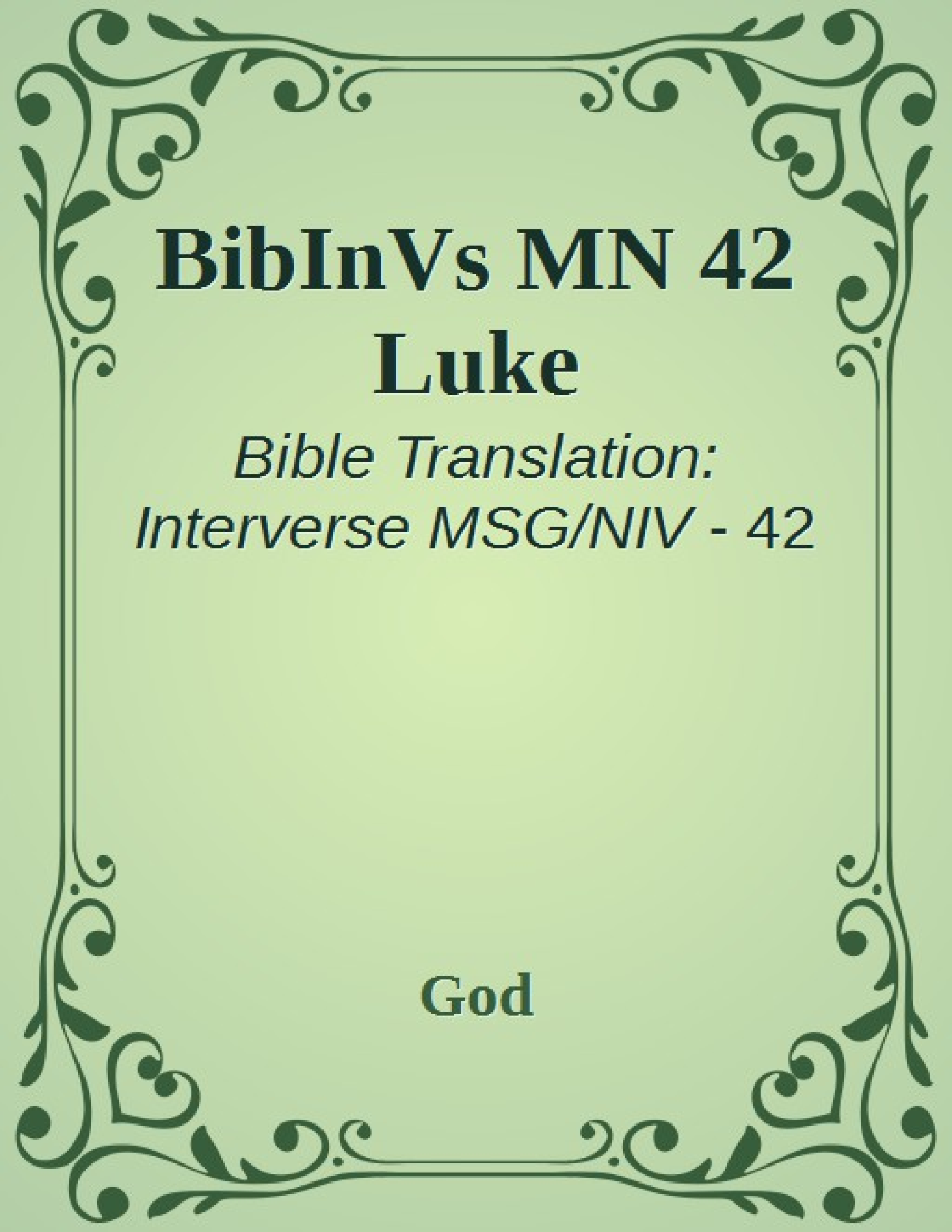


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 42

Luke

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 42*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Luke

Luke 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 So many others have tried their hand at putting together a story of the wonderful harvest of Scripture and history that took place among us,
- 1 Many have undertaken to draw up an account of the things that have been fulfilled among us,
- 2 using reports handed down by the original eyewitnesses who served this Word with their very lives.
- 2 just as they were handed down to us by those who from the first were eyewitnesses and servants of the word.
- 3 Since I have investigated all the reports in close detail, starting from the story's beginning, I decided to write it all out for you, most honorable Theophilus,
- 3 Therefore, since I myself have carefully investigated everything from the beginning, it seemed good also to me to write an orderly account for you, most excellent Theophilus,
- 4 so you can know beyond the shadow of a doubt the reliability of what you were taught.
- 4 so that you may know the certainty of the things you have been taught.
- 5 During the rule of Herod, King of Judea, there was a priest assigned service in the regiment of Abijah. His name was Zachariah. His wife was descended from the daughters of Aaron. Her name was Elizabeth.
- 5 In the time of Herod king of Judea there was a priest named Zechariah, who belonged to the priestly division of Abijah; his wife Elizabeth was also a descendant of Aaron.
- 6 Together they lived honorably before God, careful in keeping to the ways of the commandments and enjoying a clear conscience before God.
- 6 Both of them were upright in the sight of God, observing all the Lord's commandments and regulations blamelessly.

- 7 But they were childless because Elizabeth could never conceive, and now they were quite old.
- 7 But they had no children, because Elizabeth was barren; and they were both well along in years.
- 8 It so happened that as Zachariah was carrying out his priestly duties before God, working the shift assigned to his regiment,
- 8 Once when Zechariah's division was on duty and he was serving as priest before God,
- 9 it came his one turn in life to enter the sanctuary of God and burn incense.
- 9 he was chosen by lot, according to the custom of the priesthood, to go into the temple of the Lord and burn incense.
- 10 The congregation was gathered and praying outside the Temple at the hour of the incense offering.
- 10 And when the time for the burning of incense came, all the assembled worshipers were praying outside.
- 11 Unannounced, an angel of God appeared just to the right of the altar of incense.
- 11 Then an angel of the Lord appeared to him, standing at the right side of the altar of incense.
- 12 Zachariah was paralyzed in fear.
- 12 When Zechariah saw him, he was startled and was gripped with fear.
- 13 But the angel reassured him, "Don't fear, Zachariah. Your prayer has been heard. Elizabeth, your wife, will bear a son by you. You are to name him John.
- 13 But the angel said to him: "Do not be afraid, Zechariah; your prayer has been heard. Your wife Elizabeth will bear you a son, and you are to give him the name John.
- 14 You're going to leap like a gazelle for joy, and not only you--many will delight in his birth.
- 14 He will be a joy and delight to you, and many will rejoice because of his birth,
- 15 He'll achieve great stature with God. "He'll drink neither wine nor beer. He'll be filled with the Holy Spirit from the moment he leaves his mother's womb.

- 15 for he will be great in the sight of the Lord. He is never to take wine or other fermented drink, and he will be filled with the Holy Spirit even from birth.
- 16 He will turn many sons and daughters of Israel back to their God.
- 16 Many of the people of Israel will he bring back to the Lord their God.
- 17 He will herald God's arrival in the style and strength of Elijah, soften the hearts of parents to children, and kindle devout understanding among hardened skeptics--he'll get the people ready for God."
- 17 And he will go on before the Lord, in the spirit and power of Elijah, to turn the hearts of the fathers to their children and the disobedient to the wisdom of the righteous--to make ready a people prepared for the Lord."
- 18 Zachariah said to the angel, "Do you expect me to believe this? I'm an old man and my wife is an old woman."
- 18 Zechariah asked the angel, "How can I be sure of this? I am an old man and my wife is well along in years."
- 19 But the angel said, "I am Gabriel, the sentinel of God, sent especially to bring you this glad news.
- 19 The angel answered, "I am Gabriel. I stand in the presence of God, and I have been sent to speak to you and to tell you this good news.
- 20 But because you won't believe me, you'll be unable to say a word until the day of your son's birth. Every word I've spoken to you will come true on time--God's time."
- 20 And now you will be silent and not able to speak until the day this happens, because you did not believe my words, which will come true at their proper time."
- 21 Meanwhile, the congregation waiting for Zachariah was getting restless, wondering what was keeping him so long in the sanctuary.
- 21 Meanwhile, the people were waiting for Zechariah and wondering why he stayed so long in the temple.
- 22 When he came out and couldn't speak, they knew he had seen a vision. He continued speechless and had to use sign language with the people.
- 22 When he came out, he could not speak to them. They realized he had seen a vision in the temple, for he kept making signs to them but remained unable to speak.
- 23 When the course of his priestly assignment was completed, he went back home.["

23 When his time of service was completed, he returned home.

24 It wasn't long before his wife, Elizabeth, conceived. She went off by herself for five months, relishing her pregnancy.

24 After this his wife Elizabeth became pregnant and for five months remained in seclusion.

25 "So, this is how God acts to remedy my unfortunate condition!" she said.

25 The Lord has done this for me, she said. "In these days he has shown his favor and taken away my disgrace among the people."

26 In the sixth month of Elizabeth's pregnancy, God sent the angel Gabriel to the Galilean village of Nazareth

26 In the sixth month, God sent the angel Gabriel to Nazareth, a town in Galilee,

27 to a virgin engaged to be married to a man descended from David. His name was Joseph, and the virgin's name, Mary.

27 to a virgin pledged to be married to a man named Joseph, a descendant of David. The virgin's name was Mary.

28 Upon entering, Gabriel greeted her: Good morning! You're beautiful with God's beauty, Beautiful inside and out! God be with you.

28 The angel went to her and said, "Greetings, you who are highly favored! The Lord is with you."

29 She was thoroughly shaken, wondering what was behind a greeting like that.

29 Mary was greatly troubled at his words and wondered what kind of greeting this might be.

30 But the angel assured her, "Mary, you have nothing to fear. God has a surprise for you:

30 But the angel said to her, "Do not be afraid, Mary, you have found favor with God.

31 You will become pregnant and give birth to a son and call his name Jesus.

31 You will be with child and give birth to a son, and you are to give him the name Jesus.

32 He will be great, be called 'Son of the Highest.' The Lord God will give him the throne of his father David;

32 He will be great and will be called the Son of the Most High. The Lord God will give him the throne of his father David,
33 He will rule Jacob's house forever-- no end, ever, to his kingdom."
33 and he will reign over the house of Jacob forever; his kingdom will never end."
34 Mary said to the angel, "But how? I've never slept with a man."
34 How will this be, Mary asked the angel, "since I am a virgin?"
35 The angel answered, The Holy Spirit will come upon you, the power of the Highest hover over you; Therefore, the child you bring to birth will be called Holy, Son of God.
35 The angel answered, "The Holy Spirit will come upon you, and the power of the Most High will overshadow you. So the holy one to be born will be called the Son of God.
36 "And did you know that your cousin Elizabeth conceived a son, old as she is? Everyone called her barren, and here she is six months' pregnant!
36 Even Elizabeth your relative is going to have a child in her old age, and she who was said to be barren is in her sixth month.
37 Nothing, you see, is impossible with God."
37 For nothing is impossible with God."
38 And Mary said, Yes, I see it all now: I'm the Lord's maid, ready to serve. Let it be with me just as you say. Then the angel left her.
38 I am the Lord's servant, Mary answered. "May it be to me as you have said." Then the angel left her.
39 Mary didn't waste a minute. She got up and traveled to a town in Judah in the hill country,
39 At that time Mary got ready and hurried to a town in the hill country of Judea,
40 straight to Zachariah's house, and greeted Elizabeth.
40 where she entered Zechariah's home and greeted Elizabeth.
41 When Elizabeth heard Mary's greeting, the baby in her womb leaped. She was filled with the Holy Spirit,
41 When Elizabeth heard Mary's greeting, the baby leaped in her womb, and Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit.
42 and sang out exuberantly, You're so blessed among women, and the babe in your womb, also blessed!

42 In a loud voice she exclaimed: "Blessed are you among women, and
blessed is the child you will bear!

43 And why am I so blessed that the mother of my Lord visits me?

43 But why am I so favored, that the mother of my Lord should come to
me?

44 The moment the sound of your greeting entered my ears, The babe in
my womb skipped like a lamb for sheer joy.

44 As soon as the sound of your greeting reached my ears, the baby in my
womb leaped for joy.

45 Blessed woman, who believed what God said, believed every word
would come true!

45 Blessed is she who has believed that what the Lord has said to her will
be accomplished!"

46 And Mary said, I'm bursting with God-news;

46 And Mary said: "My soul glorifies the Lord

47 I'm dancing the song of my Savior God.

47 and my spirit rejoices in God my Savior,

48 God took one good look at me, and look what happened-- I'm the most
fortunate woman on earth! What God has done for me will never be
forgotten,

48 for he has been mindful of the humble state of his servant. From now on
all generations will call me blessed,

49 the God whose very name is holy, set apart from all others.

49 for the Mighty One has done great things for me-- holy is his name.

50 His mercy flows in wave after wave on those who are in awe before
him.

50 His mercy extends to those who fear him, from generation to
generation.

51 He bared his arm and showed his strength, scattered the bluffing
braggarts.

51 He has performed mighty deeds with his arm; he has scattered those
who are proud in their inmost thoughts.

52 He knocked tyrants off their high horses, pulled victims out of the mud.

52 He has brought down rulers from their thrones but has lifted up the
humble.

53 The starving poor sat down to a banquet; the callous rich were left out in the cold.

53 He has filled the hungry with good things but has sent the rich away empty.

54 He embraced his chosen child, Israel; he remembered and piled on the mercies, piled them high.

54 He has helped his servant Israel, remembering to be merciful

55 It's exactly what he promised, beginning with Abraham and right up to now.

55 to Abraham and his descendants forever, even as he said to our fathers."

56 Mary stayed with Elizabeth for three months and then went back to her own home.

56 Mary stayed with Elizabeth for about three months and then returned home.

57 When Elizabeth was full-term in her pregnancy, she bore a son.

57 When it was time for Elizabeth to have her baby, she gave birth to a son.

58 Her neighbors and relatives, seeing that God had overwhelmed her with mercy, celebrated with her.

58 Her neighbors and relatives heard that the Lord had shown her great mercy, and they shared her joy.

59 On the eighth day, they came to circumcise the child and were calling him Zachariah after his father.

59 On the eighth day they came to circumcise the child, and they were going to name him after his father Zechariah,

60 But his mother intervened: "No. He is to be called John."

60 but his mother spoke up and said, "No! He is to be called John."

61 "But," they said, "no one in your family is named that."

61 They said to her, "There is no one among your relatives who has that name."

62 They used sign language to ask Zachariah what he wanted him named.

62 Then they made signs to his father, to find out what he would like to name the child.

63 Asking for a tablet, Zachariah wrote, "His name is to be John." That took everyone by surprise.

63 He asked for a writing tablet, and to everyone's astonishment he wrote, "His name is John."

64 Surprise followed surprise--Zachariah's mouth was now open, his tongue loose, and he was talking, praising God!

64 Immediately his mouth was opened and his tongue was loosed, and he began to speak, praising God.

65 A deep, reverential fear settled over the neighborhood, and in all that Judean hill country people talked about nothing else.

65 The neighbors were all filled with awe, and throughout the hill country of Judea people were talking about all these things.

66 Everyone who heard about it took it to heart, wondering, "What will become of this child? Clearly, God has his hand in this."

66 Everyone who heard this wondered about it, asking, "What then is this child going to be?" For the Lord's hand was with him.

67 Then Zachariah was filled with the Holy Spirit and prophesied,

67 His father Zechariah was filled with the Holy Spirit and prophesied:

68 Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel; he came and set his people free.

68 Praise be to the Lord, the God of Israel, because he has come and has redeemed his people.

69 He set the power of salvation in the center of our lives, and in the very house of David his servant,

69 He has raised up a horn of salvation for us in the house of his servant David

70 Just as he promised long ago through the preaching of his holy prophets:

70 (as he said through his holy prophets of long ago),

71 Deliverance from our enemies and every hateful hand;

71 salvation from our enemies and from the hand of all who hate us--

72 Mercy to our fathers, as he remembers to do what he said he'd do,

72 to show mercy to our fathers and to remember his holy covenant,

73 What he swore to our father Abraham--

73 the oath he swore to our father Abraham:

74 a clean rescue from the enemy camp, So we can worship him without a care in the world,

74 to rescue us from the hand of our enemies, and to enable us to serve him without fear

75 made holy before him as long as we live.

75 in holiness and righteousness before him all our days.

76 And you, my child, "Prophet of the Highest," will go ahead of the Master to prepare his ways,
76 And you, my child, will be called a prophet of the Most High; for you will go on before the Lord to prepare the way for him,
77 Present the offer of salvation to his people, the forgiveness of their sins.
77 to give his people the knowledge of salvation through the forgiveness of their sins,
78 Through the heartfelt mercies of our God, God's Sunrise will break in upon us,
78 because of the tender mercy of our God, by which the rising sun will come to us from heaven
79 Shining on those in the darkness, those sitting in the shadow of death, Then showing us the way, one foot at a time, down the path of peace.
79 to shine on those living in darkness and in the shadow of death, to guide our feet into the path of peace."
80 The child grew up, healthy and spirited. He lived out in the desert until the day he made his prophetic debut in Israel.
80 And the child grew and became strong in spirit; and he lived in the desert until he appeared publicly to Israel.

Luke 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 About that time Caesar Augustus ordered a census to be taken throughout the Empire.
- 1 In those days Caesar Augustus issued a decree that a census should be taken of the entire Roman world.
- 2 This was the first census when Quirinius was governor of Syria.
- 2 (This was the first census that took place while Quirinius was governor of Syria.)
- 3 Everyone had to travel to his own ancestral hometown to be accounted for.
- 3 And everyone went to his own town to register.
- 4 So Joseph went from the Galilean town of Nazareth up to Bethlehem in Judah, David's town, for the census. As a descendant of David, he had to

go there.

- 4 So Joseph also went up from the town of Nazareth in Galilee to Judea, to Bethlehem the town of David, because he belonged to the house and line of David.
- 5 He went with Mary, his fiancée, who was pregnant.
- 5 He went there to register with Mary, who was pledged to be married to him and was expecting a child.
- 6 While they were there, the time came for her to give birth.
- 6 While they were there, the time came for the baby to be born,
- 7 She gave birth to a son, her firstborn. She wrapped him in a blanket and laid him in a manger, because there was no room in the hostel.
- 7 and she gave birth to her firstborn, a son. She wrapped him in cloths and placed him in a manger, because there was no room for them in the inn.
- 8 There were shepherders camping in the neighborhood. They had set night watches over their sheep.
- 8 And there were shepherds living out in the fields nearby, keeping watch over their flocks at night.
- 9 Suddenly, God's angel stood among them and God's glory blazed around them. They were terrified.
- 9 An angel of the Lord appeared to them, and the glory of the Lord shone around them, and they were terrified.
- 10 The angel said, "Don't be afraid. I'm here to announce a great and joyful event that is meant for everybody, worldwide:
- 10 But the angel said to them, "Do not be afraid. I bring you good news of great joy that will be for all the people.
- 11 A Savior has just been born in David's town, a Savior who is Messiah and Master.
- 11 Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is Christ the Lord.
- 12 This is what you're to look for: a baby wrapped in a blanket and lying in a manger."
- 12 This will be a sign to you: You will find a baby wrapped in cloths and lying in a manger."
- 13 At once the angel was joined by a huge angelic choir singing God's praises:

- 13 Suddenly a great company of the heavenly host appeared with the angel, praising God and saying,
- 14 Glory to God in the heavenly heights, Peace to all men and women on earth who please him.
- 14 Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace to men on whom his favor rests.
- 15 As the angel choir withdrew into heaven, the shepherders talked it over. "Let's get over to Bethlehem as fast as we can and see for ourselves what God has revealed to us."
- 15 When the angels had left them and gone into heaven, the shepherds said to one another, "Let's go to Bethlehem and see this thing that has happened, which the Lord has told us about."
- 16 They left, running, and found Mary and Joseph, and the baby lying in the manger.
- 16 So they hurried off and found Mary and Joseph, and the baby, who was lying in the manger.
- 17 Seeing was believing. They told everyone they met what the angels had said about this child.
- 17 When they had seen him, they spread the word concerning what had been told them about this child,
- 18 All who heard the shepherders were impressed.
- 18 and all who heard it were amazed at what the shepherds said to them.
- 19 Mary kept all these things to herself, holding them dear, deep within herself.
- 19 But Mary treasured up all these things and pondered them in her heart.
- 20 The shepherders returned and let loose, glorifying and praising God for everything they had heard and seen. It turned out exactly the way they'd been told!
- 20 The shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God for all the things they had heard and seen, which were just as they had been told.
- 21 When the eighth day arrived, the day of circumcision, the child was named Jesus, the name given by the angel before he was conceived.
- 21 On the eighth day, when it was time to circumcise him, he was named Jesus, the name the angel had given him before he had been conceived.
- 22 Then when the days stipulated by Moses for purification were complete, they took him up to Jerusalem to offer him to God

22 When the time of their purification according to the Law of Moses had been completed, Joseph and Mary took him to Jerusalem to present him to the Lord

23 as commanded in God's Law: "Every male who opens the womb shall be a holy offering to God,"

23 (as it is written in the Law of the Lord, "Every firstborn male is to be consecrated to the Lord"),

24 and also to sacrifice the "pair of doves or two young pigeons" prescribed in God's Law.

24 and to offer a sacrifice in keeping with what is said in the Law of the Lord: "a pair of doves or two young pigeons."

25 In Jerusalem at the time, there was a man, Simeon by name, a good man, a man who lived in the prayerful expectancy of help for Israel. And the Holy Spirit was on him.

25 Now there was a man in Jerusalem called Simeon, who was righteous and devout. He was waiting for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was upon him.

26 The Holy Spirit had shown him that he would see the Messiah of God before he died.

26 It had been revealed to him by the Holy Spirit that he would not die before he had seen the Lord's Christ.

27 Led by the Spirit, he entered the Temple. As the parents of the child Jesus brought him in to carry out the rituals of the Law,

27 Moved by the Spirit, he went into the temple courts. When the parents brought in the child Jesus to do for him what the custom of the Law required,

28 Simeon took him into his arms and blessed God:

28 Simeon took him in his arms and praised God, saying:

29 God, you can now release your servant; release me in peace as you promised.

29 Sovereign Lord, as you have promised, you now dismiss your servant in peace.

30 With my own eyes I've seen your salvation;

30 For my eyes have seen your salvation,

31 it's now out in the open for everyone to see:

31 which you have prepared in the sight of all people,

32 A God-revealing light to the non-Jewish nations, and of glory for your people Israel.

32 a light for revelation to the Gentiles and for glory to your people Israel."

33 Jesus' father and mother were speechless with surprise at these words.

33 The child's father and mother marveled at what was said about him.

34 Simeon went on to bless them, and said to Mary his mother, This child marks both the failure and the recovery of many in Israel, A figure misunderstood and contradicted--

34 Then Simeon blessed them and said to Mary, his mother: "This child is destined to cause the falling and rising of many in Israel, and to be a sign that will be spoken against,

35 the pain of a sword-thrust through you-- But the rejection will force honesty, as God reveals who they really are.

35 so that the thoughts of many hearts will be revealed. And a sword will pierce your own soul too."

36 Anna the prophetess was also there, a daughter of Phanuel from the tribe of Asher. She was by now a very old woman. She had been married seven years

36 There was also a prophetess, Anna, the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher. She was very old; she had lived with her husband seven years after her marriage,

37 and a widow for eighty-four. She never left the Temple area, worshipping night and day with her fastings and prayers.

37 and then was a widow until she was eighty-four. She never left the temple but worshiped night and day, fasting and praying.

38 At the very time Simeon was praying, she showed up, broke into an anthem of praise to God, and talked about the child to all who were waiting expectantly for the freeing of Jerusalem.

38 Coming up to them at that very moment, she gave thanks to God and spoke about the child to all who were looking forward to the redemption of Jerusalem.

39 When they finished everything required by God in the Law, they returned to Galilee and their own town, Nazareth.

39 When Joseph and Mary had done everything required by the Law of the Lord, they returned to Galilee to their own town of Nazareth.

40 There the child grew strong in body and wise in spirit. And the grace of God was on him.

40 And the child grew and became strong; he was filled with wisdom, and the grace of God was upon him.

41 Every year Jesus' parents traveled to Jerusalem for the Feast of Passover.

41 Every year his parents went to Jerusalem for the Feast of the Passover.

42 When he was twelve years old, they went up as they always did for the Feast.

42 When he was twelve years old, they went up to the Feast, according to the custom.

43 When it was over and they left for home, the child Jesus stayed behind in Jerusalem, but his parents didn't know it.

43 After the Feast was over, while his parents were returning home, the boy Jesus stayed behind in Jerusalem, but they were unaware of it.

44 Thinking he was somewhere in the company of pilgrims, they journeyed for a whole day and then began looking for him among relatives and neighbors.

44 Thinking he was in their company, they traveled on for a day. Then they began looking for him among their relatives and friends.

45 When they didn't find him, they went back to Jerusalem looking for him.

45 When they did not find him, they went back to Jerusalem to look for him.

46 The next day they found him in the Temple seated among the teachers, listening to them and asking questions.

46 After three days they found him in the temple courts, sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions.

47 The teachers were all quite taken with him, impressed with the sharpness of his answers.

47 Everyone who heard him was amazed at his understanding and his answers.

48 But his parents were not impressed; they were upset and hurt. His mother said, "Young man, why have you done this to us? Your father and I have been half out of our minds looking for you."

- 48 When his parents saw him, they were astonished. His mother said to him, "Son, why have you treated us like this? Your father and I have been anxiously searching for you."
- 49 He said, "Why were you looking for me? Didn't you know that I had to be here, dealing with the things of my Father?"
- 49 Why were you searching for me? he asked. "Didn't you know I had to be in my Father's house?"
- 50 But they had no idea what he was talking about.
- 50 But they did not understand what he was saying to them.
- 51 So he went back to Nazareth with them, and lived obediently with them. His mother held these things dearly, deep within herself.
- 51 Then he went down to Nazareth with them and was obedient to them. But his mother treasured all these things in her heart.
- 52 And Jesus matured, growing up in both body and spirit, blessed by both God and people.
- 52 And Jesus grew in wisdom and stature, and in favor with God and men.

Luke 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 In the fifteenth year of the rule of Caesar Tiberius--it was while Pontius Pilate was governor of Judea; Herod, ruler of Galilee; his brother Philip, ruler of Iturea and Trachonitis; Lysanias, ruler of Abilene;
- 1 In the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar--when Pontius Pilate was governor of Judea, Herod tetrarch of Galilee, his brother Philip tetrarch of Iturea and Traconitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of Abilene--
- 2 during the Chief-Priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas--John, Zachariah's son, out in the desert at the time, received a message from God.
- 2 during the high priesthood of Annas and Caiaphas, the word of God came to John son of Zechariah in the desert.
- 3 He went all through the country around the Jordan River preaching a baptism of life-change leading to forgiveness of sins,
- 3 He went into all the country around the Jordan, preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.

- 4 as described in the words of Isaiah the prophet: Thunder in the desert!
"Prepare God's arrival! Make the road smooth and straight!"
- 4 As is written in the book of the words of Isaiah the prophet: "A voice of
one calling in the desert, 'Prepare the way for the Lord, make straight
paths for him.
- 5 Every ditch will be filled in, Every bump smoothed out, The detours
straightened out, All the ruts paved over.
- 5 Every valley shall be filled in, every mountain and hill made low. The
crooked roads shall become straight, the rough ways smooth.
- 6 Everyone will be there to see The parade of God's salvation."
- 6 And all mankind will see God's salvation.' "
- 7 When crowds of people came out for baptism because it was the popular
thing to do, John exploded: "Brood of snakes! What do you think you're
doing slithering down here to the river? Do you think a little water on
your snakeskins is going to deflect God's judgment?
- 7 John said to the crowds coming out to be baptized by him, "You brood of
vipers! Who warned you to flee from the coming wrath?
- 8 It's your life that must change, not your skin. And don't think you can
pull rank by claiming Abraham as 'father.' Being a child of Abraham is
neither here nor there--children of Abraham are a dime a dozen. God can
make children from stones if he wants.
- 8 Produce fruit in keeping with repentance. And do not begin to say to
yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.' For I tell you that out of
these stones God can raise up children for Abraham.
- 9 What counts is your life. Is it green and blossoming? Because if it's
deadwood, it goes on the fire."
- 9 The ax is already at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not
produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire."
- 10 The crowd asked him, "Then what are we supposed to do?"
- 10 What should we do then? the crowd asked.
- 11 "If you have two coats, give one away," he said. "Do the same with your
food."
- 11 John answered, "The man with two tunics should share with him who
has none, and the one who has food should do the same."
- 12 Tax men also came to be baptized and said, "Teacher, what should we
do?"

- 12 Tax collectors also came to be baptized. "Teacher," they asked, "what should we do?"
- 13 He told them, "No more extortion--collect only what is required by law."
- 13 Don't collect any more than you are required to, he told them.
- 14 Soldiers asked him, "And what should we do?" He told them, "No shakedowns, no blackmail--and be content with your rations."
- 14 Then some soldiers asked him, "And what should we do?" He replied, "Don't extort money and don't accuse people falsely-- be content with your pay."
- 15 The interest of the people by now was building. They were all beginning to wonder, "Could this John be the Messiah?"
- 15 The people were waiting expectantly and were all wondering in their hearts if John might possibly be the Christ.
- 16 But John intervened: "I'm baptizing you here in the river. The main character in this drama, to whom I'm a mere stagehand, will ignite the kingdom life, a fire, the Holy Spirit within you, changing you from the inside out.
- 16 John answered them all, "I baptize you with water. But one more powerful than I will come, the thongs of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie. He will baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire.
- 17 He's going to clean house--make a clean sweep of your lives. He'll place everything true in its proper place before God; everything false he'll put out with the trash to be burned."
- 17 His winnowing fork is in his hand to clear his threshing floor and to gather the wheat into his barn, but he will burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire."
- 18 There was a lot more of this--words that gave strength to the people, words that put heart in them. The Message!
- 18 And with many other words John exhorted the people and preached the good news to them.
- 19 But Herod, the ruler, stung by John's rebuke in the matter of Herodias, his brother Philip's wife,
- 19 But when John rebuked Herod the tetrarch because of Herodias, his brother's wife, and all the other evil things he had done,

20 capped his long string of evil deeds with this outrage: He put John in jail.

20 Herod added this to them all: He locked John up in prison.

21 After all the people were baptized, Jesus was baptized. As he was praying, the sky opened up

21 When all the people were being baptized, Jesus was baptized too. And as he was praying, heaven was opened

22 and the Holy Spirit, like a dove descending, came down on him. And along with the Spirit, a voice: "You are my Son, chosen and marked by my love, pride of my life."

22 and the Holy Spirit descended on him in bodily form like a dove. And a voice came from heaven: "You are my Son, whom I love; with you I am well pleased."

23 When Jesus entered public life he was about thirty years old, the son (in public perception) of Joseph, who was-- son of Heli,

23 Now Jesus himself was about thirty years old when he began his ministry. He was the son, so it was thought, of Joseph, the son of Heli,

24 son of Matthat, son of Levi, son of Melchi, son of Jannai,

24 the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, the son of Melki, the son of Jannai, the son of Joseph,

25 son of Joseph, son of Mattathias, son of Amos, son of Nahum, son of Esli, son of Naggai,

25 the son of Mattathias, the son of Amos, the son of Nahum, the son of Esli, the son of Naggai,

26 son of Maath, son of Mattathias, son of Semein, son of Josech, son of Joda,

26 the son of Maath, the son of Mattathias, the son of Semein, the son of Josech, the son of Joda,

27 son of Joanan, son of Rhesa, son of Zerubbabel, son of Shealtiel, son of Neri,

27 the son of Joanan, the son of Rhesa, the son of Zerubbabel, the son of Shealtiel, the son of Neri,

28 son of Melchi, son of Addi, son of Cosam, son of Elmadam, son of Er,

28 the son of Melki, the son of Addi, the son of Cosam, the son of Elmadam, the son of Er,

29 son of Joshua, son of Eliezer, son of Jorim, son of Matthat, son of Levi,

- 29 the son of Joshua, the son of Eliezer, the son of Jorim, the son of
Matthat, the son of Levi,
30 son of Simeon, son of Judah, son of Joseph, son of Jonam, son of
Eliakim,
30 the son of Simeon, the son of Judah, the son of Joseph, the son of
Jonam, the son of Eliakim,
31 son of Melea, son of Menna, son of Mattatha, son of Nathan, son of
David,
31 the son of Melea, the son of Menna, the son of Mattatha, the son of
Nathan, the son of David,
32 son of Jesse, son of Obed, son of Boaz, son of Sala, son of Nahshon,
32 the son of Jesse, the son of Obed, the son of Boaz, the son of Salmon,
the son of Nahshon,
33 son of Amminadab, son of Admin, son of Arni, son of Hezron, son of
Perez, son of Judah,
33 the son of Amminadab, the son of Ram, the son of Hezron, the son of
Perez, the son of Judah,
34 son of Jacob, son of Isaac, son of Abraham, son of Terah, son of Nahor,
34 the son of Jacob, the son of Isaac, the son of Abraham, the son of Terah,
the son of Nahor,
35 son of Serug, son of Reu, son of Peleg, son of Eber, son of Shelah,
35 the son of Serug, the son of Reu, the son of Peleg, the son of Eber, the
son of Shelah,
36 son of Cainan, son of Arphaxad, son of Shem, son of Noah, son of
Lamech,
36 the son of Cainan, the son of Arphaxad, the son of Shem, the son of
Noah, the son of Lamech,
37 son of Methuselah, son of Enoch, son of Jared, son of Mahalaleel, son
of Cainan,
37 the son of Methuselah, the son of Enoch, the son of Jared, the son of
Mahalalel, the son of Kenan,
38 son of Enos, son of Seth, son of Adam, son of God.
38 the son of Enosh, the son of Seth, the son of Adam, the son of God.

Luke 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Now Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, left the Jordan and was led by the Spirit into the wild.
- 1 Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit in the desert,
- 2 For forty wilderness days and nights he was tested by the Devil. He ate nothing during those days, and when the time was up he was hungry.
- 2 where for forty days he was tempted by the devil. He ate nothing during those days, and at the end of them he was hungry.
- 3 The Devil, playing on his hunger, gave the first test: "Since you're God's Son, command this stone to turn into a loaf of bread."
- 3 The devil said to him, "If you are the Son of God, tell this stone to become bread."
- 4 Jesus answered by quoting Deuteronomy: "It takes more than bread to really live."
- 4 Jesus answered, "It is written: 'Man does not live on bread alone.' "
- 5 For the second test he led him up and spread out all the kingdoms of the earth on display at once.
- 5 The devil led him up to a high place and showed him in an instant all the kingdoms of the world.
- 6 Then the Devil said, "They're yours in all their splendor to serve your pleasure. I'm in charge of them all and can turn them over to whomever I wish.
- 6 And he said to him, "I will give you all their authority and splendor, for it has been given to me, and I can give it to anyone I want to.
- 7 Worship me and they're yours, the whole works."
- 7 So if you worship me, it will all be yours."
- 8 Jesus refused, again backing his refusal with Deuteronomy: "Worship the Lord your God and only the Lord your God. Serve him with absolute single-heartedness."
- 8 Jesus answered, "It is written: 'Worship the Lord your God and serve him only.' "
- 9 For the third test the Devil took him to Jerusalem and put him on top of the Temple. He said, "If you are God's Son, jump.

- 9 The devil led him to Jerusalem and had him stand on the highest point of the temple. "If you are the Son of God," he said, "throw yourself down from here.
- 10 It's written, isn't it, that 'he has placed you in the care of angels to protect you;
- 10 For it is written: " 'He will command his angels concerning you to guard you carefully;
- 11 they will catch you; you won't so much as stub your toe on a stone?'"
- 11 they will lift you up in their hands, so that you will not strike your foot against a stone.' "
- 12 "Yes," said Jesus, "and it's also written, 'Don't you dare tempt the Lord your God.'"
- 12 Jesus answered, "It says: 'Do not put the Lord your God to the test.' "
- 13 That completed the testing. The Devil retreated temporarily, lying in wait for another opportunity.
- 13 When the devil had finished all this tempting, he left him until an opportune time.
- 14 Jesus returned to Galilee powerful in the Spirit. News that he was back spread through the countryside.
- 14 Jesus returned to Galilee in the power of the Spirit, and news about him spread through the whole countryside.
- 15 He taught in their meeting places to everyone's acclaim and pleasure.
- 15 He taught in their synagogues, and everyone praised him.
- 16 He came to Nazareth where he had been reared. As he always did on the Sabbath, he went to the meeting place. When he stood up to read,
- 16 He went to Nazareth, where he had been brought up, and on the Sabbath day he went into the synagogue, as was his custom. And he stood up to read.
- 17 he was handed the scroll of the prophet Isaiah. Unrolling the scroll, he found the place where it was written,
- 17 The scroll of the prophet Isaiah was handed to him. Unrolling it, he found the place where it is written:
- 18 God's Spirit is on me; he's chosen me to preach the Message of good news to the poor, Sent me to announce pardon to prisoners and recovery of sight to the blind, To set the burdened and battered free,

18 The Spirit of the Lord is on me, because he has anointed me to preach good news to the poor. He has sent me to proclaim freedom for the prisoners and recovery of sight for the blind, to release the oppressed,
19 to announce, "This is God's year to act!"
19 to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor."
20 He rolled up the scroll, handed it back to the assistant, and sat down. Every eye in the place was on him, intent.
20 Then he rolled up the scroll, gave it back to the attendant and sat down. The eyes of everyone in the synagogue were fastened on him,
21 Then he started in, "You've just heard Scripture make history. It came true just now in this place."
21 and he began by saying to them, "Today this scripture is fulfilled in your hearing."
22 All who were there, watching and listening, were surprised at how well he spoke. But they also said, "Isn't this Joseph's son, the one we've known since he was a youngster?"
22 All spoke well of him and were amazed at the gracious words that came from his lips. "Isn't this Joseph's son?" they asked.
23 He answered, "I suppose you're going to quote the proverb, 'Doctor, go heal yourself. Do here in your hometown what we heard you did in Capernaum.'
23 Jesus said to them, "Surely you will quote this proverb to me: 'Physician, heal yourself! Do here in your hometown what we have heard that you did in Capernaum.' "
24 Well, let me tell you something: No prophet is ever welcomed in his hometown.
24 I tell you the truth, he continued, "no prophet is accepted in his hometown.
25 Isn't it a fact that there were many widows in Israel at the time of Elijah during that three and a half years of drought when famine devastated the land,
25 I assure you that there were many widows in Israel in Elijah's time, when the sky was shut for three and a half years and there was a severe famine throughout the land.
26 but the only widow to whom Elijah was sent was in Sarepta in Sidon?

26 Yet Elijah was not sent to any of them, but to a widow in Zarephath in the region of Sidon.

27 And there were many lepers in Israel at the time of the prophet Elisha but the only one cleansed was Naaman the Syrian."

27 And there were many in Israel with leprosy in the time of Elisha the prophet, yet not one of them was cleansed--only Naaman the Syrian."

28 That set everyone in the meeting place seething with anger.

28 All the people in the synagogue were furious when they heard this.

29 They threw him out, banishing him from the village, then took him to a mountain cliff at the edge of the village to throw him to his doom,

29 They got up, drove him out of the town, and took him to the brow of the hill on which the town was built, in order to throw him down the cliff.

30 but he gave them the slip and was on his way.

30 But he walked right through the crowd and went on his way.

31 He went down to Capernaum, a village in Galilee. He was teaching the people on the Sabbath.

31 Then he went down to Capernaum, a town in Galilee, and on the Sabbath began to teach the people.

32 They were surprised and impressed--his teaching was so forthright, so confident, so authoritative, not the quibbling and quoting they were used to.

32 They were amazed at his teaching, because his message had authority.

33 In the meeting place that day there was a man demonically disturbed. He screamed,

33 In the synagogue there was a man possessed by a demon, an evil spirit. He cried out at the top of his voice,

34 "Ho! What business do you have here with us, Jesus? Nazarene! I know what you're up to. You're the Holy One of God and you've come to destroy us!"

34 Ha! What do you want with us, Jesus of Nazareth? Have you come to destroy us? I know who you are--the Holy One of God!

35 Jesus shut him up: "Quiet! Get out of him!" The demonic spirit threw the man down in front of them all and left. The demon didn't hurt him.

35 Be quiet! Jesus said sternly. "Come out of him!" Then the demon threw the man down before them all and came out without injuring him.

- 36 That set everyone back on their heels, whispering and wondering, "What's going on here? Someone whose words make things happen? Someone who orders demonic spirits to get out and they go?"
- 36 All the people were amazed and said to each other, "What is this teaching? With authority and power he gives orders to evil spirits and they come out!"
- 37 Jesus was the talk of the town.
- 37 And the news about him spread throughout the surrounding area.
- 38 He left the meeting place and went to Simon's house. Simon's mother-in-law was running a high fever and they asked him to do something for her.
- 38 Jesus left the synagogue and went to the home of Simon. Now Simon's mother-in-law was suffering from a high fever, and they asked Jesus to help her.
- 39 He stood over her, told the fever to leave--and it left. Before they knew it, she was up getting dinner for them.
- 39 So he bent over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her. She got up at once and began to wait on them.
- 40 When the sun went down, everyone who had anyone sick with some ailment or other brought them to him. One by one he placed his hands on them and healed them.
- 40 When the sun was setting, the people brought to Jesus all who had various kinds of sickness, and laying his hands on each one, he healed them.
- 41 Demons left in droves, screaming, "Son of God! You're the Son of God!" But he shut them up, refusing to let them speak because they knew too much, knew him to be the Messiah.
- 41 Moreover, demons came out of many people, shouting, "You are the Son of God!" But he rebuked them and would not allow them to speak, because they knew he was the Christ.
- 42 He left the next day for open country. But the crowds went looking and, when they found him, clung to him so he couldn't go on.
- 42 At daybreak Jesus went out to a solitary place. The people were looking for him and when they came to where he was, they tried to keep him from leaving them.

- 43 He told them, "Don't you realize that there are yet other villages where I have to tell the Message of God's kingdom, that this is the work God sent me to do?"
- 43 But he said, "I must preach the good news of the kingdom of God to the other towns also, because that is why I was sent."
- 44 Meanwhile he continued preaching in the meeting places of Galilee.
- 44 And he kept on preaching in the synagogues of Judea.

Luke 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Once when he was standing on the shore of Lake Gennesaret, the crowd was pushing in on him to better hear the Word of God.
- 1 One day as Jesus was standing by the Lake of Gennesaret, with the people crowding around him and listening to the word of God,
- 2 He noticed two boats tied up. The fishermen had just left them and were out scrubbing their nets.
- 2 he saw at the water's edge two boats, left there by the fishermen, who were washing their nets.
- 3 He climbed into the boat that was Simon's and asked him to put out a little from the shore. Sitting there, using the boat for a pulpit, he taught the crowd.
- 3 He got into one of the boats, the one belonging to Simon, and asked him to put out a little from shore. Then he sat down and taught the people from the boat.
- 4 When he finished teaching, he said to Simon, "Push out into deep water and let your nets out for a catch."
- 4 When he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, "Put out into deep water, and let down the nets for a catch."
- 5 Simon said, "Master, we've been fishing hard all night and haven't caught even a minnow. But if you say so, I'll let out the nets."
- 5 Simon answered, "Master, we've worked hard all night and haven't caught anything. But because you say so, I will let down the nets."
- 6 It was no sooner said than done--a huge haul of fish, straining the nets past capacity.

- 6 When they had done so, they caught such a large number of fish that their nets began to break.
- 7 They waved to their partners in the other boat to come help them. They filled both boats, nearly swamping them with the catch.
- 7 So they signaled their partners in the other boat to come and help them, and they came and filled both boats so full that they began to sink.
- 8 Simon Peter, when he saw it, fell to his knees before Jesus. "Master, leave. I'm a sinner and can't handle this holiness. Leave me to myself."
- 8 When Simon Peter saw this, he fell at Jesus' knees and said, "Go away from me, Lord; I am a sinful man!"
- 9 When they pulled in that catch of fish, awe overwhelmed Simon and everyone with him.
- 9 For he and all his companions were astonished at the catch of fish they had taken,
- 10 It was the same with James and John, Zebedee's sons, coworkers with Simon. Jesus said to Simon, "There is nothing to fear. From now on you'll be fishing for men and women."
- 10 and so were James and John, the sons of Zebedee, Simon's partners. Then Jesus said to Simon, "Don't be afraid; from now on you will catch men."
- 11 They pulled their boats up on the beach, left them, nets and all, and followed him.
- 11 So they pulled their boats up on shore, left everything and followed him.
- 12 One day in one of the villages there was a man covered with leprosy. When he saw Jesus he fell down before him in prayer and said, "If you want to, you can cleanse me."
- 12 While Jesus was in one of the towns, a man came along who was covered with leprosy. When he saw Jesus, he fell with his face to the ground and begged him, "Lord, if you are willing, you can make me clean."
- 13 Jesus put out his hand, touched him, and said, "I want to. Be clean." Then and there his skin was smooth, the leprosy gone.
- 13 Jesus reached out his hand and touched the man. "I am willing," he said. "Be clean!" And immediately the leprosy left him.
- 14 Jesus instructed him, "Don't talk about this all over town. Just quietly present your healed self to the priest, along with the offering ordered by

Moses. Your cleansed and obedient life, not your words, will bear witness to what I have done."

14 Then Jesus ordered him, "Don't tell anyone, but go, show yourself to the priest and offer the sacrifices that Moses commanded for your cleansing, as a testimony to them."

15 But the man couldn't keep it to himself, and the word got out. Soon a large crowd of people had gathered to listen and be healed of their ailments.

15 Yet the news about him spread all the more, so that crowds of people came to hear him and to be healed of their sicknesses.

16 As often as possible Jesus withdrew to out-of-the-way places for prayer.

16 But Jesus often withdrew to lonely places and prayed.

17 One day as he was teaching, Pharisees and religion teachers were sitting around. They had come from nearly every village in Galilee and Judea, even as far away as Jerusalem, to be there. The healing power of God was on him.

17 One day as he was teaching, Pharisees and teachers of the law, who had come from every village of Galilee and from Judea and Jerusalem, were sitting there. And the power of the Lord was present for him to heal the sick.

18 Some men arrived carrying a paraplegic on a stretcher. They were looking for a way to get into the house and set him before Jesus.

18 Some men came carrying a paralytic on a mat and tried to take him into the house to lay him before Jesus.

19 When they couldn't find a way in because of the crowd, they went up on the roof, removed some tiles, and let him down in the middle of everyone, right in front of Jesus.

19 When they could not find a way to do this because of the crowd, they went up on the roof and lowered him on his mat through the tiles into the middle of the crowd, right in front of Jesus.

20 Impressed by their bold belief, he said, "Friend, I forgive your sins."

20 When Jesus saw their faith, he said, "Friend, your sins are forgiven."

21 That set the religion scholars and Pharisees buzzing. "Who does he think he is? That's blasphemous talk! God and only God can forgive sins."

- 21 The Pharisees and the teachers of the law began thinking to themselves, "Who is this fellow who speaks blasphemy? Who can forgive sins but God alone?"
- 22 Jesus knew exactly what they were thinking and said, "Why all this gossiping and whispering?"
- 22 Jesus knew what they were thinking and asked, "Why are you thinking these things in your hearts?"
- 23 Which is simpler: to say 'I forgive your sins,' or to say 'Get up and start walking'?
- 23 Which is easier: to say, 'Your sins are forgiven,' or to say, 'Get up and walk'?
- 24 Well, just so it's clear that I'm the Son of Man and authorized to do either, or both. . . ." He now spoke directly to the paralytic: "Get up. Take your bedroll and go home."
- 24 But that you may know that the Son of Man has authority on earth to forgive sins. . . ." He said to the paralyzed man, "I tell you, get up, take your mat and go home."
- 25 Without a moment's hesitation, he did it--got up, took his blanket, and left for home, giving glory to God all the way.
- 25 Immediately he stood up in front of them, took what he had been lying on and went home praising God.
- 26 The people rubbed their eyes, incredulous--and then also gave glory to God. Awestruck, they said, "We've never seen anything like that!"
- 26 Everyone was amazed and gave praise to God. They were filled with awe and said, "We have seen remarkable things today."
- 27 After this he went out and saw a man named Levi at his work collecting taxes. Jesus said, "Come along with me."
- 27 After this, Jesus went out and saw a tax collector by the name of Levi sitting at his tax booth. "Follow me," Jesus said to him,
- 28 And he did--walked away from everything and went with him.
- 28 and Levi got up, left everything and followed him.
- 29 Levi gave a large dinner at his home for Jesus. Everybody was there, tax men and other disreputable characters as guests at the dinner.
- 29 Then Levi held a great banquet for Jesus at his house, and a large crowd of tax collectors and others were eating with them.

- 30 The Pharisees and their religion scholars came to his disciples greatly offended. "What is he doing eating and drinking with crooks and 'sinners'?"
- 30 But the Pharisees and the teachers of the law who belonged to their sect complained to his disciples, "Why do you eat and drink with tax collectors and 'sinners'?"
- 31 Jesus heard about it and spoke up, "Who needs a doctor: the healthy or the sick?"
- 31 Jesus answered them, "It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.
- 32 I'm here inviting outsiders, not insiders--an invitation to a changed life, changed inside and out."
- 32 I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance."
- 33 They asked him, "John's disciples are well-known for keeping fasts and saying prayers. Also the Pharisees. But you seem to spend most of your time at parties. Why?"
- 33 They said to him, "John's disciples often fast and pray, and so do the disciples of the Pharisees, but yours go on eating and drinking."
- 34 Jesus said, "When you're celebrating a wedding, you don't skimp on the cake and wine. You feast. Later you may need to pull in your belt, but this isn't the time. As long as the bride and groom are with you, you have a good time.
- 34 Jesus answered, "Can you make the guests of the bridegroom fast while he is with them?"
- 35 When the groom is gone, the fasting can begin. No one throws cold water on a friendly bonfire. This is Kingdom Come!
- 35 But the time will come when the bridegroom will be taken from them; in those days they will fast."
- 36 "No one cuts up a fine silk scarf to patch old work clothes; you want fabrics that match.
- 36 He told them this parable: "No one tears a patch from a new garment and sews it on an old one. If he does, he will have torn the new garment, and the patch from the new will not match the old.
- 37 And you don't put wine in old, cracked bottles;
- 37 And no one pours new wine into old wineskins. If he does, the new wine will burst the skins, the wine will run out and the wineskins will be

ruined.

38 you get strong, clean bottles for your fresh vintage wine.

38 No, new wine must be poured into new wineskins.

39 And no one who has ever tasted fine aged wine prefers unaged wine."

39 And no one after drinking old wine wants the new, for he says, 'The old is better.' "

Luke 6

MSG

NIV

1 On a certain Sabbath Jesus was walking through a field of ripe grain. His disciples were pulling off heads of grain, rubbing them in their hands to get rid of the chaff, and eating them.

1 One Sabbath Jesus was going through the grainfields, and his disciples began to pick some heads of grain, rub them in their hands and eat the kernels.

2 Some Pharisees said, "Why are you doing that, breaking a Sabbath rule?"

2 Some of the Pharisees asked, "Why are you doing what is unlawful on the Sabbath?"

3 But Jesus stood up for them. "Have you never read what David and those with him did when they were hungry?

3 Jesus answered them, "Have you never read what David did when he and his companions were hungry?

4 How he entered the sanctuary and ate fresh bread off the altar, bread that no one but priests were allowed to eat? He also handed it out to his companions."

4 He entered the house of God, and taking the consecrated bread, he ate what is lawful only for priests to eat. And he also gave some to his companions."

5 Then he said, "The Son of Man is no slave to the Sabbath; he's in charge."

5 Then Jesus said to them, "The Son of Man is Lord of the Sabbath."

6 On another Sabbath he went to the meeting place and taught. There was a man there with a crippled right hand.

- 6 On another Sabbath he went into the synagogue and was teaching, and a man was there whose right hand was shriveled.
- 7 The religion scholars and Pharisees had their eye on Jesus to see if he would heal the man, hoping to catch him in a Sabbath infraction.
- 7 The Pharisees and the teachers of the law were looking for a reason to accuse Jesus, so they watched him closely to see if he would heal on the Sabbath.
- 8 He knew what they were up to and spoke to the man with the crippled hand: "Get up and stand here before us." He did.
- 8 But Jesus knew what they were thinking and said to the man with the shriveled hand, "Get up and stand in front of everyone." So he got up and stood there.
- 9 Then Jesus addressed them, "Let me ask you something: What kind of action suits the Sabbath best? Doing good or doing evil? Helping people or leaving them helpless?"
- 9 Then Jesus said to them, "I ask you, which is lawful on the Sabbath: to do good or to do evil, to save life or to destroy it?"
- 10 He looked around, looked each one in the eye. He said to the man, "Hold out your hand." He held it out--it was as good as new!
- 10 He looked around at them all, and then said to the man, "Stretch out your hand." He did so, and his hand was completely restored.
- 11 They were beside themselves with anger, and started plotting how they might get even with him.
- 11 But they were furious and began to discuss with one another what they might do to Jesus.
- 12 At about that same time he climbed a mountain to pray. He was there all night in prayer before God.
- 12 One of those days Jesus went out to a mountainside to pray, and spent the night praying to God.
- 13 The next day he summoned his disciples; from them he selected twelve he designated as apostles:
- 13 When morning came, he called his disciples to him and chose twelve of them, whom he also designated apostles:
- 14 Simon, whom he named Peter, Andrew, his brother, James, John, Philip, Bartholomew,

- 14 Simon (whom he named Peter), his brother Andrew, James, John, Philip, Bartholomew,
- 15 Matthew, Thomas, James, son of Alphaeus, Simon, called the Zealot,
- 15 Matthew, Thomas, James son of Alphaeus, Simon who was called the Zealot,
- 16 Judas, son of James, Judas Iscariot, who betrayed him.
- 16 Judas son of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor.
- 17 Coming down off the mountain with them, he stood on a plain surrounded by disciples, and was soon joined by a huge congregation from all over Judea and Jerusalem, even from the seaside towns of Tyre and Sidon.
- 17 He went down with them and stood on a level place. A large crowd of his disciples was there and a great number of people from all over Judea, from Jerusalem, and from the coast of Tyre and Sidon,
- 18 They had come both to hear him and to be cured of their ailments. Those disturbed by evil spirits were healed.
- 18 who had come to hear him and to be healed of their diseases. Those troubled by evil spirits were cured,
- 19 Everyone was trying to touch him--so much energy surging from him, so many people healed!
- 19 and the people all tried to touch him, because power was coming from him and healing them all.
- 20 Then he spoke: You're blessed when you've lost it all. God's kingdom is there for the finding.
- 20 Looking at his disciples, he said: "Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God.
- 21 You're blessed when you're ravenously hungry. Then you're ready for the Messianic meal. You're blessed when the tears flow freely. Joy comes with the morning.
- 21 Blessed are you who hunger now, for you will be satisfied. Blessed are you who weep now, for you will laugh.
- 22 "Count yourself blessed every time someone cuts you down or throws you out, every time someone smears or blackens your name to discredit me. What it means is that the truth is too close for comfort and that that person is uncomfortable.

- 22 Blessed are you when men hate you, when they exclude you and insult you and reject your name as evil, because of the Son of Man.
- 23 You can be glad when that happens--skip like a lamb, if you like!--for even though they don't like it, I do . . . and all heaven applauds. And know that you are in good company; my preachers and witnesses have always been treated like this.
- 23 Rejoice in that day and leap for joy, because great is your reward in heaven. For that is how their fathers treated the prophets.
- 24 But it's trouble ahead if you think you have it made. What you have is all you'll ever get.
- 24 But woe to you who are rich, for you have already received your comfort.
- 25 And it's trouble ahead if you're satisfied with yourself. Your self will not satisfy you for long. And it's trouble ahead if you think life's all fun and games. There's suffering to be met, and you're going to meet it.
- 25 Woe to you who are well fed now, for you will go hungry. Woe to you who laugh now, for you will mourn and weep.
- 26 "There's trouble ahead when you live only for the approval of others, saying what flatters them, doing what indulges them. Popularity contests are not truth contests--look how many scoundrel preachers were approved by your ancestors! Your task is to be true, not popular.
- 26 Woe to you when all men speak well of you, for that is how their fathers treated the false prophets.
- 27 "To you who are ready for the truth, I say this: Love your enemies. Let them bring out the best in you, not the worst.
- 27 But I tell you who hear me: Love your enemies, do good to those who hate you,
- 28 When someone gives you a hard time, respond with the energies of prayer for that person.
- 28 bless those who curse you, pray for those who mistreat you.
- 29 If someone slaps you in the face, stand there and take it. If someone grabs your shirt, giftwrap your best coat and make a present of it.
- 29 If someone strikes you on one cheek, turn to him the other also. If someone takes your cloak, do not stop him from taking your tunic.
- 30 If someone takes unfair advantage of you, use the occasion to practice the servant life. No more tit-for-tat stuff. Live generously.

- 30 Give to everyone who asks you, and if anyone takes what belongs to you, do not demand it back.
- 31 "Here is a simple rule of thumb for behavior: Ask yourself what you want people to do for you; then grab the initiative and do it for them!
- 31 Do to others as you would have them do to you.
- 32 If you only love the lovable, do you expect a pat on the back? Run-of-the-mill sinners do that.
- 32 If you love those who love you, what credit is that to you? Even 'sinners' love those who love them.
- 33 If you only help those who help you, do you expect a medal? Garden-variety sinners do that.
- 33 And if you do good to those who are good to you, what credit is that to you? Even 'sinners' do that.
- 34 If you only give for what you hope to get out of it, do you think that's charity? The stingiest of pawnbrokers does that.
- 34 And if you lend to those from whom you expect repayment, what credit is that to you? Even 'sinners' lend to 'sinners,' expecting to be repaid in full.
- 35 "I tell you, love your enemies. Help and give without expecting a return. You'll never--I promise--regret it. Live out this God-created identity the way our Father lives toward us, generously and graciously, even when we're at our worst.
- 35 But love your enemies, do good to them, and lend to them without expecting to get anything back. Then your reward will be great, and you will be sons of the Most High, because he is kind to the ungrateful and wicked.
- 36 Our Father is kind; you be kind.
- 36 Be merciful, just as your Father is merciful.
- 37 "Don't pick on people, jump on their failures, criticize their faults--unless, of course, you want the same treatment. Don't condemn those who are down; that hardness can boomerang. Be easy on people; you'll find life a lot easier.
- 37 Do not judge, and you will not be judged. Do not condemn, and you will not be condemned. Forgive, and you will be forgiven.
- 38 Give away your life; you'll find life given back, but not merely given back--given back with bonus and blessing. Giving, not getting, is the

way. Generosity begets generosity."

38 Give, and it will be given to you. A good measure, pressed down, shaken together and running over, will be poured into your lap. For with the measure you use, it will be measured to you."

39 He quoted a proverb: "'Can a blind man guide a blind man?' Wouldn't they both end up in the ditch?"

39 He also told them this parable: "Can a blind man lead a blind man? Will they not both fall into a pit?"

40 An apprentice doesn't lecture the master. The point is to be careful who you follow as your teacher.

40 A student is not above his teacher, but everyone who is fully trained will be like his teacher.

41 "It's easy to see a smudge on your neighbor's face and be oblivious to the ugly sneer on your own.

41 Why do you look at the speck of sawdust in your brother's eye and pay no attention to the plank in your own eye?"

42 Do you have the nerve to say, 'Let me wash your face for you,' when your own face is distorted by contempt? It's this I-know-better-than-you mentality again, playing a holier-than-thou part instead of just living your own part. Wipe that ugly sneer off your own face and you might be fit to offer a washcloth to your neighbor.

42 How can you say to your brother, 'Brother, let me take the speck out of your eye,' when you yourself fail to see the plank in your own eye? You hypocrite, first take the plank out of your eye, and then you will see clearly to remove the speck from your brother's eye.

43 "You don't get wormy apples off a healthy tree, nor good apples off a diseased tree.

43 No good tree bears bad fruit, nor does a bad tree bear good fruit.

44 The health of the apple tells the health of the tree. You must begin with your own life-giving lives.

44 Each tree is recognized by its own fruit. People do not pick figs from thornbushes, or grapes from briars.

45 It's who you are, not what you say and do, that counts. Your true being brims over into true words and deeds.

45 The good man brings good things out of the good stored up in his heart, and the evil man brings evil things out of the evil stored up in his heart.

For out of the overflow of his heart his mouth speaks.

46 "Why are you so polite with me, always saying 'Yes, sir,' and 'That's right, sir,' but never doing a thing I tell you?

46 Why do you call me, 'Lord, Lord,' and do not do what I say?

47 These words I speak to you are not mere additions to your life, homeowner improvements to your standard of living. They are foundation words, words to build a life on.

47 I will show you what he is like who comes to me and hears my words and puts them into practice.

48 "If you work the words into your life, you are like a smart carpenter who dug deep and laid the foundation of his house on bedrock. When the river burst its banks and crashed against the house, nothing could shake it; it was built to last.

48 He is like a man building a house, who dug down deep and laid the foundation on rock. When a flood came, the torrent struck that house but could not shake it, because it was well built.

49 But if you just use my words in Bible studies and don't work them into your life, you are like a dumb carpenter who built a house but skipped the foundation. When the swollen river came crashing in, it collapsed like a house of cards. It was a total loss."

49 But the one who hears my words and does not put them into practice is like a man who built a house on the ground without a foundation. The moment the torrent struck that house, it collapsed and its destruction was complete."

Luke 7

MSG

NIV

1 When he finished speaking to the people, he entered Capernaum.

1 When Jesus had finished saying all this in the hearing of the people, he entered Capernaum.

2 A Roman captain there had a servant who was on his deathbed. He prized him highly and didn't want to lose him.

2 There a centurion's servant, whom his master valued highly, was sick and about to die.

3 When he heard Jesus was back, he sent leaders from the Jewish community asking him to come and heal his servant.

3 The centurion heard of Jesus and sent some elders of the Jews to him, asking him to come and heal his servant.

4 They came to Jesus and urged him to do it, saying, "He deserves this.

4 When they came to Jesus, they pleaded earnestly with him, "This man deserves to have you do this,

5 He loves our people. He even built our meeting place."

5 because he loves our nation and has built our synagogue."

6 Jesus went with them. When he was still quite far from the house, the captain sent friends to tell him, "Master, you don't have to go to all this trouble. I'm not that good a person, you know. I'd be embarrassed for you to come to my house,

6 So Jesus went with them. He was not far from the house when the centurion sent friends to say to him: "Lord, don't trouble yourself, for I do not deserve to have you come under my roof.

7 even embarrassed to come to you in person. Just give the order and my servant will get well.

7 That is why I did not even consider myself worthy to come to you. But say the word, and my servant will be healed.

8 I'm a man under orders; I also give orders. I tell one soldier, 'Go,' and he goes; another, 'Come,' and he comes; my slave, 'Do this,' and he does it."

8 For I myself am a man under authority, with soldiers under me. I tell this one, 'Go,' and he goes; and that one, 'Come,' and he comes. I say to my servant, 'Do this,' and he does it."

9 Taken aback, Jesus addressed the accompanying crowd: "I've yet to come across this kind of simple trust anywhere in Israel, the very people who are supposed to know about God and how he works."

9 When Jesus heard this, he was amazed at him, and turning to the crowd following him, he said, "I tell you, I have not found such great faith even in Israel."

10 When the messengers got back home, they found the servant up and well.

10 Then the men who had been sent returned to the house and found the servant well.

- 11 Not long after that, Jesus went to the village Nain. His disciples were with him, along with quite a large crowd.
- 11 Soon afterward, Jesus went to a town called Nain, and his disciples and a large crowd went along with him.
- 12 As they approached the village gate, they met a funeral procession--a woman's only son was being carried out for burial. And the mother was a widow.
- 12 As he approached the town gate, a dead person was being carried out--the only son of his mother, and she was a widow. And a large crowd from the town was with her.
- 13 When Jesus saw her, his heart broke. He said to her, "Don't cry."
- 13 When the Lord saw her, his heart went out to her and he said, "Don't cry."
- 14 Then he went over and touched the coffin. The pallbearers stopped. He said, "Young man, I tell you: Get up."
- 14 Then he went up and touched the coffin, and those carrying it stood still. He said, "Young man, I say to you, get up!"
- 15 The dead son sat up and began talking. Jesus presented him to his mother.
- 15 The dead man sat up and began to talk, and Jesus gave him back to his mother.
- 16 They all realized they were in a place of holy mystery, that God was at work among them. They were quietly worshipful--and then noisily grateful, calling out among themselves, "God is back, looking to the needs of his people!"
- 16 They were all filled with awe and praised God. "A great prophet has appeared among us," they said. "God has come to help his people."
- 17 The news of Jesus spread all through the country.
- 17 This news about Jesus spread throughout Judea and the surrounding country.
- 18 John's disciples reported back to him the news of all these events taking place.
- 18 John's disciples told him about all these things. Calling two of them,
- 19 He sent two of them to the Master to ask the question, "Are you the One we've been expecting, or are we still waiting?"

- 19 he sent them to the Lord to ask, "Are you the one who was to come, or should we expect someone else?"
- 20 The men showed up before Jesus and said, "John the Baptizer sent us to ask you, 'Are you the One we've been expecting, or are we still waiting?'"
- 20 When the men came to Jesus, they said, "John the Baptist sent us to you to ask, 'Are you the one who was to come, or should we expect someone else?' "
- 21 In the next two or three hours Jesus healed many from diseases, distress, and evil spirits. To many of the blind he gave the gift of sight.
- 21 At that very time Jesus cured many who had diseases, sicknesses and evil spirits, and gave sight to many who were blind.
- 22 Then he gave his answer: "Go back and tell John what you have just seen and heard: The blind see, The lame walk, Lepers are cleansed, The deaf hear, The dead are raised, The wretched of the earth have God's salvation hospitality extended to them.
- 22 So he replied to the messengers, "Go back and report to John what you have seen and heard: The blind receive sight, the lame walk, those who have leprosy are cured, the deaf hear, the dead are raised, and the good news is preached to the poor.
- 23 "Is this what you were expecting? Then count yourselves fortunate!"
- 23 Blessed is the man who does not fall away on account of me."
- 24 After John's messengers left to make their report, Jesus said more about John to the crowd of people. "What did you expect when you went out to see him in the wild? A weekend camper?
- 24 After John's messengers left, Jesus began to speak to the crowd about John: "What did you go out into the desert to see? A reed swayed by the wind?
- 25 Hardly. What then? A sheik in silk pajamas? Not in the wilderness, not by a long shot.
- 25 If not, what did you go out to see? A man dressed in fine clothes? No, those who wear expensive clothes and indulge in luxury are in palaces.
- 26 What then? A messenger from God? That's right, a messenger! Probably the greatest messenger you'll ever hear.
- 26 But what did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet.

- 27 He is the messenger Malachi announced when he wrote, I'm sending my messenger on ahead To make the road smooth for you.
- 27 This is the one about whom it is written: " 'I will send my messenger ahead of you, who will prepare your way before you.'
- 28 "Let me lay it out for you as plainly as I can: No one in history surpasses John the Baptizer, but in the kingdom he prepared you for, the lowliest person is ahead of him.
- 28 I tell you, among those born of women there is no one greater than John; yet the one who is least in the kingdom of God is greater than he."
- 29 The ordinary and disreputable people who heard John, by being baptized by him into the kingdom, are the clearest evidence;
- 29 (All the people, even the tax collectors, when they heard Jesus' words, acknowledged that God's way was right, because they had been baptized by John.
- 30 the Pharisees and religious officials would have nothing to do with such a baptism, wouldn't think of giving up their place in line to their inferiors.
- 30 But the Pharisees and experts in the law rejected God's purpose for themselves, because they had not been baptized by John.)
- 31 "How can I account for the people of this generation?
- 31 To what, then, can I compare the people of this generation? What are they like?
- 32 They're like spoiled children complaining to their parents, 'We wanted to skip rope and you were always too tired; we wanted to talk but you were always too busy.'
- 32 They are like children sitting in the marketplace and calling out to each other: " 'We played the flute for you, and you did not dance; we sang a dirge, and you did not cry.'
- 33 John the Baptizer came fasting and you called him crazy.
- 33 For John the Baptist came neither eating bread nor drinking wine, and you say, 'He has a demon.'
- 34 The Son of Man came feasting and you called him a lush.
- 34 The Son of Man came eating and drinking, and you say, 'Here is a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and "sinners." ' '
- 35 Opinion polls don't count for much, do they? The proof of the pudding is in the eating."

35 But wisdom is proved right by all her children."

36 One of the Pharisees asked him over for a meal. He went to the Pharisee's house and sat down at the dinner table.

36 Now one of the Pharisees invited Jesus to have dinner with him, so he went to the Pharisee's house and reclined at the table.

37 Just then a woman of the village, the town harlot, having learned that Jesus was a guest in the home of the Pharisee, came with a bottle of very expensive perfume

37 When a woman who had lived a sinful life in that town learned that Jesus was eating at the Pharisee's house, she brought an alabaster jar of perfume,

38 and stood at his feet, weeping, raining tears on his feet. Letting down her hair, she dried his feet, kissed them, and anointed them with the perfume.

38 and as she stood behind him at his feet weeping, she began to wet his feet with her tears. Then she wiped them with her hair, kissed them and poured perfume on them.

39 When the Pharisee who had invited him saw this, he said to himself, "If this man was the prophet I thought he was, he would have known what kind of woman this is who is falling all over him."

39 When the Pharisee who had invited him saw this, he said to himself, "If this man were a prophet, he would know who is touching him and what kind of woman she is--that she is a sinner."

40 Jesus said to him, "Simon, I have something to tell you." "Oh? Tell me."

40 Jesus answered him, "Simon, I have something to tell you." "Tell me, teacher," he said.

41 "Two men were in debt to a banker. One owed five hundred silver pieces, the other fifty.

41 Two men owed money to a certain moneylender. One owed him five hundred denarii, and the other fifty.

42 Neither of them could pay up, and so the banker canceled both debts. Which of the two would be more grateful?"

42 Neither of them had the money to pay him back, so he canceled the debts of both. Now which of them will love him more?"

43 Simon answered, "I suppose the one who was forgiven the most." "That's right," said Jesus.

- 43 Simon replied, "I suppose the one who had the bigger debt canceled."
"You have judged correctly," Jesus said.
- 44 Then turning to the woman, but speaking to Simon, he said, "Do you see this woman? I came to your home; you provided no water for my feet, but she rained tears on my feet and dried them with her hair.
- 44 Then he turned toward the woman and said to Simon, "Do you see this woman? I came into your house. You did not give me any water for my feet, but she wet my feet with her tears and wiped them with her hair.
- 45 You gave me no greeting, but from the time I arrived she hasn't quit kissing my feet.
- 45 You did not give me a kiss, but this woman, from the time I entered, has not stopped kissing my feet.
- 46 You provided nothing for freshening up, but she has soothed my feet with perfume.
- 46 You did not put oil on my head, but she has poured perfume on my feet.
- 47 Impressive, isn't it? She was forgiven many, many sins, and so she is very, very grateful. If the forgiveness is minimal, the gratitude is minimal."
- 47 Therefore, I tell you, her many sins have been forgiven--for she loved much. But he who has been forgiven little loves little."
- 48 Then he spoke to her: "I forgive your sins."
- 48 Then Jesus said to her, "Your sins are forgiven."
- 49 That set the dinner guests talking behind his back: "Who does he think he is, forgiving sins!"
- 49 The other guests began to say among themselves, "Who is this who even forgives sins?"
- 50 He ignored them and said to the woman, "Your faith has saved you. Go in peace."
- 50 Jesus said to the woman, "Your faith has saved you; go in peace."

Luke 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 He continued according to plan, traveled to town after town, village after village, preaching God's kingdom, spreading the Message. The Twelve

were with him.

- 1 After this, Jesus traveled about from one town and village to another, proclaiming the good news of the kingdom of God. The Twelve were with him,
- 2 There were also some women in their company who had been healed of various evil afflictions and illnesses: Mary, the one called Magdalene, from whom seven demons had gone out;
- 2 and also some women who had been cured of evil spirits and diseases: Mary (called Magdalene) from whom seven demons had come out;
- 3 Joanna, wife of Chuza, Herod's manager; and Susanna--along with many others who used their considerable means to provide for the company.
- 3 Joanna the wife of Cuza, the manager of Herod's household; Susanna; and many others. These women were helping to support them out of their own means.
- 4 As they went from town to town, a lot of people joined in and traveled along. He addressed them, using this story:
- 4 While a large crowd was gathering and people were coming to Jesus from town after town, he told this parable:
- 5 "A farmer went out to sow his seed. Some of it fell on the road; it was tramped down and the birds ate it.
- 5 A farmer went out to sow his seed. As he was scattering the seed, some fell along the path; it was trampled on, and the birds of the air ate it up.
- 6 Other seed fell in the gravel; it sprouted, but withered because it didn't have good roots.
- 6 Some fell on rock, and when it came up, the plants withered because they had no moisture.
- 7 Other seed fell in the weeds; the weeds grew with it and strangled it.
- 7 Other seed fell among thorns, which grew up with it and choked the plants.
- 8 Other seed fell in rich earth and produced a bumper crop. "Are you listening to this? Really listening?"
- 8 Still other seed fell on good soil. It came up and yielded a crop, a hundred times more than was sown." When he said this, he called out, "He who has ears to hear, let him hear."
- 9 His disciples asked, "Why did you tell this story?"
- 9 His disciples asked him what this parable meant.

- 10 He said, "You've been given insight into God's kingdom--you know how it works. There are others who need stories. But even with stories some of them aren't going to get it: Their eyes are open but don't see a thing, Their ears are open but don't hear a thing.
- 10 He said, "The knowledge of the secrets of the kingdom of God has been given to you, but to others I speak in parables, so that, " 'though seeing, they may not see; though hearing, they may not understand.'
- 11 "This story is about some of those people. The seed is the Word of God.
- 11 This is the meaning of the parable: The seed is the word of God.
- 12 The seeds on the road are those who hear the Word, but no sooner do they hear it than the Devil snatches it from them so they won't believe and be saved.
- 12 Those along the path are the ones who hear, and then the devil comes and takes away the word from their hearts, so that they may not believe and be saved.
- 13 "The seeds in the gravel are those who hear with enthusiasm, but the enthusiasm doesn't go very deep. It's only another fad, and the moment there's trouble it's gone.
- 13 Those on the rock are the ones who receive the word with joy when they hear it, but they have no root. They believe for a while, but in the time of testing they fall away.
- 14 "And the seed that fell in the weeds--well, these are the ones who hear, but then the seed is crowded out and nothing comes of it as they go about their lives worrying about tomorrow, making money, and having fun.
- 14 The seed that fell among thorns stands for those who hear, but as they go on their way they are choked by life's worries, riches and pleasures, and they do not mature.
- 15 "But the seed in the good earth--these are the good-hearts who seize the Word and hold on no matter what, sticking with it until there's a harvest.
- 15 But the seed on good soil stands for those with a noble and good heart, who hear the word, retain it, and by persevering produce a crop.
- 16 "No one lights a lamp and then covers it with a washtub or shoves it under the bed. No, you set it up on a lamp stand so those who enter the room can see their way.

- 16 No one lights a lamp and hides it in a jar or puts it under a bed. Instead, he puts it on a stand, so that those who come in can see the light.
- 17 We're not keeping secrets; we're telling them. We're not hiding things; we're bringing everything out into the open.
- 17 For there is nothing hidden that will not be disclosed, and nothing concealed that will not be known or brought out into the open.
- 18 So be careful that you don't become misers of what you hear. Generosity begets generosity. Stinginess impoverishes."
- 18 Therefore consider carefully how you listen. Whoever has will be given more; whoever does not have, even what he thinks he has will be taken from him."
- 19 His mother and brothers showed up but couldn't get through to him because of the crowd.
- 19 Now Jesus' mother and brothers came to see him, but they were not able to get near him because of the crowd.
- 20 He was given the message, "Your mother and brothers are standing outside wanting to see you."
- 20 Someone told him, "Your mother and brothers are standing outside, wanting to see you."
- 21 He replied, "My mother and brothers are the ones who hear and do God's Word. Obedience is thicker than blood."
- 21 He replied, "My mother and brothers are those who hear God's word and put it into practice."
- 22 One day he and his disciples got in a boat. "Let's cross the lake," he said. And off they went.
- 22 One day Jesus said to his disciples, "Let's go over to the other side of the lake." So they got into a boat and set out.
- 23 It was smooth sailing, and he fell asleep. A terrific storm came up suddenly on the lake. Water poured in, and they were about to capsize.
- 23 As they sailed, he fell asleep. A squall came down on the lake, so that the boat was being swamped, and they were in great danger.
- 24 They woke Jesus: "Master, Master, we're going to drown!" Getting to his feet, he told the wind, "Silence!" and the waves, "Quiet down!" They did it. The lake became smooth as glass.
- 24 The disciples went and woke him, saying, "Master, Master, we're going to drown!" He got up and rebuked the wind and the raging waters; the

storm subsided, and all was calm.

25 Then he said to his disciples, "Why can't you trust me?" They were in absolute awe, staggered and stammering, "Who is this, anyway? He calls out to the winds and sea, and they do what he tells them!"

25 Where is your faith? he asked his disciples. In fear and amazement they asked one another, "Who is this? He commands even the winds and the water, and they obey him."

26 They sailed on to the country of the Gerasenes, directly opposite Galilee.

26 They sailed to the region of the Gerasenes, which is across the lake from Galilee.

27 As he stepped out onto land, a madman from town met him; he was a victim of demons. He hadn't worn clothes for a long time, nor lived at home; he lived in the cemetery.

27 When Jesus stepped ashore, he was met by a demon-possessed man from the town. For a long time this man had not worn clothes or lived in a house, but had lived in the tombs.

28 When he saw Jesus he screamed, fell before him, and bellowed, "What business do you have messing with me? You're Jesus, Son of the High God, but don't give me a hard time!"

28 When he saw Jesus, he cried out and fell at his feet, shouting at the top of his voice, "What do you want with me, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I beg you, don't torture me!"

29 (The man said this because Jesus had started to order the unclean spirit out of him.) Time after time the demon threw the man into convulsions. He had been placed under constant guard and tied with chains and shackles, but crazed and driven wild by the demon, he would shatter the bonds.

29 For Jesus had commanded the evil spirit to come out of the man. Many times it had seized him, and though he was chained hand and foot and kept under guard, he had broken his chains and had been driven by the demon into solitary places.

30 Jesus asked him, "What is your name?" "Mob. My name is Mob," he said, because many demons afflicted him.

30 Jesus asked him, "What is your name?" "Legion," he replied, because many demons had gone into him.

31 And they begged Jesus desperately not to order them to the bottomless pit.

31 And they begged him repeatedly not to order them to go into the Abyss.

32 A large herd of pigs was browsing and rooting on a nearby hill. The demons begged Jesus to order them into the pigs. He gave the order.

32 A large herd of pigs was feeding there on the hillside. The demons begged Jesus to let them go into them, and he gave them permission.

33 It was even worse for the pigs than for the man. Crazy, they stampeded over a cliff into the lake and drowned.

33 When the demons came out of the man, they went into the pigs, and the herd rushed down the steep bank into the lake and was drowned.

34 Those tending the pigs, scared to death, bolted and told their story in town and country.

34 When those tending the pigs saw what had happened, they ran off and reported this in the town and countryside,

35 People went out to see what had happened. They came to Jesus and found the man from whom the demons had been sent, sitting there at Jesus' feet, wearing decent clothes and making sense. It was a holy moment, and for a short time they were more reverent than curious.

35 and the people went out to see what had happened. When they came to Jesus, they found the man from whom the demons had gone out, sitting at Jesus' feet, dressed and in his right mind; and they were afraid.

36 Then those who had seen it happen told how the demoniac had been saved.

36 Those who had seen it told the people how the demon-possessed man had been cured.

37 Later, a great many people from the Gerasene countryside got together and asked Jesus to leave--too much change, too fast, and they were scared. So Jesus got back in the boat and set off.

37 Then all the people of the region of the Gerasenes asked Jesus to leave them, because they were overcome with fear. So he got into the boat and left.

38 The man whom he had delivered from the demons asked to go with him, but he sent him back, saying,

38 The man from whom the demons had gone out begged to go with him, but Jesus sent him away, saying,

39 "Go home and tell everything God did in you." So he went back and preached all over town everything Jesus had done in him.

39 Return home and tell how much God has done for you. So the man went away and told all over town how much Jesus had done for him.

40 On his return, Jesus was welcomed by a crowd. They were all there expecting him.

40 Now when Jesus returned, a crowd welcomed him, for they were all expecting him.

41 A man came up, Jairus by name. He was president of the meeting place. He fell at Jesus' feet and begged him to come to his home

41 Then a man named Jairus, a ruler of the synagogue, came and fell at Jesus' feet, pleading with him to come to his house

42 because his twelve-year-old daughter, his only child, was dying. Jesus went with him, making his way through the pushing, jostling crowd.

42 because his only daughter, a girl of about twelve, was dying. As Jesus was on his way, the crowds almost crushed him.

43 In the crowd that day there was a woman who for twelve years had been afflicted with hemorrhages. She had spent every penny she had on doctors but not one had been able to help her.

43 And a woman was there who had been subject to bleeding for twelve years, but no one could heal her.

44 She slipped in from behind and touched the edge of Jesus' robe. At that very moment her hemorrhaging stopped.

44 She came up behind him and touched the edge of his cloak, and immediately her bleeding stopped.

45 Jesus said, "Who touched me?" When no one stepped forward, Peter said, "But Master, we've got crowds of people on our hands. Dozens have touched you."

45 Who touched me? Jesus asked. When they all denied it, Peter said, "Master, the people are crowding and pressing against you."

46 Jesus insisted, "Someone touched me. I felt power discharging from me."

46 But Jesus said, "Someone touched me; I know that power has gone out from me."

47 When the woman realized that she couldn't remain hidden, she knelt trembling before him. In front of all the people, she blurted out her story-

-why she touched him and how at that same moment she was healed.

47 Then the woman, seeing that she could not go unnoticed, came trembling and fell at his feet. In the presence of all the people, she told why she had touched him and how she had been instantly healed.

48 Jesus said, "Daughter, you took a risk trusting me, and now you're healed and whole. Live well, live blessed!"

48 Then he said to her, "Daughter, your faith has healed you. Go in peace."

49 While he was still talking, someone from the leader's house came up and told him, "Your daughter died. No need now to bother the Teacher."

49 While Jesus was still speaking, someone came from the house of Jairus, the synagogue ruler. "Your daughter is dead," he said. "Don't bother the teacher any more."

50 Jesus overheard and said, "Don't be upset. Just trust me and everything will be all right."

50 Hearing this, Jesus said to Jairus, "Don't be afraid; just believe, and she will be healed."

51 Going into the house, he wouldn't let anyone enter with him except Peter, John, James, and the child's parents.

51 When he arrived at the house of Jairus, he did not let anyone go in with him except Peter, John and James, and the child's father and mother.

52 Everyone was crying and carrying on over her. Jesus said, "Don't cry. She didn't die; she's sleeping."

52 Meanwhile, all the people were wailing and mourning for her. "Stop wailing," Jesus said. "She is not dead but asleep."

53 They laughed at him. They knew she was dead.

53 They laughed at him, knowing that she was dead.

54 Then Jesus, gripping her hand, called, "My dear child, get up."

54 But he took her by the hand and said, "My child, get up!"

55 She was up in an instant, up and breathing again! He told them to give her something to eat.

55 Her spirit returned, and at once she stood up. Then Jesus told them to give her something to eat.

56 Her parents were ecstatic, but Jesus warned them to keep quiet. "Don't tell a soul what happened in this room."

56 Her parents were astonished, but he ordered them not to tell anyone what had happened.

Luke 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jesus now called the Twelve and gave them authority and power to deal with all the demons and cure diseases.
- 1 When Jesus had called the Twelve together, he gave them power and authority to drive out all demons and to cure diseases,
- 2 He commissioned them to preach the news of God's kingdom and heal the sick.
- 2 and he sent them out to preach the kingdom of God and to heal the sick.
- 3 He said, "Don't load yourselves up with equipment.
- 3 He told them: "Take nothing for the journey--no staff, no bag, no bread, no money, no extra tunic.
- 4 Keep it simple; you are the equipment. And no luxury inns--get a modest place and be content there until you leave.
- 4 Whatever house you enter, stay there until you leave that town.
- 5 If you're not welcomed, leave town. Don't make a scene. Shrug your shoulders and move on."
- 5 If people do not welcome you, shake the dust off your feet when you leave their town, as a testimony against them."
- 6 Commissioned, they left. They traveled from town to town telling the latest news of God, the Message, and curing people everywhere they went.
- 6 So they set out and went from village to village, preaching the gospel and healing people everywhere.
- 7 Herod, the ruler, heard of these goings on and didn't know what to think. There were people saying John had come back from the dead,
- 7 Now Herod the tetrarch heard about all that was going on. And he was perplexed, because some were saying that John had been raised from the dead,
- 8 others that Elijah had appeared, still others that some prophet of long ago had shown up.
- 8 others that Elijah had appeared, and still others that one of the prophets of long ago had come back to life.

- 9 Herod said, "But I killed John--took off his head. So who is this that I keep hearing about?" Curious, he looked for a chance to see him in action.
- 9 But Herod said, "I beheaded John. Who, then, is this I hear such things about?" And he tried to see him.
- 10 The apostles returned and reported on what they had done. Jesus took them away, off by themselves, near the town called Bethsaida.
- 10 When the apostles returned, they reported to Jesus what they had done. Then he took them with him and they withdrew by themselves to a town called Bethsaida,
- 11 But the crowds got wind of it and followed. Jesus graciously welcomed them and talked to them about the kingdom of God. Those who needed healing, he healed.
- 11 but the crowds learned about it and followed him. He welcomed them and spoke to them about the kingdom of God, and healed those who needed healing.
- 12 As the day declined, the Twelve said, "Dismiss the crowd so they can go to the farms or villages around here and get a room for the night and a bite to eat. We're out in the middle of nowhere."
- 12 Late in the afternoon the Twelve came to him and said, "Send the crowd away so they can go to the surrounding villages and countryside and find food and lodging, because we are in a remote place here."
- 13 "You feed them," Jesus said. They said, "We couldn't scrape up more than five loaves of bread and a couple of fish--unless, of course, you want us to go to town ourselves and buy food for everybody."
- 13 He replied, "You give them something to eat." They answered, "We have only five loaves of bread and two fish-- unless we go and buy food for all this crowd."
- 14 (There were more than five thousand people in the crowd.) But he went ahead and directed his disciples, "Sit them down in groups of about fifty."
- 14 (About five thousand men were there.) But he said to his disciples, "Have them sit down in groups of about fifty each."
- 15 They did what he said, and soon had everyone seated.
- 15 The disciples did so, and everybody sat down.

- 16 He took the five loaves and two fish, lifted his face to heaven in prayer, blessed, broke, and gave the bread and fish to the disciples to hand out to the crowd.
- 16 Taking the five loaves and the two fish and looking up to heaven, he gave thanks and broke them. Then he gave them to the disciples to set before the people.
- 17 After the people had all eaten their fill, twelve baskets of leftovers were gathered up.
- 17 They all ate and were satisfied, and the disciples picked up twelve basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over.
- 18 One time when Jesus was off praying by himself, his disciples nearby, he asked them, "What are the crowds saying about me, about who I am?"
- 18 Once when Jesus was praying in private and his disciples were with him, he asked them, "Who do the crowds say I am?"
- 19 They said, "John the Baptizer. Others say Elijah. Still others say that one of the prophets from long ago has come back."
- 19 They replied, "Some say John the Baptist; others say Elijah; and still others, that one of the prophets of long ago has come back to life."
- 20 He then asked, "And you--what are you saying about me? Who am I?" Peter answered, "The Messiah of God."
- 20 But what about you? he asked. "Who do you say I am?" Peter answered, "The Christ of God."
- 21 Jesus then warned them to keep it quiet. They were to tell no one what Peter had said.
- 21 Jesus strictly warned them not to tell this to anyone.
- 22 He went on, "It is necessary that the Son of Man proceed to an ordeal of suffering, be tried and found guilty by the religious leaders, high priests, and religion scholars, be killed, and on the third day be raised up alive."
- 22 And he said, "The Son of Man must suffer many things and be rejected by the elders, chief priests and teachers of the law, and he must be killed and on the third day be raised to life."
- 23 Then he told them what they could expect for themselves: "Anyone who intends to come with me has to let me lead. You're not in the driver's seat--I am. Don't run from suffering; embrace it. Follow me and I'll show you how."

- 23 Then he said to them all: "If anyone would come after me, he must deny himself and take up his cross daily and follow me.
- 24 Self-help is no help at all. Self-sacrifice is the way, my way, to finding yourself, your true self.
- 24 For whoever wants to save his life will lose it, but whoever loses his life for me will save it.
- 25 What good would it do to get everything you want and lose you, the real you?
- 25 What good is it for a man to gain the whole world, and yet lose or forfeit his very self?
- 26 If any of you is embarrassed with me and the way I'm leading you, know that the Son of Man will be far more embarrassed with you when he arrives in all his splendor in company with the Father and the holy angels. This isn't, you realize, pie in the sky by and by.
- 26 If anyone is ashamed of me and my words, the Son of Man will be ashamed of him when he comes in his glory and in the glory of the Father and of the holy angels.
- 27 Some who have taken their stand right here are going to see it happen, see with their own eyes the kingdom of God."
- 27 I tell you the truth, some who are standing here will not taste death before they see the kingdom of God."
- 28 About eight days after saying this, he climbed the mountain to pray, taking Peter, John, and James along.
- 28 About eight days after Jesus said this, he took Peter, John and James with him and went up onto a mountain to pray.
- 29 While he was in prayer, the appearance of his face changed and his clothes became blinding white.
- 29 As he was praying, the appearance of his face changed, and his clothes became as bright as a flash of lightning.
- 30 At once two men were there talking with him. They turned out to be Moses and Elijah--
- 30 Two men, Moses and Elijah,
- 31 and what a glorious appearance they made! They talked over his exodus, the one Jesus was about to complete in Jerusalem.
- 31 appeared in glorious splendor, talking with Jesus. They spoke about his departure, which he was about to bring to fulfillment at Jerusalem.

- 32 Meanwhile, Peter and those with him were slumped over in sleep. When they came to, rubbing their eyes, they saw Jesus in his glory and the two men standing with him.
- 32 Peter and his companions were very sleepy, but when they became fully awake, they saw his glory and the two men standing with him.
- 33 When Moses and Elijah had left, Peter said to Jesus, "Master, this is a great moment! Let's build three memorials: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah." He blurted this out without thinking.
- 33 As the men were leaving Jesus, Peter said to him, "Master, it is good for us to be here. Let us put up three shelters-- one for you, one for Moses and one for Elijah." (He did not know what he was saying.)
- 34 While he was babbling on like this, a light-radiant cloud enveloped them. As they found themselves buried in the cloud, they became deeply aware of God.
- 34 While he was speaking, a cloud appeared and enveloped them, and they were afraid as they entered the cloud.
- 35 Then there was a voice out of the cloud: "This is my Son, the Chosen! Listen to him."
- 35 A voice came from the cloud, saying, "This is my Son, whom I have chosen; listen to him."
- 36 When the sound of the voice died away, they saw Jesus there alone. They were speechless. And they continued speechless, said not one thing to anyone during those days of what they had seen.
- 36 When the voice had spoken, they found that Jesus was alone. The disciples kept this to themselves, and told no one at that time what they had seen.
- 37 When they came down off the mountain the next day, a big crowd was there to meet them.
- 37 The next day, when they came down from the mountain, a large crowd met him.
- 38 A man called from out of the crowd, "Please, please, Teacher, take a look at my son. He's my only child.
- 38 A man in the crowd called out, "Teacher, I beg you to look at my son, for he is my only child.
- 39 Often a spirit seizes him. Suddenly he's screaming, thrown into convulsions, his mouth foaming. And then it beats him black and blue

before it leaves.

39 A spirit seizes him and he suddenly screams; it throws him into convulsions so that he foams at the mouth. It scarcely ever leaves him and is destroying him.

40 I asked your disciples to deliver him but they couldn't."

40 I begged your disciples to drive it out, but they could not."

41 Jesus said, "What a generation! No sense of God! No focus to your lives! How many times do I have to go over these things? How much longer do I have to put up with this? Bring your son here."

41 O unbelieving and perverse generation, Jesus replied, "how long shall I stay with you and put up with you? Bring your son here."

42 While he was coming, the demon slammed him to the ground and threw him into convulsions. Jesus stepped in, ordered the vile spirit gone, healed the boy, and handed him back to his father.

42 Even while the boy was coming, the demon threw him to the ground in a convulsion. But Jesus rebuked the evil spirit, healed the boy and gave him back to his father.

43 They all shook their heads in wonder, astonished at God's greatness, God's majestic greatness. While they continued to stand around exclaiming over all the things he was doing, Jesus said to his disciples,

43 And they were all amazed at the greatness of God. While everyone was marveling at all that Jesus did, he said to his disciples,

44 "Treasure and ponder each of these next words: The Son of Man is about to be betrayed into human hands."

44 Listen carefully to what I am about to tell you: The Son of Man is going to be betrayed into the hands of men.

45 They didn't get what he was saying. It was like he was speaking a foreign language and they couldn't make heads or tails of it. But they were embarrassed to ask him what he meant.

45 But they did not understand what this meant. It was hidden from them, so that they did not grasp it, and they were afraid to ask him about it.

46 They started arguing over which of them would be most famous.

46 An argument started among the disciples as to which of them would be the greatest.

47 When Jesus realized how much this mattered to them, he brought a child to his side.

47 Jesus, knowing their thoughts, took a little child and had him stand beside him.

48 "Whoever accepts this child as if the child were me, accepts me," he said. "And whoever accepts me, accepts the One who sent me. You become great by accepting, not asserting. Your spirit, not your size, makes the difference."

48 Then he said to them, "Whoever welcomes this little child in my name welcomes me; and whoever welcomes me welcomes the one who sent me. For he who is least among you all--he is the greatest."

49 John spoke up, "Master, we saw a man using your name to expel demons and we stopped him because he wasn't of our group."

49 Master, said John, "we saw a man driving out demons in your name and we tried to stop him, because he is not one of us."

50 Jesus said, "Don't stop him. If he's not an enemy, he's an ally."

50 Do not stop him, Jesus said, "for whoever is not against you is for you."

51 When it came close to the time for his Ascension, he gathered up his courage and steeled himself for the journey to Jerusalem.

51 As the time approached for him to be taken up to heaven, Jesus resolutely set out for Jerusalem.

52 He sent messengers on ahead. They came to a Samaritan village to make arrangements for his hospitality.

52 And he sent messengers on ahead, who went into a Samaritan village to get things ready for him;

53 But when the Samaritans learned that his destination was Jerusalem, they refused hospitality.

53 but the people there did not welcome him, because he was heading for Jerusalem.

54 When the disciples James and John learned of it, they said, "Master, do you want us to call a bolt of lightning down out of the sky and incinerate them?"

54 When the disciples James and John saw this, they asked, "Lord, do you want us to call fire down from heaven to destroy them?"

55 Jesus turned on them: "Of course not!"

55 But Jesus turned and rebuked them,

56 And they traveled on to another village.

56 and they went to another village.

- 57 On the road someone asked if he could go along. "I'll go with you, wherever," he said.
- 57 As they were walking along the road, a man said to him, "I will follow you wherever you go."
- 58 Jesus was curt: "Are you ready to rough it? We're not staying in the best inns, you know."
- 58 Jesus replied, "Foxes have holes and birds of the air have nests, but the Son of Man has no place to lay his head."
- 59 Jesus said to another, "Follow me." He said, "Certainly, but first excuse me for a couple of days, please. I have to make arrangements for my father's funeral."
- 59 He said to another man, "Follow me." But the man replied, "Lord, first let me go and bury my father."
- 60 Jesus refused. "First things first. Your business is life, not death. And life is urgent: Announce God's kingdom!"
- 60 Jesus said to him, "Let the dead bury their own dead, but you go and proclaim the kingdom of God."
- 61 Then another said, "I'm ready to follow you, Master, but first excuse me while I get things straightened out at home."
- 61 Still another said, "I will follow you, Lord; but first let me go back and say good-by to my family."
- 62 Jesus said, "No procrastination. No backward looks. You can't put God's kingdom off till tomorrow. Seize the day."
- 62 Jesus replied, "No one who puts his hand to the plow and looks back is fit for service in the kingdom of God."

Luke 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Later the Master selected seventy and sent them ahead of him in pairs to every town and place where he intended to go.
- 1 After this the Lord appointed seventy-two others and sent them two by two ahead of him to every town and place where he was about to go.
- 2 He gave them this charge: "What a huge harvest! And how few the harvest hands. So on your knees; ask the God of the Harvest to send

harvest hands.

- 2 He told them, "The harvest is plentiful, but the workers are few. Ask the Lord of the harvest, therefore, to send out workers into his harvest field.
- 3 "On your way! But be careful--this is hazardous work. You're like lambs in a wolf pack.
- 3 Go! I am sending you out like lambs among wolves.
- 4 "Travel light. Comb and toothbrush and no extra luggage. "Don't loiter and make small talk with everyone you meet along the way.
- 4 Do not take a purse or bag or sandals; and do not greet anyone on the road.
- 5 "When you enter a home, greet the family, 'Peace.'
- 5 When you enter a house, first say, 'Peace to this house.'
- 6 If your greeting is received, then it's a good place to stay. But if it's not received, take it back and get out. Don't impose yourself.
- 6 If a man of peace is there, your peace will rest on him; if not, it will return to you.
- 7 "Stay at one home, taking your meals there, for a worker deserves three square meals. Don't move from house to house, looking for the best cook in town.
- 7 Stay in that house, eating and drinking whatever they give you, for the worker deserves his wages. Do not move around from house to house.
- 8 "When you enter a town and are received, eat what they set before you,
- 8 When you enter a town and are welcomed, eat what is set before you.
- 9 heal anyone who is sick, and tell them, 'God's kingdom is right on your doorstep!'
- 9 Heal the sick who are there and tell them, 'The kingdom of God is near you.'
- 10 "When you enter a town and are not received, go out in the street and say,
- 10 But when you enter a town and are not welcomed, go into its streets and say,
- 11 'The only thing we got from you is the dirt on our feet, and we're giving it back. Did you have any idea that God's kingdom was right on your doorstep?'
- 11 'Even the dust of your town that sticks to our feet we wipe off against you. Yet be sure of this: The kingdom of God is near.'

- 12 Sodom will have it better on Judgment Day than the town that rejects you.
- 12 I tell you, it will be more bearable on that day for Sodom than for that town.
- 13 "Doom, Chorazin! Doom, Bethsaida! If Tyre and Sidon had been given half the chances given you, they'd have been on their knees long ago, repenting and crying for mercy.
- 13 Woe to you, Korazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! For if the miracles that were performed in you had been performed in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.
- 14 Tyre and Sidon will have it easy on Judgment Day compared to you.
- 14 But it will be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon at the judgment than for you.
- 15 "And you, Capernaum! Do you think you're about to be promoted to heaven? Think again. You're on a mud slide to hell.
- 15 And you, Capernaum, will you be lifted up to the skies? No, you will go down to the depths.
- 16 "The one who listens to you, listens to me. The one who rejects you, rejects me. And rejecting me is the same as rejecting God, who sent me."
- 16 He who listens to you listens to me; he who rejects you rejects me; but he who rejects me rejects him who sent me.
- 17 The seventy came back triumphant. "Master, even the demons danced to your tune!"
- 17 The seventy-two returned with joy and said, "Lord, even the demons submit to us in your name."
- 18 Jesus said, "I know. I saw Satan fall, a bolt of lightning out of the sky.
- 18 He replied, "I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven.
- 19 See what I've given you? Safe passage as you walk on snakes and scorpions, and protection from every assault of the Enemy. No one can put a hand on you.
- 19 I have given you authority to trample on snakes and scorpions and to overcome all the power of the enemy; nothing will harm you.
- 20 All the same, the great triumph is not in your authority over evil, but in God's authority over you and presence with you. Not what you do for God but what God does for you--that's the agenda for rejoicing."

- 20 However, do not rejoice that the spirits submit to you, but rejoice that your names are written in heaven."
- 21 At that, Jesus rejoiced, exuberant in the Holy Spirit. "I thank you, Father, Master of heaven and earth, that you hid these things from the know-it-alls and showed them to these innocent newcomers. Yes, Father, it pleased you to do it this way.
- 21 At that time Jesus, full of joy through the Holy Spirit, said, "I praise you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because you have hidden these things from the wise and learned, and revealed them to little children. Yes, Father, for this was your good pleasure.
- 22 "I've been given it all by my Father! Only the Father knows who the Son is and only the Son knows who the Father is. The Son can introduce the Father to anyone he wants to."
- 22 All things have been committed to me by my Father. No one knows who the Son is except the Father, and no one knows who the Father is except the Son and those to whom the Son chooses to reveal him.
- 23 He then turned in a private aside to his disciples. "Fortunate the eyes that see what you're seeing!
- 23 Then he turned to his disciples and said privately, "Blessed are the eyes that see what you see.
- 24 There are plenty of prophets and kings who would have given their right arm to see what you are seeing but never got so much as a glimpse, to hear what you are hearing but never got so much as a whisper."
- 24 For I tell you that many prophets and kings wanted to see what you see but did not see it, and to hear what you hear but did not hear it."
- 25 Just then a religion scholar stood up with a question to test Jesus. "Teacher, what do I need to do to get eternal life?"
- 25 On one occasion an expert in the law stood up to test Jesus. "Teacher," he asked, "what must I do to inherit eternal life?"
- 26 He answered, "What's written in God's Law? How do you interpret it?"
- 26 What is written in the Law? he replied. "How do you read it?"
- 27 He said, "That you love the Lord your God with all your passion and prayer and muscle and intelligence--and that you love your neighbor as well as you do yourself."
- 27 He answered: " 'Love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your strength and with all your mind' ; and, 'Love

- your neighbor as yourself.' "
- 28 "Good answer!" said Jesus. "Do it and you'll live."
- 28 You have answered correctly, Jesus replied. "Do this and you will live."
- 29 Looking for a loophole, he asked, "And just how would you define 'neighbor'?"
- 29 But he wanted to justify himself, so he asked Jesus, "And who is my neighbor?"
- 30 Jesus answered by telling a story. "There was once a man traveling from Jerusalem to Jericho. On the way he was attacked by robbers. They took his clothes, beat him up, and went off leaving him half-dead.
- 30 In reply Jesus said: "A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho, when he fell into the hands of robbers. They stripped him of his clothes, beat him and went away, leaving him half dead.
- 31 Luckily, a priest was on his way down the same road, but when he saw him he angled across to the other side.
- 31 A priest happened to be going down the same road, and when he saw the man, he passed by on the other side.
- 32 Then a Levite religious man showed up; he also avoided the injured man.
- 32 So too, a Levite, when he came to the place and saw him, passed by on the other side.
- 33 "A Samaritan traveling the road came on him. When he saw the man's condition, his heart went out to him.
- 33 But a Samaritan, as he traveled, came where the man was; and when he saw him, he took pity on him.
- 34 He gave him first aid, disinfecting and bandaging his wounds. Then he lifted him onto his donkey, led him to an inn, and made him comfortable.
- 34 He went to him and bandaged his wounds, pouring on oil and wine. Then he put the man on his own donkey, took him to an inn and took care of him.
- 35 In the morning he took out two silver coins and gave them to the innkeeper, saying, 'Take good care of him. If it costs any more, put it on my bill--I'll pay you on my way back.'
- 35 The next day he took out two silver coins and gave them to the innkeeper. 'Look after him,' he said, 'and when I return, I will reimburse you for any extra expense you may have.'

- 36 "What do you think? Which of the three became a neighbor to the man attacked by robbers?"
- 36 Which of these three do you think was a neighbor to the man who fell into the hands of robbers?
- 37 "The one who treated him kindly," the religion scholar responded. Jesus said, "Go and do the same."
- 37 The expert in the law replied, "The one who had mercy on him." Jesus told him, "Go and do likewise."
- 38 As they continued their travel, Jesus entered a village. A woman by the name of Martha welcomed him and made him feel quite at home.
- 38 As Jesus and his disciples were on their way, he came to a village where a woman named Martha opened her home to him.
- 39 She had a sister, Mary, who sat before the Master, hanging on every word he said.
- 39 She had a sister called Mary, who sat at the Lord's feet listening to what he said.
- 40 But Martha was pulled away by all she had to do in the kitchen. Later, she stepped in, interrupting them. "Master, don't you care that my sister has abandoned the kitchen to me? Tell her to lend me a hand."
- 40 But Martha was distracted by all the preparations that had to be made. She came to him and asked, "Lord, don't you care that my sister has left me to do the work by myself? Tell her to help me!"
- 41 The Master said, "Martha, dear Martha, you're fussing far too much and getting yourself worked up over nothing.
- 41 Martha, Martha, the Lord answered, "you are worried and upset about many things,
- 42 One thing only is essential, and Mary has chosen it--it's the main course, and won't be taken from her."
- 42 but only one thing is needed. Mary has chosen what is better, and it will not be taken away from her."

Luke 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 One day he was praying in a certain place. When he finished, one of his disciples said, "Master, teach us to pray just as John taught his disciples."
- 1 One day Jesus was praying in a certain place. When he finished, one of his disciples said to him, "Lord, teach us to pray, just as John taught his disciples."
- 2 So he said, "When you pray, say, Father, Reveal who you are. Set the world right.
- 2 He said to them, "When you pray, say: " 'Father, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come.
- 3 Keep us alive with three square meals.
- 3 Give us each day our daily bread.
- 4 Keep us forgiven with you and forgiving others. Keep us safe from ourselves and the Devil."
- 4 Forgive us our sins, for we also forgive everyone who sins against us. And lead us not into temptation. ' "
- 5 Then he said, "Imagine what would happen if you went to a friend in the middle of the night and said, 'Friend, lend me three loaves of bread.
- 5 Then he said to them, "Suppose one of you has a friend, and he goes to him at midnight and says, 'Friend, lend me three loaves of bread,
- 6 An old friend traveling through just showed up, and I don't have a thing on hand.'
- 6 because a friend of mine on a journey has come to me, and I have nothing to set before him.'
- 7 "The friend answers from his bed, 'Don't bother me. The door's locked; my children are all down for the night; I can't get up to give you anything.'
- 7 Then the one inside answers, 'Don't bother me. The door is already locked, and my children are with me in bed. I can't get up and give you anything.'
- 8 "But let me tell you, even if he won't get up because he's a friend, if you stand your ground, knocking and waking all the neighbors, he'll finally get up and get you whatever you need.
- 8 I tell you, though he will not get up and give him the bread because he is his friend, yet because of the man's boldness he will get up and give him as much as he needs.

- 9 "Here's what I'm saying: Ask and you'll get; Seek and you'll find; Knock and the door will open.
- 9 So I say to you: Ask and it will be given to you; seek and you will find; knock and the door will be opened to you.
- 10 "Don't bargain with God. Be direct. Ask for what you need. This is not a cat-and-mouse, hide-and-seek game we're in.
- 10 For everyone who asks receives; he who seeks finds; and to him who knocks, the door will be opened.
- 11 If your little boy asks for a serving of fish, do you scare him with a live snake on his plate?
- 11 Which of you fathers, if your son asks for a fish, will give him a snake instead?
- 12 If your little girl asks for an egg, do you trick her with a spider?
- 12 Or if he asks for an egg, will give him a scorpion?
- 13 As bad as you are, you wouldn't think of such a thing--you're at least decent to your own children. And don't you think the Father who conceived you in love will give the Holy Spirit when you ask him?"
- 13 If you then, though you are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father in heaven give the Holy Spirit to those who ask him!"
- 14 Jesus delivered a man from a demon that had kept him speechless. The demon gone, the man started talking a blue streak, taking the crowd by complete surprise.
- 14 Jesus was driving out a demon that was mute. When the demon left, the man who had been mute spoke, and the crowd was amazed.
- 15 But some from the crowd were cynical. "Black magic," they said. "Some devil trick he's pulled from his sleeve."
- 15 But some of them said, "By Beelzebub, the prince of demons, he is driving out demons."
- 16 Others were skeptical, waiting around for him to prove himself with a spectacular miracle.
- 16 Others tested him by asking for a sign from heaven.
- 17 Jesus knew what they were thinking and said, "Any country in civil war for very long is wasted. A constantly squabbling family falls to pieces.
- 17 Jesus knew their thoughts and said to them: "Any kingdom divided against itself will be ruined, and a house divided against itself will fall.

- 18 If Satan cancels Satan, is there any Satan left? You accuse me of ganging up with the Devil, the prince of demons, to cast out demons,
- 18 If Satan is divided against himself, how can his kingdom stand? I say this because you claim that I drive out demons by Beelzebub.
- 19 but if you're slinging devil mud at me, calling me a devil who kicks out devils, doesn't the same mud stick to your own exorcists?
- 19 Now if I drive out demons by Beelzebub, by whom do your followers drive them out? So then, they will be your judges.
- 20 But if it's God's finger I'm pointing that sends the demons on their way, then God's kingdom is here for sure.
- 20 But if I drive out demons by the finger of God, then the kingdom of God has come to you.
- 21 "When a strong man, armed to the teeth, stands guard in his front yard, his property is safe and sound.
- 21 When a strong man, fully armed, guards his own house, his possessions are safe.
- 22 But what if a stronger man comes along with superior weapons? Then he's beaten at his own game, the arsenal that gave him such confidence hauled off, and his precious possessions plundered.
- 22 But when someone stronger attacks and overpowers him, he takes away the armor in which the man trusted and divides up the spoils.
- 23 "This is war, and there is no neutral ground. If you're not on my side, you're the enemy; if you're not helping, you're making things worse.
- 23 He who is not with me is against me, and he who does not gather with me, scatters.
- 24 "When a corrupting spirit is expelled from someone, it drifts along through the desert looking for an oasis, some unsuspecting soul it can bedevil. When it doesn't find anyone, it says, 'I'll go back to my old haunt.'
- 24 When an evil spirit comes out of a man, it goes through arid places seeking rest and does not find it. Then it says, 'I will return to the house I left.'
- 25 On return, it finds the person swept and dusted, but vacant.
- 25 When it arrives, it finds the house swept clean and put in order.
- 26 It then runs out and rounds up seven other spirits dirtier than itself and they all move in, whooping it up. That person ends up far worse than if

- he'd never gotten cleaned up in the first place."
- 26 Then it goes and takes seven other spirits more wicked than itself, and they go in and live there. And the final condition of that man is worse than the first."
- 27 While he was saying these things, some woman lifted her voice above the murmur of the crowd: "Blessed the womb that carried you, and the breasts at which you nursed!"
- 27 As Jesus was saying these things, a woman in the crowd called out, "Blessed is the mother who gave you birth and nursed you."
- 28 Jesus commented, "Even more blessed are those who hear God's Word and guard it with their lives!"
- 28 He replied, "Blessed rather are those who hear the word of God and obey it."
- 29 As the crowd swelled, he took a fresh tack: "The mood of this age is all wrong. Everybody's looking for proof, but you're looking for the wrong kind. All you're looking for is something to titillate your curiosity, satisfy your lust for miracles. But the only proof you're going to get is the Jonah-proof given to the Ninevites, which looks like no proof at all.
- 29 As the crowds increased, Jesus said, "This is a wicked generation. It asks for a miraculous sign, but none will be given it except the sign of Jonah.
- 30 What Jonah was to Nineveh, the Son of Man is to this age.
- 30 For as Jonah was a sign to the Ninevites, so also will the Son of Man be to this generation.
- 31 "On Judgment Day the Ninevites will stand up and give evidence that will condemn this generation, because when Jonah preached to them they changed their lives. A far greater preacher than Jonah is here, and you squabble about 'proofs.'
- 31 The Queen of the South will rise at the judgment with the men of this generation and condemn them; for she came from the ends of the earth to listen to Solomon's wisdom, and now one greater than Solomon is here.
- 32 On Judgment Day the Queen of Sheba will come forward and bring evidence that condemns this generation, because she traveled from a far corner of the earth to listen to wise Solomon. Wisdom far greater than Solomon's is right in front of you, and you quibble over 'evidence.'

- 32 The men of Nineveh will stand up at the judgment with this generation and condemn it; for they repented at the preaching of Jonah, and now one greater than Jonah is here.
- 33 "No one lights a lamp, then hides it in a drawer. It's put on a lamp stand so those entering the room have light to see where they're going.
- 33 No one lights a lamp and puts it in a place where it will be hidden, or under a bowl. Instead he puts it on its stand, so that those who come in may see the light.
- 34 Your eye is a lamp, lighting up your whole body. If you live wide-eyed in wonder and belief, your body fills up with light. If you live squinty-eyed in greed and distrust, your body is a dank cellar.
- 34 Your eye is the lamp of your body. When your eyes are good, your whole body also is full of light. But when they are bad, your body also is full of darkness.
- 35 Keep your eyes open, your lamp burning, so you don't get musty and murky.
- 35 See to it, then, that the light within you is not darkness.
- 36 Keep your life as well-lighted as your best-lighted room."
- 36 Therefore, if your whole body is full of light, and no part of it dark, it will be completely lighted, as when the light of a lamp shines on you."
- 37 When he finished that talk, a Pharisee asked him to dinner. He entered his house and sat right down at the table.
- 37 When Jesus had finished speaking, a Pharisee invited him to eat with him; so he went in and reclined at the table.
- 38 The Pharisee was shocked and somewhat offended when he saw that Jesus didn't wash up before the meal.
- 38 But the Pharisee, noticing that Jesus did not first wash before the meal, was surprised.
- 39 But the Master said to him, "I know you Pharisees burnish the surface of your cups and plates so they sparkle in the sun, but I also know your insides are maggoty with greed and secret evil.
- 39 Then the Lord said to him, "Now then, you Pharisees clean the outside of the cup and dish, but inside you are full of greed and wickedness.
- 40 Stupid Pharisees! Didn't the One who made the outside also make the inside?

- 40 You foolish people! Did not the one who made the outside make the inside also?
- 41 Turn both your pockets and your hearts inside out and give generously to the poor; then your lives will be clean, not just your dishes and your hands.
- 41 But give what is inside the dish to the poor, and everything will be clean for you.
- 42 "I've had it with you! You're hopeless, you Pharisees! Frauds! You keep meticulous account books, tithing on every nickel and dime you get, but manage to find loopholes for getting around basic matters of justice and God's love. Careful bookkeeping is commendable, but the basics are required.
- 42 Woe to you Pharisees, because you give God a tenth of your mint, rue and all other kinds of garden herbs, but you neglect justice and the love of God. You should have practiced the latter without leaving the former undone.
- 43 "You're hopeless, you Pharisees! Frauds! You love sitting at the head table at church dinners, love preening yourselves in the radiance of public flattery.
- 43 Woe to you Pharisees, because you love the most important seats in the synagogues and greetings in the marketplaces.
- 44 Frauds! You're just like unmarked graves: People walk over that nice, grassy surface, never suspecting the rot and corruption that is six feet under."
- 44 Woe to you, because you are like unmarked graves, which men walk over without knowing it.
- 45 One of the religion scholars spoke up: "Teacher, do you realize that in saying these things you're insulting us?"
- 45 One of the experts in the law answered him, "Teacher, when you say these things, you insult us also."
- 46 He said, "Yes, and I can be even more explicit. You're hopeless, you religion scholars! You load people down with rules and regulations, nearly breaking their backs, but never lift even a finger to help.
- 46 Jesus replied, "And you experts in the law, woe to you, because you load people down with burdens they can hardly carry, and you yourselves will not lift one finger to help them.

47 "You're hopeless! You build tombs for the prophets your ancestors killed.

47 Woe to you, because you build tombs for the prophets, and it was your forefathers who killed them.

48 The tombs you build are monuments to your murdering ancestors more than to the murdered prophets.

48 So you testify that you approve of what your forefathers did; they killed the prophets, and you build their tombs.

49 That accounts for God's Wisdom saying, 'I will send them prophets and apostles, but they'll kill them and run them off.'

49 Because of this, God in his wisdom said, 'I will send them prophets and apostles, some of whom they will kill and others they will persecute.'

50 What it means is that every drop of righteous blood ever spilled from the time earth began until now,.

50 Therefore this generation will be held responsible for the blood of all the prophets that has been shed since the beginning of the world,

51 from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah, who was struck down between altar and sanctuary, is on your heads. Yes, it's on the bill of this generation and this generation will pay.

51 from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah, who was killed between the altar and the sanctuary. Yes, I tell you, this generation will be held responsible for it all.

52 "You're hopeless, you religion scholars! You took the key of knowledge, but instead of unlocking doors, you locked them. You won't go in yourself, and won't let anyone else in either."

52 Woe to you experts in the law, because you have taken away the key to knowledge. You yourselves have not entered, and you have hindered those who were entering.

53 As soon as Jesus left the table, the religion scholars and Pharisees went into a rage. They went over and over everything he said,

53 When Jesus left there, the Pharisees and the teachers of the law began to oppose him fiercely and to besiege him with questions,

54 plotting how they could trap him in something from his own mouth.

54 waiting to catch him in something he might say.

Luke 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 By this time the crowd, unwieldy and stepping on each other's toes, numbered into the thousands. But Jesus' primary concern was his disciples. He said to them, "Watch yourselves carefully so you don't get contaminated with Pharisee yeast, Pharisee phoniness.
- 1 Meanwhile, when a crowd of many thousands had gathered, so that they were trampling on one another, Jesus began to speak first to his disciples, saying: "Be on your guard against the yeast of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy.
- 2 You can't keep your true self hidden forever; before long you'll be exposed. You can't hide behind a religious mask forever; sooner or later the mask will slip and your true face will be known.
- 2 There is nothing concealed that will not be disclosed, or hidden that will not be made known.
- 3 You can't whisper one thing in private and preach the opposite in public; the day's coming when those whispers will be repeated all over town.
- 3 What you have said in the dark will be heard in the daylight, and what you have whispered in the ear in the inner rooms will be proclaimed from the roofs.
- 4 "I'm speaking to you as dear friends. Don't be bluffed into silence or insincerity by the threats of religious bullies. True, they can kill you, but then what can they do? There's nothing they can do to your soul, your core being.
- 4 I tell you, my friends, do not be afraid of those who kill the body and after that can do no more.
- 5 Save your fear for God, who holds your entire life--body and soul--in his hands.
- 5 But I will show you whom you should fear: Fear him who, after the killing of the body, has power to throw you into hell. Yes, I tell you, fear him.
- 6 "What's the price of two or three pet canaries? Some loose change, right? But God never overlooks a single one.

- 6 Are not five sparrows sold for two pennies? Yet not one of them is forgotten by God.
- 7 And he pays even greater attention to you, down to the last detail--even numbering the hairs on your head! So don't be intimidated by all this bully talk. You're worth more than a million canaries.
- 7 Indeed, the very hairs of your head are all numbered. Don't be afraid; you are worth more than many sparrows.
- 8 "Stand up for me among the people you meet and the Son of Man will stand up for you before all God's angels.
- 8 I tell you, whoever acknowledges me before men, the Son of Man will also acknowledge him before the angels of God.
- 9 But if you pretend you don't know me, do you think I'll defend you before God's angels?
- 9 But he who disowns me before men will be disowned before the angels of God.
- 10 "If you bad-mouth the Son of Man out of misunderstanding or ignorance, that can be overlooked. But if you're knowingly attacking God himself, taking aim at the Holy Spirit, that won't be overlooked.
- 10 And everyone who speaks a word against the Son of Man will be forgiven, but anyone who blasphemes against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven.
- 11 "When they drag you into their meeting places, or into police courts and before judges, don't worry about defending yourselves--what you'll say or how you'll say it.
- 11 When you are brought before synagogues, rulers and authorities, do not worry about how you will defend yourselves or what you will say,
- 12 The right words will be there. The Holy Spirit will give you the right words when the time comes."
- 12 for the Holy Spirit will teach you at that time what you should say."
- 13 Someone out of the crowd said, "Teacher, order my brother to give me a fair share of the family inheritance."
- 13 Someone in the crowd said to him, "Teacher, tell my brother to divide the inheritance with me."
- 14 He replied, "Mister, what makes you think it's any of my business to be a judge or mediator for you?"

- 14 Jesus replied, "Man, who appointed me a judge or an arbiter between you?"
- 15 Speaking to the people, he went on, "Take care! Protect yourself against the least bit of greed. Life is not defined by what you have, even when you have a lot."
- 15 Then he said to them, "Watch out! Be on your guard against all kinds of greed; a man's life does not consist in the abundance of his possessions."
- 16 Then he told them this story: "The farm of a certain rich man produced a terrific crop.
- 16 And he told them this parable: "The ground of a certain rich man produced a good crop.
- 17 He talked to himself: 'What can I do? My barn isn't big enough for this harvest.'
- 17 He thought to himself, 'What shall I do? I have no place to store my crops.'
- 18 Then he said, 'Here's what I'll do: I'll tear down my barns and build bigger ones. Then I'll gather in all my grain and goods,
- 18 Then he said, 'This is what I'll do. I will tear down my barns and build bigger ones, and there I will store all my grain and my goods.
- 19 and I'll say to myself, Self, you've done well! You've got it made and can now retire. Take it easy and have the time of your life!'
- 19 And I'll say to myself, "You have plenty of good things laid up for many years. Take life easy; eat, drink and be merry." '
- 20 "Just then God showed up and said, 'Fool! Tonight you die. And your barnful of goods--who gets it?'
- 20 But God said to him, 'You fool! This very night your life will be demanded from you. Then who will get what you have prepared for yourself?'
- 21 "That's what happens when you fill your barn with Self and not with God."
- 21 This is how it will be with anyone who stores up things for himself but is not rich toward God.
- 22 He continued this subject with his disciples. "Don't fuss about what's on the table at mealtimes or if the clothes in your closet are in fashion.
- 22 Then Jesus said to his disciples: "Therefore I tell you, do not worry about your life, what you will eat; or about your body, what you will

wear.

23 There is far more to your inner life than the food you put in your stomach, more to your outer appearance than the clothes you hang on your body.

23 Life is more than food, and the body more than clothes.

24 Look at the ravens, free and unfettered, not tied down to a job description, carefree in the care of God. And you count far more.

24 Consider the ravens: They do not sow or reap, they have no storeroom or barn; yet God feeds them. And how much more valuable you are than birds!

25 "Has anyone by fussing before the mirror ever gotten taller by so much as an inch?

25 Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?

26 If fussing can't even do that, why fuss at all?

26 Since you cannot do this very little thing, why do you worry about the rest?

27 Walk into the fields and look at the wildflowers. They don't fuss with their appearance--but have you ever seen color and design quite like it? The ten best-dressed men and women in the country look shabby alongside them.

27 Consider how the lilies grow. They do not labor or spin. Yet I tell you, not even Solomon in all his splendor was dressed like one of these.

28 If God gives such attention to the wildflowers, most of them never even seen, don't you think he'll attend to you, take pride in you, do his best for you?

28 If that is how God clothes the grass of the field, which is here today, and tomorrow is thrown into the fire, how much more will he clothe you, O you of little faith!

29 "What I'm trying to do here is get you to relax, not be so preoccupied with getting so you can respond to God's giving.

29 And do not set your heart on what you will eat or drink; do not worry about it.

30 People who don't know God and the way he works fuss over these things, but you know both God and how he works.

30 For the pagan world runs after all such things, and your Father knows that you need them.

- 31 Steep yourself in God-reality, God-initiative, God-provisions. You'll find all your everyday human concerns will be met.
- 31 But seek his kingdom, and these things will be given to you as well.
- 32 Don't be afraid of missing out. You're my dearest friends! The Father wants to give you the very kingdom itself.
- 32 Do not be afraid, little flock, for your Father has been pleased to give you the kingdom.
- 33 "Be generous. Give to the poor. Get yourselves a bank that can't go bankrupt, a bank in heaven far from bankrobbers, safe from embezzlers, a bank you can bank on.
- 33 Sell your possessions and give to the poor. Provide purses for yourselves that will not wear out, a treasure in heaven that will not be exhausted, where no thief comes near and no moth destroys.
- 34 It's obvious, isn't it? The place where your treasure is, is the place you will most want to be, and end up being.
- 34 For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.
- 35 "Keep your shirts on; keep the lights on!
- 35 Be dressed ready for service and keep your lamps burning,
- 36 Be like house servants waiting for their master to come back from his honeymoon, awake and ready to open the door when he arrives and knocks.
- 36 like men waiting for their master to return from a wedding banquet, so that when he comes and knocks they can immediately open the door for him.
- 37 Lucky the servants whom the master finds on watch! He'll put on an apron, sit them at the table, and serve them a meal, sharing his wedding feast with them.
- 37 It will be good for those servants whose master finds them watching when he comes. I tell you the truth, he will dress himself to serve, will have them recline at the table and will come and wait on them.
- 38 It doesn't matter what time of the night he arrives; they're awake--and so blessed!
- 38 It will be good for those servants whose master finds them ready, even if he comes in the second or third watch of the night.
- 39 "You know that if the house owner had known what night the burglar was coming, he wouldn't have stayed out late and left the place

unlocked.

39 But understand this: If the owner of the house had known at what hour the thief was coming, he would not have let his house be broken into.

40 So don't you be slovenly and careless. Just when you don't expect him, the Son of Man will show up."

40 You also must be ready, because the Son of Man will come at an hour when you do not expect him."

41 Peter said, "Master, are you telling this story just for us? Or is it for everybody?"

41 Peter asked, "Lord, are you telling this parable to us, or to everyone?"

42 The Master said, "Let me ask you: Who is the dependable manager, full of common sense, that the master puts in charge of his staff to feed them well and on time?

42 The Lord answered, "Who then is the faithful and wise manager, whom the master puts in charge of his servants to give them their food allowance at the proper time?

43 He is a blessed man if when the master shows up he's doing his job.

43 It will be good for that servant whom the master finds doing so when he returns.

44 (SEE 12:43)

44 I tell you the truth, he will put him in charge of all his possessions.

45 But if he says to himself, 'The master is certainly taking his time,' begins maltreating the servants and maids, throws parties for his friends, and gets drunk,

45 But suppose the servant says to himself, 'My master is taking a long time in coming,' and he then begins to beat the menservants and maidservants and to eat and drink and get drunk.

46 the master will walk in when he least expects it, give him the thrashing of his life, and put him back in the kitchen peeling potatoes.

46 The master of that servant will come on a day when he does not expect him and at an hour he is not aware of. He will cut him to pieces and assign him a place with the unbelievers.

47 "The servant who knows what his master wants and ignores it, or insolently does whatever he pleases, will be thoroughly thrashed.

47 That servant who knows his master's will and does not get ready or does not do what his master wants will be beaten with many blows.

- 48 But if he does a poor job through ignorance, he'll get off with a slap on the hand. Great gifts mean great responsibilities; greater gifts, greater responsibilities!
- 48 But the one who does not know and does things deserving punishment will be beaten with few blows. From everyone who has been given much, much will be demanded; and from the one who has been entrusted with much, much more will be asked.
- 49 "I've come to start a fire on this earth--how I wish it were blazing right now!
- 49 I have come to bring fire on the earth, and how I wish it were already kindled!
- 50 I've come to change everything, turn everything rightside up--how I long for it to be finished!
- 50 But I have a baptism to undergo, and how distressed I am until it is completed!
- 51 Do you think I came to smooth things over and make everything nice? Not so. I've come to disrupt and confront!
- 51 Do you think I came to bring peace on earth? No, I tell you, but division.
- 52 From now on, when you find five in a house, it will be-- Three against two, and two against three;
- 52 From now on there will be five in one family divided against each other, three against two and two against three.
- 53 Father against son, and son against father; Mother against daughter, and daughter against mother; Mother-in-law against bride, and bride against mother-in-law."
- 53 They will be divided, father against son and son against father, mother against daughter and daughter against mother, mother-in-law against daughter-in-law and daughter-in-law against mother-in-law."
- 54 Then he turned to the crowd: "When you see clouds coming in from the west, you say, 'Storm's coming'--and you're right.
- 54 He said to the crowd: "When you see a cloud rising in the west, immediately you say, 'It's going to rain,' and it does.
- 55 And when the wind comes out of the south, you say, 'This'll be a hot one'--and you're right.
- 55 And when the south wind blows, you say, 'It's going to be hot,' and it is.

56 Frauds! You know how to tell a change in the weather, so don't tell me you can't tell a change in the season, the God-season we're in right now.

56 Hypocrites! You know how to interpret the appearance of the earth and the sky. How is it that you don't know how to interpret this present time?

57 "You don't have to be a genius to understand these things. Just use your common sense,

57 Why don't you judge for yourselves what is right?

58 the kind you'd use if, while being taken to court, you decided to settle up with your accuser on the way, knowing that if the case went to the judge you'd probably go to jail

58 As you are going with your adversary to the magistrate, try hard to be reconciled to him on the way, or he may drag you off to the judge, and the judge turn you over to the officer, and the officer throw you into prison.

59 and pay every last penny of the fine. That's the kind of decision I'm asking you to make."

59 I tell you, you will not get out until you have paid the last penny. "

Luke 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 About that time some people came up and told him about the Galileans Pilate had killed while they were at worship, mixing their blood with the blood of the sacrifices on the altar.
- 1 Now there were some present at that time who told Jesus about the Galileans whose blood Pilate had mixed with their sacrifices.
- 2 Jesus responded, "Do you think those murdered Galileans were worse sinners than all other Galileans?"
- 2 Jesus answered, "Do you think that these Galileans were worse sinners than all the other Galileans because they suffered this way?"
- 3 Not at all. Unless you turn to God, you too will die.
- 3 I tell you, no! But unless you repent, you too will all perish.
- 4 And those eighteen in Jerusalem the other day, the ones crushed and killed when the Tower of Siloam collapsed and fell on them, do you think they were worse citizens than all other Jerusalemites?
- 4 Or those eighteen who died when the tower in Siloam fell on them--do you think they were more guilty than all the others living in Jerusalem?
- 5 Not at all. Unless you turn to God, you too will die."
- 5 I tell you, no! But unless you repent, you too will all perish."
- 6 Then he told them a story: "A man had an apple tree planted in his front yard. He came to it expecting to find apples, but there weren't any.
- 6 Then he told this parable: "A man had a fig tree, planted in his vineyard, and he went to look for fruit on it, but did not find any.
- 7 He said to his gardener, 'What's going on here? For three years now I've come to this tree expecting apples and not one apple have I found. Chop it down! Why waste good ground with it any longer?'
- 7 So he said to the man who took care of the vineyard, 'For three years now I've been coming to look for fruit on this fig tree and haven't found any. Cut it down! Why should it use up the soil?'
- 8 "The gardener said, 'Let's give it another year. I'll dig around it and fertilize,

- 8 'Sir,' the man replied, 'leave it alone for one more year, and I'll dig around it and fertilize it.
- 9 and maybe it will produce next year; if it doesn't, then chop it down.' "
- 9 If it bears fruit next year, fine! If not, then cut it down.' "
- 10 He was teaching in one of the meeting places on the Sabbath.
- 10 On a Sabbath Jesus was teaching in one of the synagogues,
- 11 There was a woman present, so twisted and bent over with arthritis that she couldn't even look up. She had been afflicted with this for eighteen years.
- 11 and a woman was there who had been crippled by a spirit for eighteen years. She was bent over and could not straighten up at all.
- 12 When Jesus saw her, he called her over. "Woman, you're free!"
- 12 When Jesus saw her, he called her forward and said to her, "Woman, you are set free from your infirmity."
- 13 He laid hands on her and suddenly she was standing straight and tall, giving glory to God.
- 13 Then he put his hands on her, and immediately she straightened up and praised God.
- 14 The meeting-place president, furious because Jesus had healed on the Sabbath, said to the congregation, "Six days have been defined as work days. Come on one of the six if you want to be healed, but not on the seventh, the Sabbath."
- 14 Indignant because Jesus had healed on the Sabbath, the synagogue ruler said to the people, "There are six days for work. So come and be healed on those days, not on the Sabbath."
- 15 But Jesus shot back, "You frauds! Each Sabbath every one of you regularly unties your cow or donkey from its stall, leads it out for water, and thinks nothing of it.
- 15 The Lord answered him, "You hypocrites! Doesn't each of you on the Sabbath untie his ox or donkey from the stall and lead it out to give it water?
- 16 So why isn't it all right for me to untie this daughter of Abraham and lead her from the stall where Satan has had her tied these eighteen years?"
- 16 Then should not this woman, a daughter of Abraham, whom Satan has kept bound for eighteen long years, be set free on the Sabbath day from

what bound her?"

17 When he put it that way, his critics were left looking quite silly and red-faced. The congregation was delighted and cheered him on.

17 When he said this, all his opponents were humiliated, but the people were delighted with all the wonderful things he was doing.

18 Then he said, "How can I picture God's kingdom for you? What kind of story can I use?"

18 Then Jesus asked, "What is the kingdom of God like? What shall I compare it to?"

19 It's like a pine nut that a man plants in his front yard. It grows into a huge pine tree with thick branches, and eagles build nests in it."

19 It is like a mustard seed, which a man took and planted in his garden. It grew and became a tree, and the birds of the air perched in its branches."

20 He tried again. "How can I picture God's kingdom?"

20 Again he asked, "What shall I compare the kingdom of God to?"

21 It's like yeast that a woman works into enough dough for three loaves of bread--and waits while the dough rises."

21 It is like yeast that a woman took and mixed into a large amount of flour until it worked all through the dough."

22 He went on teaching from town to village, village to town, but keeping on a steady course toward Jerusalem.

22 Then Jesus went through the towns and villages, teaching as he made his way to Jerusalem.

23 A bystander said, "Master, will only a few be saved?" He said,

23 Someone asked him, "Lord, are only a few people going to be saved?" He said to them,

24 "Whether few or many is none of your business. Put your mind on your life with God. The way to life--to God!--is vigorous and requires your total attention. A lot of you are going to assume that you'll sit down to God's salvation banquet just because you've been hanging around the neighborhood all your lives.

24 Make every effort to enter through the narrow door, because many, I tell you, will try to enter and will not be able to.

25 Well, one day you're going to be banging on the door, wanting to get in, but you'll find the door locked and the Master saying, 'Sorry, you're not on my guest list.'

25 Once the owner of the house gets up and closes the door, you will stand outside knocking and pleading, 'Sir, open the door for us.' "But he will answer, 'I don't know you or where you come from.'

26 "You'll protest, 'But we've known you all our lives!'

26 Then you will say, 'We ate and drank with you, and you taught in our streets.'

27 only to be interrupted with his abrupt, 'Your kind of knowing can hardly be called knowing. You don't know the first thing about me.'

27 But he will reply, 'I don't know you or where you come from. Away from me, all you evildoers!'

28 "That's when you'll find yourselves out in the cold, strangers to grace. You'll watch Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and all the prophets march into God's kingdom.

28 There will be weeping there, and gnashing of teeth, when you see Abraham, Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets in the kingdom of God, but you yourselves thrown out.

29 You'll watch outsiders stream in from east, west, north, and south and sit down at the table of God's kingdom. And all the time you'll be outside looking in--and wondering what happened.

29 People will come from east and west and north and south, and will take their places at the feast in the kingdom of God.

30 This is the Great Reversal: the last in line put at the head of the line, and the so-called first ending up last.

30 Indeed there are those who are last who will be first, and first who will be last."

31 Just then some Pharisees came up and said, "Run for your life! Herod's on the hunt. He's out to kill you!"

31 At that time some Pharisees came to Jesus and said to him, "Leave this place and go somewhere else. Herod wants to kill you."

32 Jesus said, "Tell that fox that I've no time for him right now. Today and tomorrow I'm busy clearing out the demons and healing the sick; the third day I'm wrapping things up.

32 He replied, "Go tell that fox, 'I will drive out demons and heal people today and tomorrow, and on the third day I will reach my goal.'

33 Besides, it's not proper for a prophet to come to a bad end outside Jerusalem.

- 33 In any case, I must keep going today and tomorrow and the next day-- for surely no prophet can die outside Jerusalem!
- 34 Jerusalem, Jerusalem, killer of prophets, abuser of the messengers of God! How often I've longed to gather your children, gather your children like a hen, Her brood safe under her wings-- but you refused and turned away!
- 34 O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, you who kill the prophets and stone those sent to you, how often I have longed to gather your children together, as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings, but you were not willing!
- 35 And now it's too late: You won't see me again until the day you say, 'Blessed is he who comes in the name of God.'
- 35 Look, your house is left to you desolate. I tell you, you will not see me again until you say, 'Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.' "

Luke 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 One time when Jesus went for a Sabbath meal with one of the top leaders of the Pharisees, all the guests had their eyes on him, watching his every move.
- 1 One Sabbath, when Jesus went to eat in the house of a prominent Pharisee, he was being carefully watched.
- 2 Right before him there was a man hugely swollen in his joints.
- 2 There in front of him was a man suffering from dropsy.
- 3 So Jesus asked the religion scholars and Pharisees present, "Is it permitted to heal on the Sabbath? Yes or no?"
- 3 Jesus asked the Pharisees and experts in the law, "Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath or not?"
- 4 They were silent. So he took the man, healed him, and sent him on his way.
- 4 But they remained silent. So taking hold of the man, he healed him and sent him away.
- 5 Then he said, "Is there anyone here who, if a child or animal fell down a well, wouldn't rush to pull him out immediately, not asking whether or not it was the Sabbath?"

- 5 Then he asked them, "If one of you has a son or an ox that falls into a well on the Sabbath day, will you not immediately pull him out?"
- 6 They were stumped. There was nothing they could say to that.
- 6 And they had nothing to say.
- 7 He went on to tell a story to the guests around the table. Noticing how each had tried to elbow into the place of honor, he said,
- 7 When he noticed how the guests picked the places of honor at the table, he told them this parable:
- 8 "When someone invites you to dinner, don't take the place of honor. Somebody more important than you might have been invited by the host.
- 8 When someone invites you to a wedding feast, do not take the place of honor, for a person more distinguished than you may have been invited.
- 9 Then he'll come and call out in front of everybody, 'You're in the wrong place. The place of honor belongs to this man.' Red-faced, you'll have to make your way to the very last table, the only place left.
- 9 If so, the host who invited both of you will come and say to you, 'Give this man your seat.' Then, humiliated, you will have to take the least important place.
- 10 "When you're invited to dinner, go and sit at the last place. Then when the host comes he may very well say, 'Friend, come up to the front.' That will give the dinner guests something to talk about!
- 10 But when you are invited, take the lowest place, so that when your host comes, he will say to you, 'Friend, move up to a better place.' Then you will be honored in the presence of all your fellow guests.
- 11 What I'm saying is, If you walk around with your nose in the air, you're going to end up flat on your face. But if you're content to be simply yourself, you will become more than yourself."
- 11 For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and he who humbles himself will be exalted."
- 12 Then he turned to the host. "The next time you put on a dinner, don't just invite your friends and family and rich neighbors, the kind of people who will return the favor.
- 12 Then Jesus said to his host, "When you give a luncheon or dinner, do not invite your friends, your brothers or relatives, or your rich neighbors; if you do, they may invite you back and so you will be repaid.

- 13 Invite some people who never get invited out, the misfits from the wrong side of the tracks.
- 13 But when you give a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, the blind,
- 14 You'll be--and experience--a blessing. They won't be able to return the favor, but the favor will be returned--oh, how it will be returned!--at the resurrection of God's people."
- 14 and you will be blessed. Although they cannot repay you, you will be repaid at the resurrection of the righteous."
- 15 That triggered a response from one of the guests: "How fortunate the one who gets to eat dinner in God's kingdom!"
- 15 When one of those at the table with him heard this, he said to Jesus, "Blessed is the man who will eat at the feast in the kingdom of God."
- 16 Jesus followed up. "Yes. For there was once a man who threw a great dinner party and invited many.
- 16 Jesus replied: "A certain man was preparing a great banquet and invited many guests.
- 17 When it was time for dinner, he sent out his servant to the invited guests, saying, 'Come on in; the food's on the table.'
- 17 At the time of the banquet he sent his servant to tell those who had been invited, 'Come, for everything is now ready.'
- 18 "Then they all began to beg off, one after another making excuses. The first said, 'I bought a piece of property and need to look it over. Send my regrets.'
- 18 But they all alike began to make excuses. The first said, 'I have just bought a field, and I must go and see it. Please excuse me.'
- 19 "Another said, 'I just bought five teams of oxen, and I really need to check them out. Send my regrets.'
- 19 Another said, 'I have just bought five yoke of oxen, and I'm on my way to try them out. Please excuse me.'
- 20 "And yet another said, 'I just got married and need to get home to my wife.'
- 20 Still another said, 'I just got married, so I can't come.'
- 21 "The servant went back and told the master what had happened. He was outraged and told the servant, 'Quickly, get out into the city streets and alleys. Collect all who look like they need a square meal, all the misfits

and homeless and wretched you can lay your hands on, and bring them here.'

21 The servant came back and reported this to his master. Then the owner of the house became angry and ordered his servant, 'Go out quickly into the streets and alleys of the town and bring in the poor, the crippled, the blind and the lame.'

22 "The servant reported back, 'Master, I did what you commanded--and there's still room.'

22 'Sir,' the servant said, 'what you ordered has been done, but there is still room.'

23 "The master said, 'Then go to the country roads. Whoever you find, drag them in. I want my house full!'

23 Then the master told his servant, 'Go out to the roads and country lanes and make them come in, so that my house will be full.'

24 Let me tell you, not one of those originally invited is going to get so much as a bite at my dinner party."

24 I tell you, not one of those men who were invited will get a taste of my banquet.' "

25 One day when large groups of people were walking along with him, Jesus turned and told them,

25 Large crowds were traveling with Jesus, and turning to them he said:

26 "Anyone who comes to me but refuses to let go of father, mother, spouse, children, brothers, sisters--yes, even one's own self!--can't be my disciple.

26 If anyone comes to me and does not hate his father and mother, his wife and children, his brothers and sisters--yes, even his own life--he cannot be my disciple.

27 Anyone who won't shoulder his own cross and follow behind me can't be my disciple.

27 And anyone who does not carry his cross and follow me cannot be my disciple.

28 "Is there anyone here who, planning to build a new house, doesn't first sit down and figure the cost so you'll know if you can complete it?

28 Suppose one of you wants to build a tower. Will he not first sit down and estimate the cost to see if he has enough money to complete it?

- 29 If you only get the foundation laid and then run out of money, you're going to look pretty foolish. Everyone passing by will poke fun at you:
- 29 For if he lays the foundation and is not able to finish it, everyone who sees it will ridicule him,
- 30 'He started something he couldn't finish.'
- 30 saying, 'This fellow began to build and was not able to finish.'
- 31 "Or can you imagine a king going into battle against another king without first deciding whether it is possible with his ten thousand troops to face the twenty thousand troops of the other?
- 31 Or suppose a king is about to go to war against another king. Will he not first sit down and consider whether he is able with ten thousand men to oppose the one coming against him with twenty thousand?
- 32 And if he decides he can't, won't he send an emissary and work out a truce?
- 32 If he is not able, he will send a delegation while the other is still a long way off and will ask for terms of peace.
- 33 "Simply put, if you're not willing to take what is dearest to you, whether plans or people, and kiss it good-bye, you can't be my disciple.
- 33 In the same way, any of you who does not give up everything he has cannot be my disciple.
- 34 "Salt is excellent. But if the salt goes flat, it's useless, good for nothing. "Are you listening to this? Really listening?"
- 34 Salt is good, but if it loses its saltiness, how can it be made salty again?
- 35 (SEE 14:34)
- 35 It is fit neither for the soil nor for the manure pile; it is thrown out. "He who has ears to hear, let him hear."

Luke 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 By this time a lot of men and women of doubtful reputation were hanging around Jesus, listening intently.
- 1 Now the tax collectors and "sinners" were all gathering around to hear him.

- 2 The Pharisees and religion scholars were not pleased, not at all pleased. They growled, "He takes in sinners and eats meals with them, treating them like old friends."
- 2 But the Pharisees and the teachers of the law muttered, "This man welcomes sinners and eats with them."
- 3 Their grumbling triggered this story.
- 3 Then Jesus told them this parable:
- 4 "Suppose one of you had a hundred sheep and lost one. Wouldn't you leave the ninety-nine in the wilderness and go after the lost one until you found it?"
- 4 Suppose one of you has a hundred sheep and loses one of them. Does he not leave the ninety-nine in the open country and go after the lost sheep until he finds it?
- 5 When found, you can be sure you would put it across your shoulders, rejoicing,
- 5 And when he finds it, he joyfully puts it on his shoulders
- 6 and when you got home call in your friends and neighbors, saying, 'Celebrate with me! I've found my lost sheep!'
- 6 and goes home. Then he calls his friends and neighbors together and says, 'Rejoice with me; I have found my lost sheep.'
- 7 Count on it--there's more joy in heaven over one sinner's rescued life than over ninety-nine good people in no need of rescue.
- 7 I tell you that in the same way there will be more rejoicing in heaven over one sinner who repents than over ninety-nine righteous persons who do not need to repent.
- 8 "Or imagine a woman who has ten coins and loses one. Won't she light a lamp and scour the house, looking in every nook and cranny until she finds it?"
- 8 Or suppose a woman has ten silver coins and loses one. Does she not light a lamp, sweep the house and search carefully until she finds it?
- 9 And when she finds it you can be sure she'll call her friends and neighbors: 'Celebrate with me! I found my lost coin!'
- 9 And when she finds it, she calls her friends and neighbors together and says, 'Rejoice with me; I have found my lost coin.'
- 10 Count on it--that's the kind of party God's angels throw every time one lost soul turns to God."

- 10 In the same way, I tell you, there is rejoicing in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner who repents."
- 11 Then he said, "There was once a man who had two sons.
- 11 Jesus continued: "There was a man who had two sons.
- 12 The younger said to his father, 'Father, I want right now what's coming to me.' "So the father divided the property between them.
- 12 The younger one said to his father, 'Father, give me my share of the estate.' So he divided his property between them.
- 13 It wasn't long before the younger son packed his bags and left for a distant country. There, undisciplined and dissipated, he wasted everything he had.
- 13 Not long after that, the younger son got together all he had, set off for a distant country and there squandered his wealth in wild living.
- 14 After he had gone through all his money, there was a bad famine all through that country and he began to hurt.
- 14 After he had spent everything, there was a severe famine in that whole country, and he began to be in need.
- 15 He signed on with a citizen there who assigned him to his fields to slop the pigs.
- 15 So he went and hired himself out to a citizen of that country, who sent him to his fields to feed pigs.
- 16 He was so hungry he would have eaten the cobs in the pig slop, but no one would give him any.
- 16 He longed to fill his stomach with the pods that the pigs were eating, but no one gave him anything.
- 17 "That brought him to his senses. He said, 'All those farmhands working for my father sit down to three meals a day, and here I am starving to death.
- 17 When he came to his senses, he said, 'How many of my father's hired men have food to spare, and here I am starving to death!
- 18 I'm going back to my father. I'll say to him, Father, I've sinned against God, I've sinned before you;
- 18 I will set out and go back to my father and say to him: Father, I have sinned against heaven and against you.
- 19 I don't deserve to be called your son. Take me on as a hired hand.'

- 19 I am no longer worthy to be called your son; make me like one of your hired men.'
- 20 He got right up and went home to his father. "When he was still a long way off, his father saw him. His heart pounding, he ran out, embraced him, and kissed him.
- 20 So he got up and went to his father. "But while he was still a long way off, his father saw him and was filled with compassion for him; he ran to his son, threw his arms around him and kissed him.
- 21 The son started his speech: 'Father, I've sinned against God, I've sinned before you; I don't deserve to be called your son ever again.'
- 21 The son said to him, 'Father, I have sinned against heaven and against you. I am no longer worthy to be called your son. '
- 22 "But the father wasn't listening. He was calling to the servants, 'Quick. Bring a clean set of clothes and dress him. Put the family ring on his finger and sandals on his feet.
- 22 But the father said to his servants, 'Quick! Bring the best robe and put it on him. Put a ring on his finger and sandals on his feet.
- 23 Then get a grain-fed heifer and roast it. We're going to feast! We're going to have a wonderful time!
- 23 Bring the fattened calf and kill it. Let's have a feast and celebrate.
- 24 My son is here--given up for dead and now alive! Given up for lost and now found!' And they began to have a wonderful time.
- 24 For this son of mine was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found.' So they began to celebrate.
- 25 "All this time his older son was out in the field. When the day's work was done he came in. As he approached the house, he heard the music and dancing.
- 25 Meanwhile, the older son was in the field. When he came near the house, he heard music and dancing.
- 26 Calling over one of the houseboys, he asked what was going on.
- 26 So he called one of the servants and asked him what was going on.
- 27 He told him, 'Your brother came home. Your father has ordered a feast--barbecued beef!--because he has him home safe and sound.'
- 27 'Your brother has come,' he replied, 'and your father has killed the fattened calf because he has him back safe and sound.'

- 28 "The older brother stalked off in an angry sulk and refused to join in. His father came out and tried to talk to him, but he wouldn't listen.
- 28 The older brother became angry and refused to go in. So his father went out and pleaded with him.
- 29 The son said, 'Look how many years I've stayed here serving you, never giving you one moment of grief, but have you ever thrown a party for me and my friends?
- 29 But he answered his father, 'Look! All these years I've been slaving for you and never disobeyed your orders. Yet you never gave me even a young goat so I could celebrate with my friends.
- 30 Then this son of yours who has thrown away your money on whores shows up and you go all out with a feast!'
- 30 But when this son of yours who has squandered your property with prostitutes comes home, you kill the fattened calf for him!'
- 31 "His father said, 'Son, you don't understand. You're with me all the time, and everything that is mine is yours--
- 31 'My son,' the father said, 'you are always with me, and everything I have is yours.
- 32 but this is a wonderful time, and we had to celebrate. This brother of yours was dead, and he's alive! He was lost, and he's found!'"
- 32 But we had to celebrate and be glad, because this brother of yours was dead and is alive again; he was lost and is found.' "

Luke 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jesus said to his disciples, "There was once a rich man who had a manager. He got reports that the manager had been taking advantage of his position by running up huge personal expenses.
- 1 Jesus told his disciples: "There was a rich man whose manager was accused of wasting his possessions.
- 2 So he called him in and said, 'What's this I hear about you? You're fired. And I want a complete audit of your books.'
- 2 So he called him in and asked him, 'What is this I hear about you? Give an account of your management, because you cannot be manager any

longer.'

- 3 "The manager said to himself, 'What am I going to do? I've lost my job as manager. I'm not strong enough for a laboring job, and I'm too proud to beg. . . .
- 3 The manager said to himself, 'What shall I do now? My master is taking away my job. I'm not strong enough to dig, and I'm ashamed to beg--
- 4 Ah, I've got a plan. Here's what I'll do . . . then when I'm turned out into the street, people will take me into their houses.'
- 4 I know what I'll do so that, when I lose my job here, people will welcome me into their houses.'
- 5 "Then he went at it. One after another, he called in the people who were in debt to his master. He said to the first, 'How much do you owe my master?'
- 5 So he called in each one of his master's debtors. He asked the first, 'How much do you owe my master?'
- 6 "He replied, 'A hundred jugs of olive oil.' "The manager said, 'Here, take your bill, sit down here--quick now--write fifty.'
- 6 'Eight hundred gallons of olive oil,' he replied. The manager told him, 'Take your bill, sit down quickly, and make it four hundred.'
- 7 "To the next he said, 'And you, what do you owe?' "He answered, 'A hundred sacks of wheat.' "He said, 'Take your bill, write in eighty.'
- 7 Then he asked the second, 'And how much do you owe?' 'A thousand bushels of wheat,' he replied. "He told him, 'Take your bill and make it eight hundred.'
- 8 "Now here's a surprise: The master praised the crooked manager! And why? Because he knew how to look after himself. Streetwise people are smarter in this regard than law-abiding citizens. They are on constant alert, looking for angles, surviving by their wits.
- 8 The master commended the dishonest manager because he had acted shrewdly. For the people of this world are more shrewd in dealing with their own kind than are the people of the light.
- 9 I want you to be smart in the same way--but for what is right--using every adversity to stimulate you to creative survival, to concentrate your attention on the bare essentials, so you'll live, really live, and not complacently just get by on good behavior."

- 9 I tell you, use worldly wealth to gain friends for yourselves, so that when it is gone, you will be welcomed into eternal dwellings.
- 10 Jesus went on to make these comments: If you're honest in small things, you'll be honest in big things;
- 10 Whoever can be trusted with very little can also be trusted with much, and whoever is dishonest with very little will also be dishonest with much.
- 11 If you're a crook in small things, you'll be a crook in big things.
- 11 So if you have not been trustworthy in handling worldly wealth, who will trust you with true riches?
- 12 If you're not honest in small jobs, who will put you in charge of the store?
- 12 And if you have not been trustworthy with someone else's property, who will give you property of your own?
- 13 No worker can serve two bosses: He'll either hate the first and love the second Or adore the first and despise the second. You can't serve both God and the Bank.
- 13 No servant can serve two masters. Either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve both God and Money.
- 14 When the Pharisees, a money-obsessed bunch, heard him say these things, they rolled their eyes, dismissing him as hopelessly out of touch.
- 14 The Pharisees, who loved money, heard all this and were sneering at Jesus.
- 15 So Jesus spoke to them: "You are masters at making yourselves look good in front of others, but God knows what's behind the appearance. What society sees and calls monumental, God sees through and calls monstrous.
- 15 He said to them, "You are the ones who justify yourselves in the eyes of men, but God knows your hearts. What is highly valued among men is detestable in God's sight.
- 16 God's Law and the Prophets climaxed in John; Now it's all kingdom of God--the glad news and compelling invitation to every man and woman.
- 16 The Law and the Prophets were proclaimed until John. Since that time, the good news of the kingdom of God is being preached, and everyone is forcing his way into it.

- 17 The sky will disintegrate and the earth dissolve before a single letter of God's Law wears out.
- 17 It is easier for heaven and earth to disappear than for the least stroke of a pen to drop out of the Law.
- 18 Using the legalities of divorce as a cover for lust is adultery; Using the legalities of marriage as a cover for lust is adultery.
- 18 Anyone who divorces his wife and marries another woman commits adultery, and the man who marries a divorced woman commits adultery.
- 19 "There once was a rich man, expensively dressed in the latest fashions, wasting his days in conspicuous consumption.
- 19 There was a rich man who was dressed in purple and fine linen and lived in luxury every day.
- 20 A poor man named Lazarus, covered with sores, had been dumped on his doorstep.
- 20 At his gate was laid a beggar named Lazarus, covered with sores
- 21 All he lived for was to get a meal from scraps off the rich man's table. His best friends were the dogs who came and licked his sores.
- 21 and longing to eat what fell from the rich man's table. Even the dogs came and licked his sores.
- 22 "Then he died, this poor man, and was taken up by the angels to the lap of Abraham. The rich man also died and was buried.
- 22 The time came when the beggar died and the angels carried him to Abraham's side. The rich man also died and was buried.
- 23 In hell and in torment, he looked up and saw Abraham in the distance and Lazarus in his lap.
- 23 In hell, where he was in torment, he looked up and saw Abraham far away, with Lazarus by his side.
- 24 He called out, 'Father Abraham, mercy! Have mercy! Send Lazarus to dip his finger in water to cool my tongue. I'm in agony in this fire.'
- 24 So he called to him, 'Father Abraham, have pity on me and send Lazarus to dip the tip of his finger in water and cool my tongue, because I am in agony in this fire.'
- 25 "But Abraham said, 'Child, remember that in your lifetime you got the good things and Lazarus the bad things. It's not like that here. Here he's consoled and you're tormented.

- 25 But Abraham replied, 'Son, remember that in your lifetime you received your good things, while Lazarus received bad things, but now he is comforted here and you are in agony.
- 26 Besides, in all these matters there is a huge chasm set between us so that no one can go from us to you even if he wanted to, nor can anyone cross over from you to us.'
- 26 And besides all this, between us and you a great chasm has been fixed, so that those who want to go from here to you cannot, nor can anyone cross over from there to us.'
- 27 "The rich man said, 'Then let me ask you, Father: Send him to the house of my father
- 27 He answered, 'Then I beg you, father, send Lazarus to my father's house,
- 28 where I have five brothers, so he can tell them the score and warn them so they won't end up here in this place of torment.'
- 28 for I have five brothers. Let him warn them, so that they will not also come to this place of torment.'
- 29 "Abraham answered, 'They have Moses and the Prophets to tell them the score. Let them listen to them.'
- 29 Abraham replied, 'They have Moses and the Prophets; let them listen to them.'
- 30 "'I know, Father Abraham,' he said, 'but they're not listening. If someone came back to them from the dead, they would change their ways.'
- 30 'No, father Abraham,' he said, 'but if someone from the dead goes to them, they will repent.'
- 31 "Abraham replied, 'If they won't listen to Moses and the Prophets, they're not going to be convinced by someone who rises from the dead.'"
- 31 He said to him, 'If they do not listen to Moses and the Prophets, they will not be convinced even if someone rises from the dead.'

Luke 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 He said to his disciples, "Hard trials and temptations are bound to come, but too bad for whoever brings them on!

- 1 Jesus said to his disciples: "Things that cause people to sin are bound to come, but woe to that person through whom they come.
- 2 Better to wear a millstone necklace and take a swim in the deep blue sea than give even one of these dear little ones a hard time!
- 2 It would be better for him to be thrown into the sea with a millstone tied around his neck than for him to cause one of these little ones to sin.
- 3 "Be alert. If you see your friend going wrong, correct him. If he responds, forgive him.
- 3 So watch yourselves. "If your brother sins, rebuke him, and if he repents, forgive him.
- 4 Even if it's personal against you and repeated seven times through the day, and seven times he says, 'I'm sorry, I won't do it again,' forgive him."
- 4 If he sins against you seven times in a day, and seven times comes back to you and says, 'I repent,' forgive him."
- 5 The apostles came up and said to the Master, "Give us more faith."
- 5 The apostles said to the Lord, "Increase our faith!"
- 6 But the Master said, "You don't need more faith. There is no 'more' or 'less' in faith. If you have a bare kernel of faith, say the size of a poppy seed, you could say to this sycamore tree, 'Go jump in the lake,' and it would do it.
- 6 He replied, "If you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mulberry tree, 'Be uprooted and planted in the sea,' and it will obey you.
- 7 "Suppose one of you has a servant who comes in from plowing the field or tending the sheep. Would you take his coat, set the table, and say, 'Sit down and eat'?
- 7 Suppose one of you had a servant plowing or looking after the sheep. Would he say to the servant when he comes in from the field, 'Come along now and sit down to eat'?
- 8 Wouldn't you be more likely to say, 'Prepare dinner; change your clothes and wait table for me until I've finished my coffee; then go to the kitchen and have your supper'?
- 8 Would he not rather say, 'Prepare my supper, get yourself ready and wait on me while I eat and drink; after that you may eat and drink'?
- 9 Does the servant get special thanks for doing what's expected of him?

9 Would he thank the servant because he did what he was told to do?

10 It's the same with you. When you've done everything expected of you, be matter-of-fact and say, 'The work is done. What we were told to do, we did.'"

10 So you also, when you have done everything you were told to do, should say, 'We are unworthy servants; we have only done our duty.' "

11 It happened that as he made his way toward Jerusalem, he crossed over the border between Samaria and Galilee.

11 Now on his way to Jerusalem, Jesus traveled along the border between Samaria and Galilee.

12 As he entered a village, ten men, all lepers, met him. They kept their distance

12 As he was going into a village, ten men who had leprosy met him. They stood at a distance

13 but raised their voices, calling out, "Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!"

13 and called out in a loud voice, "Jesus, Master, have pity on us!"

14 Taking a good look at them, he said, "Go, show yourselves to the priests." They went, and while still on their way, became clean.

14 When he saw them, he said, "Go, show yourselves to the priests." And as they went, they were cleansed.

15 One of them, when he realized that he was healed, turned around and came back, shouting his gratitude, glorifying God.

15 One of them, when he saw he was healed, came back, praising God in a loud voice.

16 He kneeled at Jesus' feet, so grateful. He couldn't thank him enough--and he was a Samaritan.

16 He threw himself at Jesus' feet and thanked him--and he was a Samaritan.

17 Jesus said, "Were not ten healed? Where are the nine?"

17 Jesus asked, "Were not all ten cleansed? Where are the other nine?"

18 Can none be found to come back and give glory to God except this outsider?"

18 Was no one found to return and give praise to God except this foreigner?"

19 Then he said to him, "Get up. On your way. Your faith has healed and saved you."

19 Then he said to him, "Rise and go; your faith has made you well."

20 Jesus, grilled by the Pharisees on when the kingdom of God would come, answered, "The kingdom of God doesn't come by counting the days on the calendar.

20 Once, having been asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God would come, Jesus replied, "The kingdom of God does not come with your careful observation,

21 Nor when someone says, 'Look here!' or, 'There it is!' And why? Because God's kingdom is already among you."

21 nor will people say, 'Here it is,' or 'There it is,' because the kingdom of God is within you."

22 He went on to say to his disciples, "The days are coming when you are going to be desperately homesick for just a glimpse of one of the days of the Son of Man, and you won't see a thing.

22 Then he said to his disciples, "The time is coming when you will long to see one of the days of the Son of Man, but you will not see it.

23 And they'll say to you, 'Look over there!' or, 'Look here!' Don't fall for any of that nonsense.

23 Men will tell you, 'There he is!' or 'Here he is!' Do not go running off after them.

24 The arrival of the Son of Man is not something you go out to see. He simply comes. "You know how the whole sky lights up from a single flash of lightning? That's how it will be on the Day of the Son of Man.

24 For the Son of Man in his day will be like the lightning, which flashes and lights up the sky from one end to the other.

25 But first it's necessary that he suffer many things and be turned down by the people of today.

25 But first he must suffer many things and be rejected by this generation.

26 "The time of the Son of Man will be just like the time of Noah--

26 Just as it was in the days of Noah, so also will it be in the days of the Son of Man.

27 everyone carrying on as usual, having a good time right up to the day Noah boarded the ship. They suspected nothing until the flood hit and swept everything away.

27 People were eating, drinking, marrying and being given in marriage up to the day Noah entered the ark. Then the flood came and destroyed

them all.

28 "It was the same in the time of Lot--the people carrying on, having a good time, business as usual

28 It was the same in the days of Lot. People were eating and drinking, buying and selling, planting and building.

29 right up to the day Lot walked out of Sodom and a firestorm swept down and burned everything to a crisp.

29 But the day Lot left Sodom, fire and sulfur rained down from heaven and destroyed them all.

30 That's how it will be--sudden, total--when the Son of Man is revealed.

30 It will be just like this on the day the Son of Man is revealed.

31 "When the Day arrives and you're out working in the yard, don't run into the house to get anything. And if you're out in the field, don't go back and get your coat.

31 On that day no one who is on the roof of his house, with his goods inside, should go down to get them. Likewise, no one in the field should go back for anything.

32 Remember what happened to Lot's wife!

32 Remember Lot's wife!

33 If you grasp and cling to life on your terms, you'll lose it, but if you let that life go, you'll get life on God's terms.

33 Whoever tries to keep his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life will preserve it.

34 "On that Day, two men will be in the same boat fishing--one taken, the other left.

34 I tell you, on that night two people will be in one bed; one will be taken and the other left.

35 Two women will be working in the same kitchen--one taken, the other left."

35 Two women will be grinding grain together; one will be taken and the other left. "

36 (OMITTED TEXT)

37 Trying to take all this in, the disciples said, "Master, where?" He told them, "Watch for the circling of the vultures. They'll spot the corpse first. The action will begin around my dead body."

37 Where, Lord? they asked. He replied, "Where there is a dead body, there the vultures will gather."

Luke 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jesus told them a story showing that it was necessary for them to pray consistently and never quit.
- 1 Then Jesus told his disciples a parable to show them that they should always pray and not give up.
- 2 He said, "There was once a judge in some city who never gave God a thought and cared nothing for people.
- 2 He said: "In a certain town there was a judge who neither feared God nor cared about men.
- 3 A widow in that city kept after him: 'My rights are being violated. Protect me!'
- 3 And there was a widow in that town who kept coming to him with the plea, 'Grant me justice against my adversary.'
- 4 "He never gave her the time of day. But after this went on and on he said to himself, 'I care nothing what God thinks, even less what people think.
- 4 For some time he refused. But finally he said to himself, 'Even though I don't fear God or care about men,
- 5 But because this widow won't quit badgering me, I'd better do something and see that she gets justice--otherwise I'm going to end up beaten black and blue by her pounding.'"
- 5 yet because this widow keeps bothering me, I will see that she gets justice, so that she won't eventually wear me out with her coming!"
- 6 Then the Master said, "Do you hear what that judge, corrupt as he is, is saying?
- 6 And the Lord said, "Listen to what the unjust judge says.
- 7 So what makes you think God won't step in and work justice for his chosen people, who continue to cry out for help? Won't he stick up for them?
- 7 And will not God bring about justice for his chosen ones, who cry out to him day and night? Will he keep putting them off?

- 8 I assure you, he will. He will not drag his feet. But how much of that kind of persistent faith will the Son of Man find on the earth when he returns?"
- 8 I tell you, he will see that they get justice, and quickly. However, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?"
- 9 He told his next story to some who were complacently pleased with themselves over their moral performance and looked down their noses at the common people:
- 9 To some who were confident of their own righteousness and looked down on everybody else, Jesus told this parable:
- 10 "Two men went up to the Temple to pray, one a Pharisee, the other a tax man.
- 10 Two men went up to the temple to pray, one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector.
- 11 The Pharisee posed and prayed like this: 'Oh, God, I thank you that I am not like other people--robbers, crooks, adulterers, or, heaven forbid, like this tax man.
- 11 The Pharisee stood up and prayed about himself: 'God, I thank you that I am not like other men--robbers, evildoers, adulterers--or even like this tax collector.
- 12 I fast twice a week and tithe on all my income.'
- 12 I fast twice a week and give a tenth of all I get.'
- 13 "Meanwhile the tax man, slumped in the shadows, his face in his hands, not daring to look up, said, 'God, give mercy. Forgive me, a sinner.'"
- 13 But the tax collector stood at a distance. He would not even look up to heaven, but beat his breast and said, 'God, have mercy on me, a sinner.'
- 14 Jesus commented, "This tax man, not the other, went home made right with God. If you walk around with your nose in the air, you're going to end up flat on your face, but if you're content to be simply yourself, you will become more than yourself."
- 14 I tell you that this man, rather than the other, went home justified before God. For everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, and he who humbles himself will be exalted.
- 15 People brought babies to Jesus, hoping he might touch them. When the disciples saw it, they shooed them off.

- 15 People were also bringing babies to Jesus to have him touch them. When the disciples saw this, they rebuked them.
- 16 Jesus called them back. "Let these children alone. Don't get between them and me. These children are the kingdom's pride and joy.
- 16 But Jesus called the children to him and said, "Let the little children come to me, and do not hinder them, for the kingdom of God belongs to such as these.
- 17 Mark this: Unless you accept God's kingdom in the simplicity of a child, you'll never get in."
- 17 I tell you the truth, anyone who will not receive the kingdom of God like a little child will never enter it."
- 18 One day one of the local officials asked him, "Good Teacher, what must I do to deserve eternal life?"
- 18 A certain ruler asked him, "Good teacher, what must I do to inherit eternal life?"
- 19 Jesus said, "Why are you calling me good? No one is good--only God.
- 19 Why do you call me good? Jesus answered. "No one is good--except God alone.
- 20 You know the commandments, don't you? No illicit sex, no killing, no stealing, no lying, honor your father and mother."
- 20 You know the commandments: 'Do not commit adultery, do not murder, do not steal, do not give false testimony, honor your father and mother.' "
- 21 He said, "I've kept them all for as long as I can remember."
- 21 All these I have kept since I was a boy, he said.
- 22 When Jesus heard that, he said, "Then there's only one thing left to do: Sell everything you own and give it away to the poor. You will have riches in heaven. Then come, follow me."
- 22 When Jesus heard this, he said to him, "You still lack one thing. Sell everything you have and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come, follow me."
- 23 This was the last thing the official expected to hear. He was very rich and became terribly sad. He was holding on tight to a lot of things and not about to let them go.
- 23 When he heard this, he became very sad, because he was a man of great wealth.

- 24 Seeing his reaction, Jesus said, "Do you have any idea how difficult it is for people who have it all to enter God's kingdom?"
- 24 Jesus looked at him and said, "How hard it is for the rich to enter the kingdom of God!"
- 25 I'd say it's easier to thread a camel through a needle's eye than get a rich person into God's kingdom."
- 25 Indeed, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God."
- 26 "Then who has any chance at all?" the others asked.
- 26 Those who heard this asked, "Who then can be saved?"
- 27 "No chance at all," Jesus said, "if you think you can pull it off by yourself. Every chance in the world if you trust God to do it."
- 27 Jesus replied, "What is impossible with men is possible with God."
- 28 Peter tried to regain some initiative: "We left everything we owned and followed you, didn't we?"
- 28 Peter said to him, "We have left all we had to follow you!"
- 29 "Yes," said Jesus, "and you won't regret it. No one who has sacrificed home, spouse, brothers and sisters, parents, children--whatever--
- 29 I tell you the truth, Jesus said to them, "no one who has left home or wife or brothers or parents or children for the sake of the kingdom of God
- 30 will lose out. It will all come back multiplied many times over in your lifetime. And then the bonus of eternal life!"
- 30 will fail to receive many times as much in this age and, in the age to come, eternal life."
- 31 Then Jesus took the Twelve off to the side and said, "Listen carefully. We're on our way up to Jerusalem. Everything written in the Prophets about the Son of Man will take place.
- 31 Jesus took the Twelve aside and told them, "We are going up to Jerusalem, and everything that is written by the prophets about the Son of Man will be fulfilled.
- 32 He will be handed over to the Romans, jeered at, made sport of, and spit on. Then, after giving him the third degree, they will kill him.
- 32 He will be handed over to the Gentiles. They will mock him, insult him, spit on him, flog him and kill him.
- 33 In three days he will rise, alive."

33 On the third day he will rise again."
34 But they didn't get it, could make neither heads nor tails of what he was talking about.
34 The disciples did not understand any of this. Its meaning was hidden from them, and they did not know what he was talking about.
35 He came to the outskirts of Jericho. A blind man was sitting beside the road asking for handouts.
35 As Jesus approached Jericho, a blind man was sitting by the roadside begging.
36 When he heard the rustle of the crowd, he asked what was going on.
36 When he heard the crowd going by, he asked what was happening.
37 They told him, "Jesus the Nazarene is going by."
37 They told him, "Jesus of Nazareth is passing by."
38 He yelled, "Jesus! Son of David! Mercy, have mercy on me!"
38 He called out, "Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me!"
39 Those ahead of Jesus told the man to shut up, but he only yelled all the louder, "Son of David! Mercy, have mercy on me!"
39 Those who led the way rebuked him and told him to be quiet, but he shouted all the more, "Son of David, have mercy on me!"
40 Jesus stopped and ordered him to be brought over. When he had come near, Jesus asked,
40 Jesus stopped and ordered the man to be brought to him. When he came near, Jesus asked him,
41 "What do you want from me?" He said, "Master, I want to see again."
41 What do you want me to do for you? "Lord, I want to see," he replied.
42 Jesus said, "Go ahead--see again! Your faith has saved and healed you!"
42 Jesus said to him, "Receive your sight; your faith has healed you."
43 The healing was instant: He looked up, seeing--and then followed Jesus, glorifying God. Everyone in the street joined in, shouting praise to God.
43 Immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus, praising God. When all the people saw it, they also praised God.

Luke 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then Jesus entered and walked through Jericho.
- 1 Jesus entered Jericho and was passing through.
- 2 There was a man there, his name Zacchaeus, the head tax man and quite rich.
- 2 A man was there by the name of Zacchaeus; he was a chief tax collector and was wealthy.
- 3 He wanted desperately to see Jesus, but the crowd was in his way--he was a short man and couldn't see over the crowd.
- 3 He wanted to see who Jesus was, but being a short man he could not, because of the crowd.
- 4 So he ran on ahead and climbed up in a sycamore tree so he could see Jesus when he came by.
- 4 So he ran ahead and climbed a sycamore-fig tree to see him, since Jesus was coming that way.
- 5 When Jesus got to the tree, he looked up and said, "Zacchaeus, hurry down. Today is my day to be a guest in your home."
- 5 When Jesus reached the spot, he looked up and said to him, "Zacchaeus, come down immediately. I must stay at your house today."
- 6 Zacchaeus scrambled out of the tree, hardly believing his good luck, delighted to take Jesus home with him.
- 6 So he came down at once and welcomed him gladly.
- 7 Everyone who saw the incident was indignant and grumped, "What business does he have getting cozy with this crook?"
- 7 All the people saw this and began to mutter, "He has gone to be the guest of a 'sinner.' "
- 8 Zacchaeus just stood there, a little stunned. He stammered apologetically, "Master, I give away half my income to the poor--and if I'm caught cheating, I pay four times the damages."
- 8 But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, "Look, Lord! Here and now I give half of my possessions to the poor, and if I have cheated anybody out of anything, I will pay back four times the amount."
- 9 Jesus said, "Today is salvation day in this home! Here he is: Zacchaeus, son of Abraham!
- 9 Jesus said to him, "Today salvation has come to this house, because this man, too, is a son of Abraham.
- 10 For the Son of Man came to find and restore the lost."

10 For the Son of Man came to seek and to save what was lost."

11 While he had their attention, and because they were getting close to Jerusalem by this time and expectation was building that God's kingdom would appear any minute, he told this story:

11 While they were listening to this, he went on to tell them a parable, because he was near Jerusalem and the people thought that the kingdom of God was going to appear at once.

12 "There was once a man descended from a royal house who needed to make a long trip back to headquarters to get authorization for his rule and then return.

12 He said: "A man of noble birth went to a distant country to have himself appointed king and then to return.

13 But first he called ten servants together, gave them each a sum of money, and instructed them, 'Operate with this until I return.'

13 So he called ten of his servants and gave them ten minas. 'Put this money to work,' he said, 'until I come back.'

14 "But the citizens there hated him. So they sent a commission with a signed petition to oppose his rule: 'We don't want this man to rule us.'

14 But his subjects hated him and sent a delegation after him to say, 'We don't want this man to be our king.'

15 "When he came back bringing the authorization of his rule, he called those ten servants to whom he had given the money to find out how they had done.

15 He was made king, however, and returned home. Then he sent for the servants to whom he had given the money, in order to find out what they had gained with it.

16 "The first said, 'Master, I doubled your money.'

16 The first one came and said, 'Sir, your mina has earned ten more.'

17 "He said, 'Good servant! Great work! Because you've been trustworthy in this small job, I'm making you governor of ten towns.'

17 'Well done, my good servant!' his master replied. 'Because you have been trustworthy in a very small matter, take charge of ten cities.'

18 "The second said, 'Master, I made a fifty percent profit on your money.'

18 The second came and said, 'Sir, your mina has earned five more.'

19 "He said, 'I'm putting you in charge of five towns.'

19 His master answered, 'You take charge of five cities.'

20 "The next servant said, 'Master, here's your money safe and sound. I kept it hidden in the cellar.

20 Then another servant came and said, 'Sir, here is your mina; I have kept it laid away in a piece of cloth.

21 To tell you the truth, I was a little afraid. I know you have high standards and hate sloppiness, and don't suffer fools gladly.'

21 I was afraid of you, because you are a hard man. You take out what you did not put in and reap what you did not sow.'

22 "He said, 'You're right that I don't suffer fools gladly--and you've acted the fool!

22 His master replied, 'I will judge you by your own words, you wicked servant! You knew, did you, that I am a hard man, taking out what I did not put in, and reaping what I did not sow?

23 Why didn't you at least invest the money in securities so I would have gotten a little interest on it?'

23 Why then didn't you put my money on deposit, so that when I came back, I could have collected it with interest?'

24 "Then he said to those standing there, 'Take the money from him and give it to the servant who doubled my stake.'

24 Then he said to those standing by, 'Take his mina away from him and give it to the one who has ten minas.'

25 "They said, 'But Master, he already has double . . .'

25 'Sir,' they said, 'he already has ten!'

26 "He said, 'That's what I mean: Risk your life and get more than you ever dreamed of. Play it safe and end up holding the bag.

26 He replied, 'I tell you that to everyone who has, more will be given, but as for the one who has nothing, even what he has will be taken away.

27 "'As for these enemies of mine who petitioned against my rule, clear them out of here. I don't want to see their faces around here again.'"

27 But those enemies of mine who did not want me to be king over them--bring them here and kill them in front of me.' "

28 After saying these things, Jesus headed straight up to Jerusalem.

28 After Jesus had said this, he went on ahead, going up to Jerusalem.

29 When he got near Bethphage and Bethany at the mountain called Olives, he sent off two of the disciples with instructions:

29 As he approached Bethphage and Bethany at the hill called the Mount of Olives, he sent two of his disciples, saying to them,

30 "Go to the village across from you. As soon as you enter, you'll find a colt tethered, one that has never been ridden. Untie it and bring it.

30 Go to the village ahead of you, and as you enter it, you will find a colt tied there, which no one has ever ridden. Untie it and bring it here.

31 If anyone says anything, asks, 'What are you doing?' say, 'His Master needs him.'"

31 If anyone asks you, 'Why are you untying it?' tell him, 'The Lord needs it.' "

32 The two left and found it just as he said.

32 Those who were sent ahead went and found it just as he had told them.

33 As they were untying the colt, its owners said, "What are you doing untying the colt?"

33 As they were untying the colt, its owners asked them, "Why are you untying the colt?"

34 They said, "His Master needs him."

34 They replied, "The Lord needs it."

35 They brought the colt to Jesus. Then, throwing their coats on its back, they helped Jesus get on.

35 They brought it to Jesus, threw their cloaks on the colt and put Jesus on it.

36 As he rode, the people gave him a grand welcome, throwing their coats on the street.

36 As he went along, people spread their cloaks on the road.

37 Right at the crest, where Mount Olives begins its descent, the whole crowd of disciples burst into enthusiastic praise over all the mighty works they had witnessed:

37 When he came near the place where the road goes down the Mount of Olives, the whole crowd of disciples began joyfully to praise God in loud voices for all the miracles they had seen:

38 Blessed is he who comes, the king in God's name! All's well in heaven! Glory in the high places!

38 Blessed is the king who comes in the name of the Lord! "Peace in heaven and glory in the highest!"

39 Some Pharisees from the crowd told him, "Teacher, get your disciples under control!"

39 Some of the Pharisees in the crowd said to Jesus, "Teacher, rebuke your disciples!"

40 But he said, "If they kept quiet, the stones would do it for them, shouting praise."

40 I tell you, he replied, "if they keep quiet, the stones will cry out."

41 When the city came into view, he wept over it.

41 As he approached Jerusalem and saw the city, he wept over it

42 "If you had only recognized this day, and everything that was good for you! But now it's too late.

42 and said, "If you, even you, had only known on this day what would bring you peace--but now it is hidden from your eyes.

43 In the days ahead your enemies are going to bring up their heavy artillery and surround you, pressing in from every side.

43 The days will come upon you when your enemies will build an embankment against you and encircle you and hem you in on every side.

44 They'll smash you and your babies on the pavement. Not one stone will be left intact. All this because you didn't recognize and welcome God's personal visit."

44 They will dash you to the ground, you and the children within your walls. They will not leave one stone on another, because you did not recognize the time of God's coming to you."

45 Going into the Temple he began to throw out everyone who had set up shop, selling everything and anything.

45 Then he entered the temple area and began driving out those who were selling.

46 He said, "It's written in Scripture, My house is a house of prayer; You have turned it into a religious bazaar."

46 It is written, he said to them, " 'My house will be a house of prayer' ; but you have made it 'a den of robbers.' "

47 From then on he taught each day in the Temple. The high priests, religion scholars, and the leaders of the people were trying their best to find a way to get rid of him.

47 Every day he was teaching at the temple. But the chief priests, the teachers of the law and the leaders among the people were trying to kill

him.

48 But with the people hanging on every word he spoke, they couldn't come up with anything.

48 Yet they could not find any way to do it, because all the people hung on his words.

Luke 20

MSG

NIV

1 One day he was teaching the people in the Temple, proclaiming the Message. The high priests, religion scholars, and leaders confronted

1 One day as he was teaching the people in the temple courts and preaching the gospel, the chief priests and the teachers of the law, together with the elders, came up to him.

2 him and demanded, "Show us your credentials. Who authorized you to speak and act like this?"

2 Tell us by what authority you are doing these things, they said. "Who gave you this authority?"

3 Jesus answered, "First, let me ask you a question:

3 He replied, "I will also ask you a question. Tell me,

4 About the baptism of John--who authorized it, heaven or humans?"

4 John's baptism--was it from heaven, or from men?"

5 They were on the spot, and knew it. They pulled back into a huddle and whispered, "If we say 'heaven,' he'll ask us why we didn't believe him;

5 They discussed it among themselves and said, "If we say, 'From heaven,' he will ask, 'Why didn't you believe him?'

6 if we say 'humans,' the people will tear us limb from limb, convinced as they are that John was God's prophet."

6 But if we say, 'From men,' all the people will stone us, because they are persuaded that John was a prophet."

7 They agreed to concede that round to Jesus and said they didn't know.

7 So they answered, "We don't know where it was from."

8 Jesus said, "Then neither will I answer your question."

8 Jesus said, "Neither will I tell you by what authority I am doing these things."

- 9 Jesus told another story to the people: "A man planted a vineyard. He handed it over to farmhands and went off on a trip. He was gone a long time.
- 9 He went on to tell the people this parable: "A man planted a vineyard, rented it to some farmers and went away for a long time.
- 10 In time he sent a servant back to the farmhands to collect the profits, but they beat him up and sent him off empty-handed.
- 10 At harvest time he sent a servant to the tenants so they would give him some of the fruit of the vineyard. But the tenants beat him and sent him away empty-handed.
- 11 He decided to try again and sent another servant. That one they beat black and blue, and sent him off empty-handed.
- 11 He sent another servant, but that one also they beat and treated shamefully and sent away empty-handed.
- 12 He tried a third time. They worked that servant over from head to foot and dumped him in the street.
- 12 He sent still a third, and they wounded him and threw him out.
- 13 "Then the owner of the vineyard said, 'I know what I'll do: I'll send my beloved son. They're bound to respect my son.'
- 13 Then the owner of the vineyard said, 'What shall I do? I will send my son, whom I love; perhaps they will respect him.'
- 14 "But when the farmhands saw him coming, they quickly put their heads together. 'This is our chance--this is the heir! Let's kill him and have it all to ourselves.'
- 14 But when the tenants saw him, they talked the matter over. 'This is the heir,' they said. 'Let's kill him, and the inheritance will be ours.'
- 15 They killed him and threw him over the fence. "What do you think the owner of the vineyard will do?
- 15 So they threw him out of the vineyard and killed him. "What then will the owner of the vineyard do to them?
- 16 Right. He'll come and clean house. Then he'll assign the care of the vineyard to others." Those who were listening said, "Oh, no! He'd never do that!"
- 16 He will come and kill those tenants and give the vineyard to others." When the people heard this, they said, "May this never be!"

- 17 But Jesus didn't back down. "Why, then, do you think this was written: That stone the masons threw out-- It's now the cornerstone!?"
- 17 Jesus looked directly at them and asked, "Then what is the meaning of that which is written: " 'The stone the builders rejected has become the capstone' ?
- 18 "Anyone falling over that stone will break every bone in his body; if the stone falls on anyone, it will be a total smashup."
- 18 Everyone who falls on that stone will be broken to pieces, but he on whom it falls will be crushed."
- 19 The religion scholars and high priests wanted to lynch him on the spot, but they were intimidated by public opinion. They knew the story was about them.
- 19 The teachers of the law and the chief priests looked for a way to arrest him immediately, because they knew he had spoken this parable against them. But they were afraid of the people.
- 20 Watching for a chance to get him, they sent spies who posed as honest inquirers, hoping to trick him into saying something that would get him in trouble with the law.
- 20 Keeping a close watch on him, they sent spies, who pretended to be honest. They hoped to catch Jesus in something he said so that they might hand him over to the power and authority of the governor.
- 21 So they asked him, "Teacher, we know that you're honest and straightforward when you teach, that you don't pander to anyone but teach the way of God accurately.
- 21 So the spies questioned him: "Teacher, we know that you speak and teach what is right, and that you do not show partiality but teach the way of God in accordance with the truth.
- 22 Tell us: Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar or not?"
- 22 Is it right for us to pay taxes to Caesar or not?"
- 23 He knew they were laying for him and said,
- 23 He saw through their duplicity and said to them,
- 24 "Show me a coin. Now, this engraving, who does it look like and what does it say?"
- 24 Show me a denarius. Whose portrait and inscription are on it?
- 25 "Caesar," they said. Jesus said, "Then give Caesar what is his and give God what is his."

25 Caesar's, they replied. He said to them, "Then give to Caesar what is Caesar's, and to God what is God's."

26 Try as they might, they couldn't trap him into saying anything incriminating. His answer caught them off guard and left them speechless.

26 They were unable to trap him in what he had said there in public. And astonished by his answer, they became silent.

27 Some Sadducees came up. This is the Jewish party that denies any possibility of resurrection. They asked,

27 Some of the Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection, came to Jesus with a question.

28 "Teacher, Moses wrote us that if a man dies and leaves a wife but no child, his brother is obligated to take the widow to wife and get her with child.

28 Teacher, they said, "Moses wrote for us that if a man's brother dies and leaves a wife but no children, the man must marry the widow and have children for his brother.

29 Well, there once were seven brothers. The first took a wife. He died childless.

29 Now there were seven brothers. The first one married a woman and died childless.

30 The second married her and died,

30 The second

31 then the third, and eventually all seven had their turn, but no child.

31 and then the third married her, and in the same way the seven died, leaving no children.

32 After all that, the wife died.

32 Finally, the woman died too.

33 That wife, now--in the resurrection whose wife is she? All seven married her."

33 Now then, at the resurrection whose wife will she be, since the seven were married to her?"

34 Jesus said, "Marriage is a major preoccupation here,

34 Jesus replied, "The people of this age marry and are given in marriage.

35 but not there. Those who are included in the resurrection of the dead will no longer be concerned with marriage

35 But those who are considered worthy of taking part in that age and in the resurrection from the dead will neither marry nor be given in marriage,
36 nor, of course, with death. They will have better things to think about, if you can believe it. All ecstasies and intimacies then will be with God.
36 and they can no longer die; for they are like the angels. They are God's children, since they are children of the resurrection.
37 Even Moses exclaimed about resurrection at the burning bush, saying, 'God: God of Abraham, God of Isaac, God of Jacob!'
37 But in the account of the bush, even Moses showed that the dead rise, for he calls the Lord 'the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.'
38 God isn't the God of dead men, but of the living. To him all are alive."
38 He is not the God of the dead, but of the living, for to him all are alive."
39 Some of the religion scholars said, "Teacher, that's a great answer!"
39 Some of the teachers of the law responded, "Well said, teacher!"
40 For a while, anyway, no one dared put questions to him.
40 And no one dared to ask him any more questions.
41 Then he put a question to them: "How is it that they say that the Messiah is David's son?
41 Then Jesus said to them, "How is it that they say the Christ is the Son of David?
42 In the Book of Psalms, David clearly says, God said to my Master, "Sit here at my right hand
42 David himself declares in the Book of Psalms: " 'The Lord said to my Lord: "Sit at my right hand
43 until I put your enemies under your feet."
43 until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet." '
44 "David here designates the Messiah as 'my Master'--so how can the Messiah also be his 'son'?"
44 David calls him 'Lord.' How then can he be his son?"
45 With everybody listening, Jesus spoke to his disciples.
45 While all the people were listening, Jesus said to his disciples,
46 "Watch out for the religion scholars. They love to walk around in academic gowns, preen in the radiance of public flattery, bask in prominent positions, sit at the head table at every church function.

- 46 Beware of the teachers of the law. They like to walk around in flowing robes and love to be greeted in the marketplaces and have the most important seats in the synagogues and the places of honor at banquets.
- 47 And all the time they are exploiting the weak and helpless. The longer their prayers, the worse they get. But they'll pay for it in the end."
- 47 They devour widows' houses and for a show make lengthy prayers. Such men will be punished most severely."

Luke 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 Just then he looked up and saw the rich people dropping offerings in the collection plate.
- 1 As he looked up, Jesus saw the rich putting their gifts into the temple treasury.
- 2 Then he saw a poor widow put in two pennies.
- 2 He also saw a poor widow put in two very small copper coins.
- 3 He said, "The plain truth is that this widow has given by far the largest offering today.
- 3 I tell you the truth, he said, "this poor widow has put in more than all the others.
- 4 All these others made offerings that they'll never miss; she gave extravagantly what she couldn't afford--she gave her all!"
- 4 All these people gave their gifts out of their wealth; but she out of her poverty put in all she had to live on."
- 5 One day people were standing around talking about the Temple, remarking how beautiful it was, the splendor of its stonework and memorial gifts. Jesus said,
- 5 Some of his disciples were remarking about how the temple was adorned with beautiful stones and with gifts dedicated to God. But Jesus said,
- 6 "All this you're admiring so much--the time is coming when every stone in that building will end up in a heap of rubble."
- 6 As for what you see here, the time will come when not one stone will be left on another; every one of them will be thrown down.

- 7 They asked him, "Teacher, when is this going to happen? What clue will we get that it's about to take place?"
- 7 Teacher, they asked, "when will these things happen? And what will be the sign that they are about to take place?"
- 8 He said, "Watch out for the doomsday deceivers. Many leaders are going to show up with forged identities claiming, 'I'm the One,' or, 'The end is near.' Don't fall for any of that.
- 8 He replied: "Watch out that you are not deceived. For many will come in my name, claiming, 'I am he,' and, 'The time is near.' Do not follow them.
- 9 When you hear of wars and uprisings, keep your head and don't panic. This is routine history and no sign of the end."
- 9 When you hear of wars and revolutions, do not be frightened. These things must happen first, but the end will not come right away."
- 10 He went on, "Nation will fight nation and ruler fight ruler, over and over.
- 10 Then he said to them: "Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom.
- 11 Huge earthquakes will occur in various places. There will be famines. You'll think at times that the very sky is falling.
- 11 There will be great earthquakes, famines and pestilences in various places, and fearful events and great signs from heaven.
- 12 "But before any of this happens, they'll arrest you, hunt you down, and drag you to court and jail. It will go from bad to worse, dog-eat-dog, everyone at your throat because you carry my name.
- 12 But before all this, they will lay hands on you and persecute you. They will deliver you to synagogues and prisons, and you will be brought before kings and governors, and all on account of my name.
- 13 You'll end up on the witness stand, called to testify.
- 13 This will result in your being witnesses to them.
- 14 Make up your mind right now not to worry about it.
- 14 But make up your mind not to worry beforehand how you will defend yourselves.
- 15 I'll give you the words and wisdom that will reduce all your accusers to stammers and stutters.

- 15 For I will give you words and wisdom that none of your adversaries will be able to resist or contradict.
- 16 "You'll even be turned in by parents, brothers, relatives, and friends. Some of you will be killed.
- 16 You will be betrayed even by parents, brothers, relatives and friends, and they will put some of you to death.
- 17 There's no telling who will hate you because of me.
- 17 All men will hate you because of me.
- 18 Even so, every detail of your body and soul--even the hairs of your head!--is in my care; nothing of you will be lost.
- 18 But not a hair of your head will perish.
- 19 Staying with it--that's what is required. Stay with it to the end. You won't be sorry; you'll be saved.
- 19 By standing firm you will gain life.
- 20 "When you see soldiers camped all around Jerusalem, then you'll know that she is about to be devastated.
- 20 When you see Jerusalem being surrounded by armies, you will know that its desolation is near.
- 21 If you're living in Judea at the time, run for the hills. If you're in the city, get out quickly. If you're out in the fields, don't go home to get your coat.
- 21 Then let those who are in Judea flee to the mountains, let those in the city get out, and let those in the country not enter the city.
- 22 This is Vengeance Day--everything written about it will come to a head.
- 22 For this is the time of punishment in fulfillment of all that has been written.
- 23 Pregnant and nursing mothers will have it especially hard. Incredible misery! Torrential rage!
- 23 How dreadful it will be in those days for pregnant women and nursing mothers! There will be great distress in the land and wrath against this people.
- 24 People dropping like flies; people dragged off to prisons; Jerusalem under the boot of barbarians until the nations finish what was given them to do.
- 24 They will fall by the sword and will be taken as prisoners to all the nations. Jerusalem will be trampled on by the Gentiles until the times of the Gentiles are fulfilled.

25 "It will seem like all hell has broken loose--sun, moon, stars, earth, sea,
25 There will be signs in the sun, moon and stars. On the earth, nations will
be in anguish and perplexity at the roaring and tossing of the sea.
26 in an uproar and everyone all over the world in a panic, the wind
knocked out of them by the threat of doom, the powers-that-be quaking.
26 Men will faint from terror, apprehensive of what is coming on the
world, for the heavenly bodies will be shaken.
27 "And then--then!--they'll see the Son of Man welcomed in grand style--
a glorious welcome!
27 At that time they will see the Son of Man coming in a cloud with power
and great glory.
28 When all this starts to happen, up on your feet. Stand tall with your
heads high. Help is on the way!"
28 When these things begin to take place, stand up and lift up your heads,
because your redemption is drawing near."
29 He told them a story. "Look at a fig tree. Any tree for that matter.
29 He told them this parable: "Look at the fig tree and all the trees.
30 When the leaves begin to show, one look tells you that summer is right
around the corner.
30 When they sprout leaves, you can see for yourselves and know that
summer is near.
31 The same here--when you see these things happen, you know God's
kingdom is about here.
31 Even so, when you see these things happening, you know that the
kingdom of God is near.
32 Don't brush this off: I'm not just saying this for some future generation,
but for this one, too--these things will happen.
32 I tell you the truth, this generation will certainly not pass away until all
these things have happened.
33 Sky and earth will wear out; my words won't wear out.
33 Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will never pass away.
34 "But be on your guard. Don't let the sharp edge of your expectation get
dulled by parties and drinking and shopping. Otherwise, that Day is
going to take you by complete surprise, spring on you suddenly like a
trap,

- 34 Be careful, or your hearts will be weighed down with dissipation, drunkenness and the anxieties of life, and that day will close on you unexpectedly like a trap.
- 35 for it's going to come on everyone, everywhere, at once.
- 35 For it will come upon all those who live on the face of the whole earth.
- 36 So, whatever you do, don't go to sleep at the switch. Pray constantly that you will have the strength and wits to make it through everything that's coming and end up on your feet before the Son of Man."
- 36 Be always on the watch, and pray that you may be able to escape all that is about to happen, and that you may be able to stand before the Son of Man."
- 37 He spent his days in the Temple teaching, but his nights out on the mountain called Olives.
- 37 Each day Jesus was teaching at the temple, and each evening he went out to spend the night on the hill called the Mount of Olives,
- 38 All the people were up at the crack of dawn to come to the Temple and listen to him.
- 38 and all the people came early in the morning to hear him at the temple.

Luke 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Feast of Unleavened Bread, also called Passover, drew near.
- 1 Now the Feast of Unleavened Bread, called the Passover, was approaching,
- 2 The high priests and religion scholars were looking for a way to do away with Jesus but, fearful of the people, they were also looking for a way to cover their tracks.
- 2 and the chief priests and the teachers of the law were looking for some way to get rid of Jesus, for they were afraid of the people.
- 3 That's when Satan entered Judas, the one called Iscariot. He was one of the Twelve.
- 3 Then Satan entered Judas, called Iscariot, one of the Twelve.
- 4 Leaving the others, he conferred with the high priests and the Temple guards about how he might betray Jesus to them.

- 4 And Judas went to the chief priests and the officers of the temple guard and discussed with them how he might betray Jesus.
- 5 They couldn't believe their good luck and agreed to pay him well.
- 5 They were delighted and agreed to give him money.
- 6 He gave them his word and started looking for a way to betray Jesus, but out of sight of the crowd.
- 6 He consented, and watched for an opportunity to hand Jesus over to them when no crowd was present.
- 7 The Day of Unleavened Bread came, the day the Passover lamb was butchered.
- 7 Then came the day of Unleavened Bread on which the Passover lamb had to be sacrificed.
- 8 Jesus sent Peter and John off, saying, "Go prepare the Passover for us so we can eat it together."
- 8 Jesus sent Peter and John, saying, "Go and make preparations for us to eat the Passover."
- 9 They said, "Where do you want us to do this?"
- 9 Where do you want us to prepare for it? they asked.
- 10 He said, "Keep your eyes open as you enter the city. A man carrying a water jug will meet you. Follow him home.
- 10 He replied, "As you enter the city, a man carrying a jar of water will meet you. Follow him to the house that he enters,
- 11 Then speak with the owner of the house: The Teacher wants to know, 'Where is the guest room where I can eat the Passover meal with my disciples?'
- 11 and say to the owner of the house, 'The Teacher asks: Where is the guest room, where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?'
- 12 He will show you a spacious second-story room, swept and ready. Prepare the meal there."
- 12 He will show you a large upper room, all furnished. Make preparations there."
- 13 They left, found everything just as he told them, and prepared the Passover meal.
- 13 They left and found things just as Jesus had told them. So they prepared the Passover.
- 14 When it was time, he sat down, all the apostles with him,

14 When the hour came, Jesus and his apostles reclined at the table.

15 and said, "You've no idea how much I have looked forward to eating this Passover meal with you before I enter my time of suffering.

15 And he said to them, "I have eagerly desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer.

16 It's the last one I'll eat until we all eat it together in the kingdom of God."

16 For I tell you, I will not eat it again until it finds fulfillment in the kingdom of God."

17 Taking the cup, he blessed it, then said, "Take this and pass it among you.

17 After taking the cup, he gave thanks and said, "Take this and divide it among you.

18 As for me, I'll not drink wine again until the kingdom of God arrives."

18 For I tell you I will not drink again of the fruit of the vine until the kingdom of God comes."

19 Taking bread, he blessed it, broke it, and gave it to them, saying, "This is my body, given for you. Eat it in my memory."

19 And he took bread, gave thanks and broke it, and gave it to them, saying, "This is my body given for you; do this in remembrance of me."

20 He did the same with the cup after supper, saying, "This cup is the new covenant written in my blood, blood poured out for you.

20 In the same way, after the supper he took the cup, saying, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.

21 "Do you realize that the hand of the one who is betraying me is at this moment on this table?

21 But the hand of him who is going to betray me is with mine on the table.

22 It's true that the Son of Man is going down a path already marked out--no surprises there. But for the one who turns him in, turns traitor to the Son of Man, this is doomsday."

22 The Son of Man will go as it has been decreed, but woe to that man who betrays him."

23 They immediately became suspicious of each other and began quizzing one another, wondering who might be about to do this.

23 They began to question among themselves which of them it might be who would do this.

24 Within minutes they were bickering over who of them would end up the greatest.

24 Also a dispute arose among them as to which of them was considered to be greatest.

25 But Jesus intervened: "Kings like to throw their weight around and people in authority like to give themselves fancy titles.

25 Jesus said to them, "The kings of the Gentiles lord it over them; and those who exercise authority over them call themselves Benefactors.

26 It's not going to be that way with you. Let the senior among you become like the junior; let the leader act the part of the servant.

26 But you are not to be like that. Instead, the greatest among you should be like the youngest, and the one who rules like the one who serves.

27 "Who would you rather be: the one who eats the dinner or the one who serves the dinner? You'd rather eat and be served, right? But I've taken my place among you as the one who serves.

27 For who is greater, the one who is at the table or the one who serves? Is it not the one who is at the table? But I am among you as one who serves.

28 And you've stuck with me through thick and thin.

28 You are those who have stood by me in my trials.

29 Now I confer on you the royal authority my Father conferred on me

29 And I confer on you a kingdom, just as my Father conferred one on me,

30 so you can eat and drink at my table in my kingdom and be strengthened as you take up responsibilities among the congregations of God's people.

30 so that you may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom and sit on thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

31 "Simon, stay on your toes. Satan has tried his best to separate all of you from me, like chaff from wheat.

31 Simon, Simon, Satan has asked to sift you as wheat.

32 Simon, I've prayed for you in particular that you not give in or give out. When you have come through the time of testing, turn to your companions and give them a fresh start."

32 But I have prayed for you, Simon, that your faith may not fail. And when you have turned back, strengthen your brothers."

33 Peter said, "Master, I'm ready for anything with you. I'd go to jail for you. I'd die for you!"

33 But he replied, "Lord, I am ready to go with you to prison and to death."

34 Jesus said, "I'm sorry to have to tell you this, Peter, but before the rooster crows you will have three times denied that you know me."

34 Jesus answered, "I tell you, Peter, before the rooster crows today, you will deny three times that you know me."

35 Then Jesus said, "When I sent you out and told you to travel light, to take only the bare necessities, did you get along all right?" "Certainly," they said, "we got along just fine."

35 Then Jesus asked them, "When I sent you without purse, bag or sandals, did you lack anything?" "Nothing," they answered.

36 He said, "This is different. Get ready for trouble. Look to what you'll need; there are difficult times ahead. Pawn your coat and get a sword.

36 He said to them, "But now if you have a purse, take it, and also a bag; and if you don't have a sword, sell your cloak and buy one.

37 What was written in Scripture, 'He was lumped in with the criminals,' gets its final meaning in me. Everything written about me is now coming to a conclusion."

37 It is written: 'And he was numbered with the transgressors' ; and I tell you that this must be fulfilled in me. Yes, what is written about me is reaching its fulfillment."

38 They said, "Look, Master, two swords!" But he said, "Enough of that; no more sword talk!"

38 The disciples said, "See, Lord, here are two swords." "That is enough," he replied.

39 Leaving there, he went, as he so often did, to Mount Olives. The disciples followed him.

39 Jesus went out as usual to the Mount of Olives, and his disciples followed him.

40 When they arrived at the place, he said, "Pray that you don't give in to temptation."

40 On reaching the place, he said to them, "Pray that you will not fall into temptation."

41 He pulled away from them about a stone's throw, knelt down, and prayed,

41 He withdrew about a stone's throw beyond them, knelt down and prayed,
42 "Father, remove this cup from me. But please, not what I want. What do you want?"
42 Father, if you are willing, take this cup from me; yet not my will, but yours be done.
43 At once an angel from heaven was at his side, strengthening him.
43 An angel from heaven appeared to him and strengthened him.
44 He prayed on all the harder. Sweat, wrung from him like drops of blood, poured off his face.
44 And being in anguish, he prayed more earnestly, and his sweat was like drops of blood falling to the ground.
45 He got up from prayer, went back to the disciples and found them asleep, drugged by grief.
45 When he rose from prayer and went back to the disciples, he found them asleep, exhausted from sorrow.
46 He said, "What business do you have sleeping? Get up. Pray so you won't give in to temptation."
46 Why are you sleeping? he asked them. "Get up and pray so that you will not fall into temptation."
47 No sooner were the words out of his mouth than a crowd showed up, Judas, the one from the Twelve, in the lead. He came right up to Jesus to kiss him.
47 While he was still speaking a crowd came up, and the man who was called Judas, one of the Twelve, was leading them. He approached Jesus to kiss him,
48 Jesus said, "Judas, you would betray the Son of Man with a kiss?"
48 but Jesus asked him, "Judas, are you betraying the Son of Man with a kiss?"
49 When those with him saw what was happening, they said, "Master, shall we fight?"
49 When Jesus' followers saw what was going to happen, they said, "Lord, should we strike with our swords?"
50 One of them took a swing at the Chief Priest's servant and cut off his right ear.

50 And one of them struck the servant of the high priest, cutting off his right ear.

51 Jesus said, "Let them be. Even in this." Then, touching the servant's ear, he healed him.

51 But Jesus answered, "No more of this!" And he touched the man's ear and healed him.

52 Jesus spoke to those who had come--high priests, Temple police, religion leaders: "What is this, jumping me with swords and clubs as if I were a dangerous criminal?"

52 Then Jesus said to the chief priests, the officers of the temple guard, and the elders, who had come for him, "Am I leading a rebellion, that you have come with swords and clubs?"

53 Day after day I've been with you in the Temple and you've not so much as lifted a hand against me. But do it your way--it's a dark night, a dark hour."

53 Every day I was with you in the temple courts, and you did not lay a hand on me. But this is your hour--when darkness reigns."

54 Arresting Jesus, they marched him off and took him into the house of the Chief Priest. Peter followed, but at a safe distance.

54 Then seizing him, they led him away and took him into the house of the high priest. Peter followed at a distance.

55 In the middle of the courtyard some people had started a fire and were sitting around it, trying to keep warm.

55 But when they had kindled a fire in the middle of the courtyard and had sat down together, Peter sat down with them.

56 One of the serving maids sitting at the fire noticed him, then took a second look and said, "This man was with him!"

56 A servant girl saw him seated there in the firelight. She looked closely at him and said, "This man was with him."

57 He denied it, "Woman, I don't even know him."

57 But he denied it. "Woman, I don't know him," he said.

58 A short time later, someone else noticed him and said, "You're one of them." But Peter denied it: "Man, I am not."

58 A little later someone else saw him and said, "You also are one of them." "Man, I am not!" Peter replied.

59 About an hour later, someone else spoke up, really adamant: "He's got to have been with him! He's got 'Galilean' written all over him."

59 About an hour later another asserted, "Certainly this fellow was with him, for he is a Galilean."

60 Peter said, "Man, I don't know what you're talking about." At that very moment, the last word hardly off his lips, a rooster crowed.

60 Peter replied, "Man, I don't know what you're talking about!" Just as he was speaking, the rooster crowed.

61 Just then, the Master turned and looked at Peter. Peter remembered what the Master had said to him: "Before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times."

61 The Lord turned and looked straight at Peter. Then Peter remembered the word the Lord had spoken to him: "Before the rooster crows today, you will disown me three times."

62 He went out and cried and cried and cried.

62 And he went outside and wept bitterly.

63 The men in charge of Jesus began poking fun at him, slapping him around.

63 The men who were guarding Jesus began mocking and beating him.

64 They put a blindfold on him and taunted, "Who hit you that time?"

64 They blindfolded him and demanded, "Prophecy! Who hit you?"

65 They were having a grand time with him.

65 And they said many other insulting things to him.

66 When it was morning, the religious leaders of the people and the high priests and scholars all got together and brought him before their High Council.

66 At daybreak the council of the elders of the people, both the chief priests and teachers of the law, met together, and Jesus was led before them.

67 They said, "Are you the Messiah?" He answered, "If I said yes, you wouldn't believe me.

67 If you are the Christ, they said, "tell us." Jesus answered, "If I tell you, you will not believe me,

68 If I asked what you meant by your question, you wouldn't answer me.

68 and if I asked you, you would not answer.

- 69 So here's what I have to say: From here on the Son of Man takes his place at God's right hand, the place of power."
- 69 But from now on, the Son of Man will be seated at the right hand of the mighty God."
- 70 They all said, "So you admit your claim to be the Son of God?" "You're the ones who keep saying it," he said.
- 70 They all asked, "Are you then the Son of God?" He replied, "You are right in saying I am."
- 71 But they had made up their minds, "Why do we need any more evidence? We've all heard him as good as say it himself."
- 71 Then they said, "Why do we need any more testimony? We have heard it from his own lips."

Luke 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then they all took Jesus to Pilate
- 1 Then the whole assembly rose and led him off to Pilate.
- 2 and began to bring up charges against him. They said, "We found this man undermining our law and order, forbidding taxes to be paid to Caesar, setting himself up as Messiah-King."
- 2 And they began to accuse him, saying, "We have found this man subverting our nation. He opposes payment of taxes to Caesar and claims to be Christ, a king."
- 3 Pilate asked him, "Is this true that you're 'King of the Jews'?" "Those are your words, not mine," Jesus replied.
- 3 So Pilate asked Jesus, "Are you the king of the Jews?" "Yes, it is as you say," Jesus replied.
- 4 Pilate told the high priests and the accompanying crowd, "I find nothing wrong here. He seems harmless enough to me."
- 4 Then Pilate announced to the chief priests and the crowd, "I find no basis for a charge against this man."
- 5 But they were vehement. "He's stirring up unrest among the people with his teaching, disturbing the peace everywhere, starting in Galilee and now all through Judea. He's a dangerous man, endangering the peace."

- 5 But they insisted, "He stirs up the people all over Judea by his teaching. He started in Galilee and has come all the way here."
- 6 When Pilate heard that, he asked, "So, he's a Galilean?"
- 6 On hearing this, Pilate asked if the man was a Galilean.
- 7 Realizing that he properly came under Herod's jurisdiction, he passed the buck to Herod, who just happened to be in Jerusalem for a few days.
- 7 When he learned that Jesus was under Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him to Herod, who was also in Jerusalem at that time.
- 8 Herod was delighted when Jesus showed up. He had wanted for a long time to see him, he'd heard so much about him. He hoped to see him do something spectacular.
- 8 When Herod saw Jesus, he was greatly pleased, because for a long time he had been wanting to see him. From what he had heard about him, he hoped to see him perform some miracle.
- 9 He peppered him with questions. Jesus didn't answer--not one word.
- 9 He plied him with many questions, but Jesus gave him no answer.
- 10 But the high priests and religion scholars were right there, saying their piece, strident and shrill in their accusations.
- 10 The chief priests and the teachers of the law were standing there, vehemently accusing him.
- 11 Mightily offended, Herod turned on Jesus. His soldiers joined in, taunting and jeering. Then they dressed him up in an elaborate king costume and sent him back to Pilate.
- 11 Then Herod and his soldiers ridiculed and mocked him. Dressing him in an elegant robe, they sent him back to Pilate.
- 12 That day Herod and Pilate became thick as thieves. Always before they had kept their distance.
- 12 That day Herod and Pilate became friends--before this they had been enemies.
- 13 Then Pilate called in the high priests, rulers, and the others
- 13 Pilate called together the chief priests, the rulers and the people,
- 14 and said, "You brought this man to me as a disturber of the peace. I examined him in front of all of you and found there was nothing to your charge.
- 14 and said to them, "You brought me this man as one who was inciting the people to rebellion. I have examined him in your presence and have

- found no basis for your charges against him.
- 15 And neither did Herod, for he has sent him back here with a clean bill of health. It's clear that he's done nothing wrong, let alone anything deserving death.
- 15 Neither has Herod, for he sent him back to us; as you can see, he has done nothing to deserve death.
- 16 I'm going to warn him to watch his step and let him go."
- 16 Therefore, I will punish him and then release him. "
- 17 (OMITTED TEXT)
- 18 At that, the crowd went wild: "Kill him! Give us Barabbas!"
- 18 With one voice they cried out, "Away with this man! Release Barabbas to us!"
- 19 (Barabbas had been thrown in prison for starting a riot in the city and for murder.)
- 19 (Barabbas had been thrown into prison for an insurrection in the city, and for murder.)
- 20 Pilate still wanted to let Jesus go, and so spoke out again.
- 20 Wanting to release Jesus, Pilate appealed to them again.
- 21 But they kept shouting back, "Crucify! Crucify him!"
- 21 But they kept shouting, "Crucify him! Crucify him!"
- 22 He tried a third time. "But for what crime? I've found nothing in him deserving death. I'm going to warn him to watch his step and let him go."
- 22 For the third time he spoke to them: "Why? What crime has this man committed? I have found in him no grounds for the death penalty. Therefore I will have him punished and then release him."
- 23 But they kept at it, a shouting mob, demanding that he be crucified. And finally they shouted him down.
- 23 But with loud shouts they insistently demanded that he be crucified, and their shouts prevailed.
- 24 Pilate caved in and gave them what they wanted.
- 24 So Pilate decided to grant their demand.
- 25 He released the man thrown in prison for rioting and murder, and gave them Jesus to do whatever they wanted.
- 25 He released the man who had been thrown into prison for insurrection and murder, the one they asked for, and surrendered Jesus to their will.

- 26 As they led him off, they made Simon, a man from Cyrene who happened to be coming in from the countryside, carry the cross behind Jesus.
- 26 As they led him away, they seized Simon from Cyrene, who was on his way in from the country, and put the cross on him and made him carry it behind Jesus.
- 27 A huge crowd of people followed, along with women weeping and carrying on.
- 27 A large number of people followed him, including women who mourned and wailed for him.
- 28 At one point Jesus turned to the women and said, "Daughters of Jerusalem, don't cry for me. Cry for yourselves and for your children.
- 28 Jesus turned and said to them, "Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for me; weep for yourselves and for your children.
- 29 The time is coming when they'll say, 'Lucky the women who never conceived! Lucky the wombs that never gave birth! Lucky the breasts that never gave milk!'
- 29 For the time will come when you will say, 'Blessed are the barren women, the wombs that never bore and the breasts that never nursed!'
- 30 Then they'll start calling to the mountains, 'Fall down on us!' calling to the hills, 'Cover us up!'
- 30 Then " 'they will say to the mountains, "Fall on us!" and to the hills, "Cover us!" '
- 31 If people do these things to a live, green tree, can you imagine what they'll do with deadwood?"
- 31 For if men do these things when the tree is green, what will happen when it is dry?"
- 32 Two others, both criminals, were taken along with him for execution.
- 32 Two other men, both criminals, were also led out with him to be executed.
- 33 When they got to the place called Skull Hill, they crucified him, along with the criminals, one on his right, the other on his left.
- 33 When they came to the place called the Skull, there they crucified him, along with the criminals--one on his right, the other on his left.
- 34 Jesus prayed, "Father, forgive them; they don't know what they're doing." Dividing up his clothes, they threw dice for them.

34 Jesus said, "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing." And they divided up his clothes by casting lots.

35 The people stood there staring at Jesus, and the ringleaders made faces, taunting, "He saved others. Let's see him save himself! The Messiah of God--ha! The Chosen--ha!"

35 The people stood watching, and the rulers even sneered at him. They said, "He saved others; let him save himself if he is the Christ of God, the Chosen One."

36 The soldiers also came up and poked fun at him, making a game of it. They toasted him with sour wine:

36 The soldiers also came up and mocked him. They offered him wine vinegar

37 "So you're King of the Jews! Save yourself!"

37 and said, "If you are the king of the Jews, save yourself."

38 Printed over him was a sign: THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.

38 There was a written notice above him, which read: THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.

39 One of the criminals hanging alongside cursed him: "Some Messiah you are! Save yourself! Save us!"

39 One of the criminals who hung there hurled insults at him: "Aren't you the Christ? Save yourself and us!"

40 But the other one made him shut up: "Have you no fear of God? You're getting the same as him.

40 But the other criminal rebuked him. "Don't you fear God," he said, "since you are under the same sentence?"

41 We deserve this, but not him--he did nothing to deserve this."

41 We are punished justly, for we are getting what our deeds deserve. But this man has done nothing wrong."

42 Then he said, "Jesus, remember me when you enter your kingdom."

42 Then he said, "Jesus, remember me when you come into your kingdom."

"

43 He said, "Don't worry, I will. Today you will join me in paradise."

43 Jesus answered him, "I tell you the truth, today you will be with me in paradise."

44 By now it was noon. The whole earth became dark, the darkness lasting three hours--

44 It was now about the sixth hour, and darkness came over the whole land
until the ninth hour,
45 a total blackout. The Temple curtain split right down the middle.
45 for the sun stopped shining. And the curtain of the temple was torn in
two.
46 Jesus called loudly, "Father, I place my life in your hands!" Then he
breathed his last.
46 Jesus called out with a loud voice, "Father, into your hands I commit my
spirit." When he had said this, he breathed his last.
47 When the captain there saw what happened, he honored God: "This man
was innocent! A good man, and innocent!"
47 The centurion, seeing what had happened, praised God and said,
"Surely this was a righteous man."
48 All who had come around as spectators to watch the show, when they
saw what actually happened, were overcome with grief and headed
home.
48 When all the people who had gathered to witness this sight saw what
took place, they beat their breasts and went away.
49 Those who knew Jesus well, along with the women who had followed
him from Galilee, stood at a respectful distance and kept vigil.
49 But all those who knew him, including the women who had followed
him from Galilee, stood at a distance, watching these things.
50 There was a man by the name of Joseph, a member of the Jewish High
Council, a man of good heart and good character.
50 Now there was a man named Joseph, a member of the Council, a good
and upright man,
51 He had not gone along with the plans and actions of the council. His
hometown was the Jewish village of Arimathea.
51 who had not consented to their decision and action. He came from the
Judean town of Arimathea and he was waiting for the kingdom of God.
52 He lived in alert expectation of the kingdom of God. He went to Pilate
and asked for the body of Jesus.
52 Going to Pilate, he asked for Jesus' body.
53 Taking him down, he wrapped him in a linen shroud and placed him in a
tomb chiseled into the rock, a tomb never yet used.

- 53 Then he took it down, wrapped it in linen cloth and placed it in a tomb cut in the rock, one in which no one had yet been laid.
- 54 It was the day before Sabbath, the Sabbath just about to begin.
- 54 It was Preparation Day, and the Sabbath was about to begin.
- 55 The women who had been companions of Jesus from Galilee followed along. They saw the tomb where Jesus' body was placed.
- 55 The women who had come with Jesus from Galilee followed Joseph and saw the tomb and how his body was laid in it.
- 56 Then they went back to prepare burial spices and perfumes. They rested quietly on the Sabbath, as commanded.
- 56 Then they went home and prepared spices and perfumes. But they rested on the Sabbath in obedience to the commandment.

Luke 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 At the crack of dawn on Sunday, the women came to the tomb carrying the burial spices they had prepared.
- 1 On the first day of the week, very early in the morning, the women took the spices they had prepared and went to the tomb.
- 2 They found the entrance stone rolled back from the tomb,
- 2 They found the stone rolled away from the tomb,
- 3 so they walked in. But once inside, they couldn't find the body of the Master Jesus.
- 3 but when they entered, they did not find the body of the Lord Jesus.
- 4 They were puzzled, wondering what to make of this. Then, out of nowhere it seemed, two men, light cascading over them, stood there.
- 4 While they were wondering about this, suddenly two men in clothes that gleamed like lightning stood beside them.
- 5 The women were awestruck and bowed down in worship. The men said, "Why are you looking for the Living One in a cemetery?"
- 5 In their fright the women bowed down with their faces to the ground, but the men said to them, "Why do you look for the living among the dead?"
- 6 He is not here, but raised up. Remember how he told you when you were still back in Galilee

- 6 He is not here; he has risen! Remember how he told you, while he was still with you in Galilee:
- 7 that he had to be handed over to sinners, be killed on a cross, and in three days rise up?"
- 7 ' The Son of Man must be delivered into the hands of sinful men, be crucified and on the third day be raised again.' "
- 8 Then they remembered Jesus' words.
- 8 Then they remembered his words.
- 9 They left the tomb and broke the news of all this to the Eleven and the rest.
- 9 When they came back from the tomb, they told all these things to the Eleven and to all the others.
- 10 Mary Magdalene, Joanna, Mary the mother of James, and the other women with them kept telling these things to the apostles,
- 10 It was Mary Magdalene, Joanna, Mary the mother of James, and the others with them who told this to the apostles.
- 11 but the apostles didn't believe a word of it, thought they were making it all up.
- 11 But they did not believe the women, because their words seemed to them like nonsense.
- 12 But Peter jumped to his feet and ran to the tomb. He stooped to look in and saw a few grave clothes, that's all. He walked away puzzled, shaking his head.
- 12 Peter, however, got up and ran to the tomb. Bending over, he saw the strips of linen lying by themselves, and he went away, wondering to himself what had happened.
- 13 That same day two of them were walking to the village Emmaus, about seven miles out of Jerusalem.
- 13 Now that same day two of them were going to a village called Emmaus, about seven miles from Jerusalem.
- 14 They were deep in conversation, going over all these things that had happened.
- 14 They were talking with each other about everything that had happened.
- 15 In the middle of their talk and questions, Jesus came up and walked along with them.

15 As they talked and discussed these things with each other, Jesus himself came up and walked along with them;

16 But they were not able to recognize who he was.

16 but they were kept from recognizing him.

17 He asked, "What's this you're discussing so intently as you walk along?" They just stood there, long-faced, like they had lost their best friend.

17 He asked them, "What are you discussing together as you walk along?" They stood still, their faces downcast.

18 Then one of them, his name was Cleopas, said, "Are you the only one in Jerusalem who hasn't heard what's happened during the last few days?"

18 One of them, named Cleopas, asked him, "Are you only a visitor to Jerusalem and do not know the things that have happened there in these days?"

19 He said, "What has happened?" They said, "The things that happened to Jesus the Nazarene. He was a man of God, a prophet, dynamic in work and word, blessed by both God and all the people.

19 What things? he asked. "About Jesus of Nazareth," they replied. "He was a prophet, powerful in word and deed before God and all the people.

20 Then our high priests and leaders betrayed him, got him sentenced to death, and crucified him.

20 The chief priests and our rulers handed him over to be sentenced to death, and they crucified him;

21 And we had our hopes up that he was the One, the One about to deliver Israel. And it is now the third day since it happened.

21 but we had hoped that he was the one who was going to redeem Israel. And what is more, it is the third day since all this took place.

22 But now some of our women have completely confused us. Early this morning they were at the tomb

22 In addition, some of our women amazed us. They went to the tomb early this morning

23 and couldn't find his body. They came back with the story that they had seen a vision of angels who said he was alive.

23 but didn't find his body. They came and told us that they had seen a vision of angels, who said he was alive.

24 Some of our friends went off to the tomb to check and found it empty just as the women said, but they didn't see Jesus."

24 Then some of our companions went to the tomb and found it just as the women had said, but him they did not see."

25 Then he said to them, "So thick-headed! So slow-hearted! Why can't you simply believe all that the prophets said?"

25 He said to them, "How foolish you are, and how slow of heart to believe all that the prophets have spoken!"

26 Don't you see that these things had to happen, that the Messiah had to suffer and only then enter into his glory?"

26 Did not the Christ have to suffer these things and then enter his glory?"

27 Then he started at the beginning, with the Books of Moses, and went on through all the Prophets, pointing out everything in the Scriptures that referred to him.

27 And beginning with Moses and all the Prophets, he explained to them what was said in all the Scriptures concerning himself.

28 They came to the edge of the village where they were headed. He acted as if he were going on

28 As they approached the village to which they were going, Jesus acted as if he were going farther.

29 but they pressed him: "Stay and have supper with us. It's nearly evening; the day is done." So he went in with them.

29 But they urged him strongly, "Stay with us, for it is nearly evening; the day is almost over." So he went in to stay with them.

30 And here is what happened: He sat down at the table with them. Taking the bread, he blessed and broke and gave it to them.

30 When he was at the table with them, he took bread, gave thanks, broke it and began to give it to them.

31 At that moment, open-eyed, wide-eyed, they recognized him. And then he disappeared.

31 Then their eyes were opened and they recognized him, and he disappeared from their sight.

32 Back and forth they talked. "Didn't we feel on fire as he conversed with us on the road, as he opened up the Scriptures for us?"

32 They asked each other, "Were not our hearts burning within us while he talked with us on the road and opened the Scriptures to us?"

33 They didn't waste a minute. They were up and on their way back to Jerusalem. They found the Eleven and their friends gathered together,

33 They got up and returned at once to Jerusalem. There they found the Eleven and those with them, assembled together
34 talking away: "It's really happened! The Master has been raised up-- Simon saw him!"
34 and saying, "It is true! The Lord has risen and has appeared to Simon."
35 Then the two went over everything that happened on the road and how they recognized him when he broke the bread.
35 Then the two told what had happened on the way, and how Jesus was recognized by them when he broke the bread.
36 While they were saying all this, Jesus appeared to them and said, "Peace be with you."
36 While they were still talking about this, Jesus himself stood among them and said to them, "Peace be with you."
37 They thought they were seeing a ghost and were scared half to death.
37 They were startled and frightened, thinking they saw a ghost.
38 He continued with them, "Don't be upset, and don't let all these doubting questions take over.
38 He said to them, "Why are you troubled, and why do doubts rise in your minds?
39 Look at my hands; look at my feet--it's really me. Touch me. Look me over from head to toe. A ghost doesn't have muscle and bone like this."
39 Look at my hands and my feet. It is I myself! Touch me and see; a ghost does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have."
40 As he said this, he showed them his hands and feet.
40 When he had said this, he showed them his hands and feet.
41 They still couldn't believe what they were seeing. It was too much; it seemed too good to be true. He asked, "Do you have any food here?"
41 And while they still did not believe it because of joy and amazement, he asked them, "Do you have anything here to eat?"
42 They gave him a piece of leftover fish they had cooked.
42 They gave him a piece of broiled fish,
43 He took it and ate it right before their eyes.
43 and he took it and ate it in their presence.
44 Then he said, "Everything I told you while I was with you comes to this: All the things written about me in the Law of Moses, in the Prophets, and in the Psalms have to be fulfilled."

44 He said to them, "This is what I told you while I was still with you: Everything must be fulfilled that is written about me in the Law of Moses, the Prophets and the Psalms."

45 He went on to open their understanding of the Word of God, showing them how to read their Bibles this way.

45 Then he opened their minds so they could understand the Scriptures.

46 He said, "You can see now how it is written that the Messiah suffers, rises from the dead on the third day,

46 He told them, "This is what is written: The Christ will suffer and rise from the dead on the third day,

47 and then a total life-change through the forgiveness of sins is proclaimed in his name to all nations--starting from here, from Jerusalem!

47 and repentance and forgiveness of sins will be preached in his name to all nations, beginning at Jerusalem.

48 You're the first to hear and see it. You're the witnesses.

48 You are witnesses of these things.

49 What comes next is very important: I am sending what my Father promised to you, so stay here in the city until he arrives, until you're equipped with power from on high."

49 I am going to send you what my Father has promised; but stay in the city until you have been clothed with power from on high."

50 He then led them out of the city over to Bethany. Raising his hands he blessed them,

50 When he had led them out to the vicinity of Bethany, he lifted up his hands and blessed them.

51 and while blessing them, took his leave, being carried up to heaven.

51 While he was blessing them, he left them and was taken up into heaven.

52 And they were on their knees, worshiping him. They returned to Jerusalem bursting with joy.

52 Then they worshiped him and returned to Jerusalem with great joy.

53 They spent all their time in the Temple praising God. Yes.

53 And they stayed continually at the temple, praising God.